

The Age of Sail Battle Game

BLACK SEAS

1770-1830

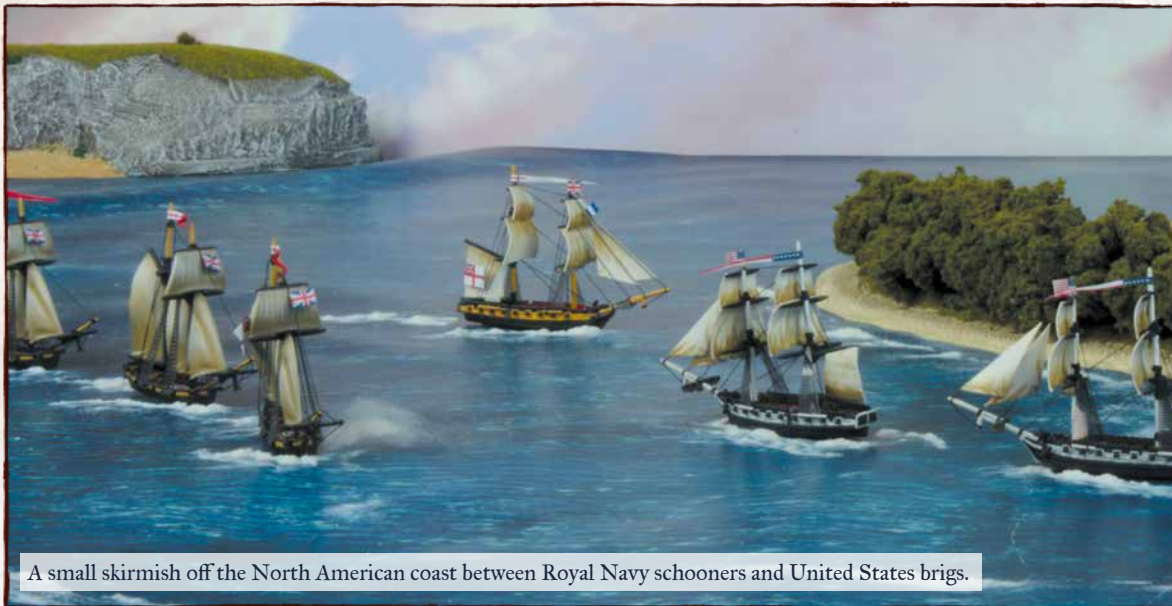
HOLD FAST!



A Black Seas Supplement

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BLACK POWDER



A small skirmish off the North American coast between Royal Navy schooners and United States brigs.



Barbary Coast pirates close in on a defenceless merchant ship.



A Spanish convoy casting off to start their mission.

HOLD FAST!

A SUPPLEMENT FOR BLACK SEAS

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In memory of Noel Williams - 1952 – 2021

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Brave American seamen show their courage by engaging a much larger British force.

HOLD FAST!

This book is a supplement to the *Black Seas* rulebook. Its aim is to add new ways in which you can play naval battles using the *Black Seas* rules, with many scenarios, campaign suggestions and tournaments, as well as a few ways to play solo.

You will need the *Black Seas* rulebook to play using this supplement, as this book does not contain the core rules. Instead, this volume is at its heart a compendium of material, some of which has been presented before in magazines and on websites. Within, you will find the most interesting additions as well as a fair few new ones, including special rules for navies other than the four main maritime powers of the era.

The historical information contained here has been presented by a couple of very talented writers.

In addition, I would like to thank John Stallard for being inspirational and instrumental in making all of this happen.

Gabrio Tolentino

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SMUGGLER'S RUN

The golden age of piracy is long past, but its spirit lives on in the hearts of enterprising 'businessmen' out to make their fortune on the margins of society. Smuggler's Run puts players at the heart of this black market, running contraband in and out of the Mediterranean. Create your own smuggling company and outwit the authorities in the name of trade and profit!

The Smuggler's Run campaign is best played with an even number of players. However, there are ways to adapt it to an odd number, with players taking turns to skip a round.

Getting Started

Before setting sail with your cargo of contraband, ensure you've got the following materials to hand:

- A copy of the *Black Seas* rulebook
- Suitable ship models to represent various kinds of ship, along with the appropriate ship cards and wake markers
- Six-sided (D6) and ten-sided (D10) dice in multiple colours
- A wind rose, measuring sticks, and tokens
- A completed set of company rosters

You can use some or all of the Advanced Rules from the *Black Seas* rulebook and

ROLLING A D100

While creating a smuggling company, some of the tables may require you to roll a D100. The easiest way to do this is to roll two ten-sided dice (D10s) of different colours, taking one result as the tens digit and the other as the single digit, thus generating a number between 1 and 100.

this supplement in the campaign, but we advise against using Rules of Engagement, Entanglement, and Weather Conditions.

Campaigns & Tournaments

Campaigns are a fun way to get a group of players to engage in a series of games that are linked in some meaningful way. This link can vary from being a story or narrative to the inclusion of a system that allows a player to grow their forces based on the number of completed games and their outcomes.

Playing a campaign can also be an excellent incentive to build and paint a fleet. Players usually start a campaign with just a few ships, then paint more as their presence becomes necessary.

Sometimes tournaments draw upon systems similar to those found in campaigns. These usually last a limited time and feature games played over one or two days. These games are not necessarily linked, but different narratives can be used to pair competing players.

In the following pages, you will find a full campaign that can be enjoyed with fellow enthusiasts, as well as a suggestion for a tournament structure loosely linked by a narrative. This system includes specific scenarios designed to increase the strength of the forces involved as they progress.

Campaign Objectives

Smuggler's Run is a campaign where rival smuggling companies compete to ferry and sell the most contraband. It works better with an even number of players in the campaign. During each Turn, the players will be matched in pairs, and, in most cases, each pair will play two back-to-back games. Before the campaign begins, players should agree on the campaign objectives. Pick one of the following or roll 1D6 on the table below to determine one randomly.

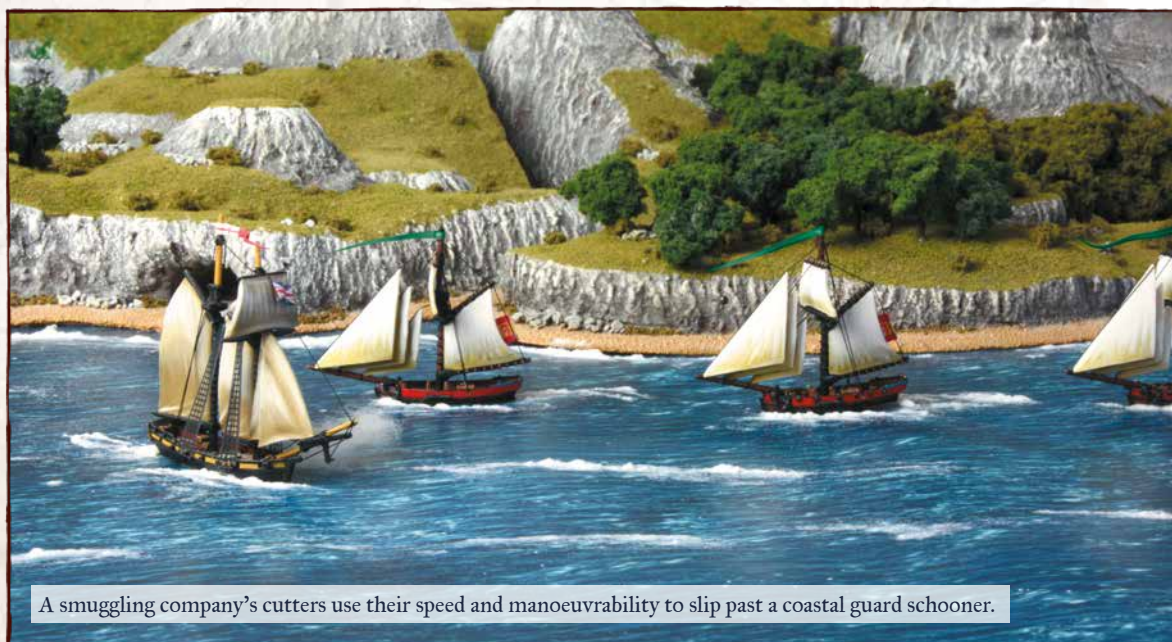
In the campaign, there are Standard Turns and Special Turns. For every four campaign Turns, the first three Turns will be Standard and the fourth will be Special. During the Standard Turns, players pair up, randomly select a scenario to play and follow all the steps as outlined, with each pair playing two back-to-back games (taking it in turn to play as the customs force). Special Turns still follow each step, but all players take part in the same scenario, Rival Companies.

Score	Result
1-2	Time and Tide Wait for No Man: Whoever has the most money in their Treasury after eight full Turns is declared the winner of the campaign.
3-4	Trade & Profit: Whoever reaches a Treasury of at least £20,000 cash first is declared the winner of the campaign.
5-6	Down to the Locker: The campaign lasts for a minimum of three full Turns. After that, it concludes as soon as one of the players has no ships left. Whoever has the most money in their Treasury at that point is declared the winner. From the fifth Turn onwards, ships can no longer be bought, repaired, or replaced.

Creating a Smuggling Company

At the beginning of the campaign, all players must create a smuggling company. Each player will track the fortunes of their illegal enterprise over the course of several in-game months, while they attempt to outwit the flat-

footed Customs & Excise officers patrolling the coastline. Each company begins with a Small Merchant ship, a Schooner, and a purse of £600 to spend on additional ships, upgrades, and trade goods.



A smuggling company's cutters use their speed and manoeuvrability to slip past a coastal guard schooner.

BUY SHIPS

To assemble their fleet of smuggling vessels, players may purchase ships from the Shipyard Table (below).

Add each new ship to the purchasing player's roster, noting its cash cost.

The cost of each ship includes an Inexperienced crew. When a ship is added to a player's fleet, money can be spent on upgrades, as shown on the Quartermaster Table (below). The maximum number of upgrades permitted for an individual vessel is specified for each ship. Note that a ship can only have one upgrade of each type.

Any leftover cash can be used to buy goods; this sum should be added to the Company Purse.

Crew experience can be increased by spending 20% of the ship cost, including upgrades (and rounding up to the nearest £10). However, you



can only increase experience by one rank per Turn per ship.

Players are encouraged to add detail to their ships, including things like names and quirks. Turn to the Additional Company Details section on pages 11–13 of this supplement for more information.

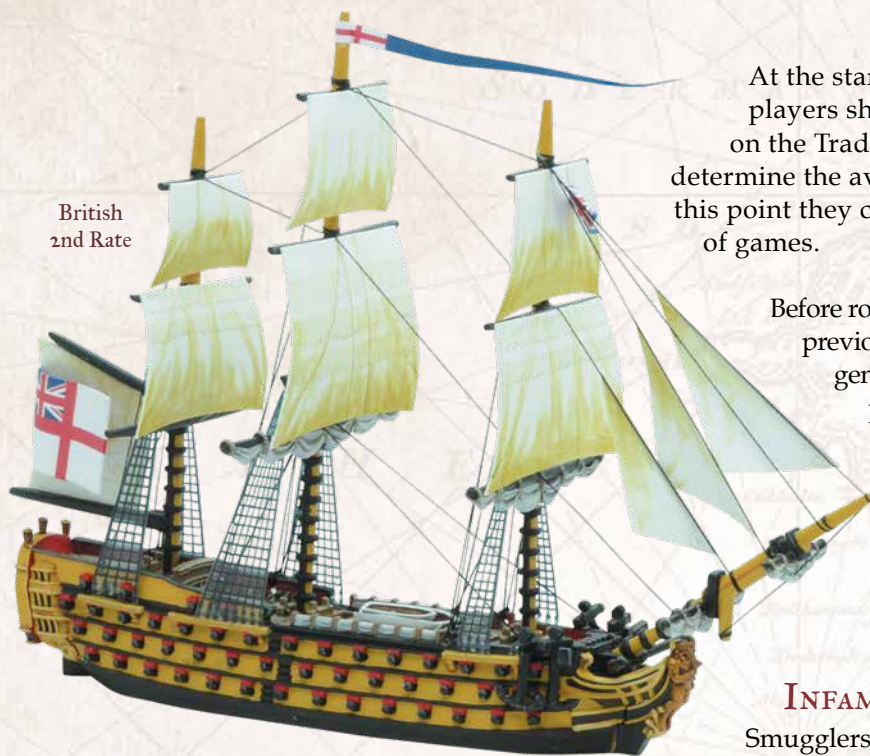
Shipyard Table

Ship	Cash Cost	Max TUs Transportable	Max Upgrades
6th Rate	£600	3	4
Bomb Ketch	£500	4	3
Brig	£400	2	3
Large Merchant	£400	8	2
Large Xebec	£500	2	3
Large Cutter	£300	2	3
Small Galley	£300	2	2
Schooner	£200	2	2
Small Xebec	£200	2	2
Small Merchant	£200	4	1
Small Cutter	£100	1	1

Quartermaster Table

Upgrade	Cash Cost
Boarding Nets	£20
Privateer	£20
Master Caulker	£20
Master Carpenter	£20
Master Builder (add 5 Ship Points to the current total)	£50
Streamlined Hull	£50
Ship's Surgeon	£50
Swivel Guns	£50
Spacious Hull (+1 TUs carried)	£100
Quarantine Flag (+2 on the Strike the Colours table)	£100
Extra Guns (add 1L gun to the ship)	£100
Lucky	£100

British
2nd Rate



At the start of each campaign Turn, players should get together and roll on the Trading Post Table (below) to determine the availability of Trade Goods. At this point they can also arrange the next set of games.

Before rolling, any unused TUs from the previous Turn are removed from the general supply. Starting with the player whose Infamy is lowest and progressing in order to the highest, players buy TUs from those available. Players who are tied for Infamy should break the deadlock with a dice roll.

INFAMY

Smugglers have a certain level of notoriety that, no matter how discreet they try to be, accrues during their career. This is called their Infamy level.

Infamy is calculated by adding the value of all a company's ships (including upgrades), the Purchase Cost of all stored Trade Goods, and any cash in the Company Purse. This sum is then divided by 100, rounding down.

Using this calculation, a starting company will have a Infamy of 10 (£1000/100).

STOCK WAREHOUSE

After buying extra ships and upgrades, as well as at the start of each campaign Turn, players can use the money in their Company Purse to purchase goods from the Trading Post Table.

Goods are organised into Trade Units (TUs). Each Trade Unit has a Purchase Cost, Sale Price, Danger Rating, and Availability. Ships can carry a set amount of Trade Units based on their size.

Trading Post Table

Name	Purchase Cost	Sale Price	Danger Rating	Availability		
				2-4 players	5-9 players	10+ players
Iron	£50	£200	1	1D3+3	1D6+3	1D10+3
Wheat	£50	£200	1	1D3+3	1D6+3	1D10+3
Timber	£50	£200	1	1D3+3	1D6+3	1D10+3
Beer	£100	£400	2	1D3+2	1D6+2	1D10+2
Tea	£100	£400	2	1D3+2	1D6+2	1D10+2
Spirits	£150	£600	3	1D3+1	1D6+1	1D10+1
Silk	£150	£600	3	1D3+1	1D6+1	1D10+1
Tobacco	£200	£800	4	1D3	1D3+1	1D6+1
Coffee	£200	£800	4	1D3	1D3+1	1D6+1
Weapons*	£300	£1,200	7	2	3	4
Espionage Materials*	£100	£1,500	12	1	2	3

* Only 1 per company per round

Campaign System

STEP I: LOAD CARGO & DETERMINE OPPOSITION

After re-stocking the warehouse, players should determine who will pair up. For the first round of the campaign, this can be done by rolling dice, drawing names from a hat, or any other random method. In subsequent Standard Turns, players should aim to play opponents they have not yet faced. In Special Turns, rank the players in order of Company Value, then pair up the first with the second, the third with the fourth, and so on. All players must then determine what forces will be involved. Smugglers choose ships from their fleets to participate in the run, as well as the cargo that each ship will carry. This is recorded and kept secret until a ship is boarded, or until Step 4.

As previously mentioned, ships can carry a certain number of Trade Units based on their size. The smugglers can load their chosen ships up to maximum capacity. Every Trade Unit has an assigned Danger Rating. Each smuggler must add the Danger Rating of each type of goods loaded together; the result is the Danger Rating of the smuggling expedition.

The player who will be controlling the opposing customs force rolls 1D10 and adds the expedition's Danger Rating and smuggler's Infamy. Check this total against the Opposition Force Table below to determine the customs force interdicting the smugglers.

***Example:** Captain Stone is loading up his fleet of dastardly smugglers for a short hop across the Strait of Gibraltar. Their fleet is made up of one Large Merchant ship, three Brigs and a 6th Rate, giving him a total cargo capacity of 17 Trade Units and a Infamy of 22.*

From their warehouse, Captain Stone takes 4 units of Tobacco, 8 units of Spirits and 1 unit of Weapons. This gives an overall danger rating of 14.

Their opponent, Captain Chapman, rolls 1D10 and gets a 7. To this result they add 14 for the expedition's Danger Rating and 22 for their opponent's Infamy. The overall total is 43, Checking that total against the Opposition Force Table shows Captain Stone will face the Coastal Schooners force.

Opposition Force Table

Score	Result (Unless specified otherwise, the experience of the customs' ships is Regular)
1-20	Lonely Patrol: Sailing toward a long-forgotten trading haven, the smuggling expedition encounters a much-neglected harbour patrol ship. The opposing force is composed of 1x Inexperienced Schooner.
21-30	Dishevelled Guards: Only a small force guards this stretch of sea. The opposing force is composed of 1x Gunboat Squadron, 1x Large Cutter, and 1x Schooner. All ships are Inexperienced.
31-40	Harbour Patrol: A patrol brig commands a small Inexperienced fleet. The opposing force is composed of 1x Gunboat Squadron, 2x Small Cutters with Inexperienced crews, and 1x Brig.
41-50	Coastal Schooners: A customs patrol hounds this stretch of coastline. The opposing force is composed of 2x Gunboat Squadrons, 3x Schooners, and 1x Brig with Veteran crew.
51-60	Frigate Frenzy: The customs patrol in this area has received a much-needed force multiplier in the form of a slightly knackered frigate. The opposing force is composed of 3x Schooners, 1x Brig with Veteran crew, and 1x 6th Rate with Inexperienced crew.
61-70	Admiralty Attention: The smuggler's operation has drawn the attention of His Majesty's Royal Navy. The opposing force is composed of 1x Schooner, 3x Brigs, and 1x 5th Rate ship.
71-80	Active Pursuit: The coast guard is actively hunting this expedition. The opposing force is composed of 1x Schooner, 3x Brigs, and 1x Small 3rd Rate ship.
81+	WANTED: The company is well known and the Admiralty has decided to send out the big guns. The opposing force is composed of 1x Schooner, 3x Brigs, and 1x 3rd Rate ship with Veteran crew.



STEP 2: ROLL BATTLE TYPE

At this stage, each pair of players should roll 1D10 on the Scenario Table to determine the scenario they will play. They will take part in the same scenario twice, with each player enacting the role of His Majesty's Customs and Excise while their paired opponent plays the smuggling company.

In the scenarios Catch the Prize, Letter of Marque, and Run the Blockade, the company is the defender. In Ambush, the company is the Ottomans. Use this same pattern for all subsequent Turns during these scenarios, with everyone playing Rival Companies in the fourth Turns.

Ignore the suggested ships and/or points for the scenarios given in the main *Black Seas* rulebook and use the fleets as described here instead. If the same smuggler rolls two identical scenarios in two consecutive Turns, they can decide whether or not to roll again.

In addition to a scenario's Victory Conditions, the game will finish at the end of a round in which half of a company's ships (rounding up) have left the gaming area on the side of the deployment zone opposite (furthest) from their own deployment zone. If the main Victory Conditions have not been met, the result is a draw.

Scenario Table

Score	Result
1	Catch the Prize (<i>Black Seas</i> , page 42)
2	Haunted Cove (page 16)
3	Run the Blockade (<i>Black Seas</i> , page 45)
4-5	Ambush (page 30)
6-7	Smuggling Run (page 15)
8	Out of the Fog (<i>Black Seas</i> , page 30)
9	Chance Encounter (<i>Black Seas</i> , page 40)
10	Letter of Marque (<i>Black Seas</i> , page 31)

If specific ships are mentioned in the Victory Conditions of a scenario, change these to match ships of the same size that participated in the game.

STEP 3: PLAY BATTLE

Get out onto the high seas and play the selected scenario with your chosen force!

Any ship that leaves the gaming table (apart from as determined by the scenario or as per the alternative scenario end described above) is considered to have Struck the Colours and will roll on the table below (in Step 5) with a -2 to the result.

STEP 4: SELL CARGO

When the Rival Companies Turn is played, only cargo that is actually unloaded is counted. In all the other scenarios, ships that were not sunk or did not Strike the Colours have successfully carried all their cargo to the destination. Each Trade Unit they carried may be redeemed for the listed Sale Price. The smuggler adds these profits to their Company Purse.

In all scenarios apart from Rival Companies, if the smuggler won, add 10% to the total sale of the goods (rounding up to the nearest £50). If the smuggler lost, subtract 10% from the total sale of the goods (rounding up to the nearest £50).

STEP 5: STRUCK COLOURS

If a ship Strikes the Colours, the player must roll 1D10 on the Consequences Table (right). If the ship was also boarded during the game, they must roll 2D10 and pick the lowest result.

If a ship Struck its Colours while carrying Espionage Materials, it will be impounded without rolling. Furthermore, from now on the company owning it has 10 points permanently added to its Infamy total.

STEP 6: UPDATE SHIPYARD STATUS

Ships that have their Ship Points reduced to zero have a small chance of surviving due to being mistaken as dead in the water. Roll a Skill Test with the ship's experience. If passed, the ship can be retained on the company's roster with zero Ship Points; otherwise, consider the ship sunk. In both instances, any transported TUs are lost.

Consequences Table

Score	Result
1-4	Impounded: The ship is captured and hauled into a Customs yard, either to be broken up or sold for a profit. It is removed from the company fleet.
5-8	Ditch the Swag: The crew managed to avoid arrest by jettisoning the contraband. No additional effects.
9-10+	Turned a Blind Eye: Caught in a sticky situation, the captain had to grease some palms to avoid capture. The ship may continue to participate in the campaign, but half its current carried cargo (in TUs, rounding up with the most expensive first) must be surrendered as bribes.

Sunk or impounded ships are lost and must be removed from the company's roster. Damaged ships remain damaged until repaired. Mark their current Ship Points on the roster. If not repaired, ships will start the next Turn damaged. Repairs cost £5 for every 1 Ship Points that needs repairing.

If all the ships in a fleet are lost, the smuggler can start the next Turn with one Small Merchant, one Small Cutter and a £600 purse.

Heavy Metal Thunder

"It was like some awfully tremendous thunderstorm, whose deafening roar is attended by incessant streaks of lightning, carrying death in every flash and strewing the ground with victims of its wrath; only in our case the scene was rendered more horrible than that by the presence of torrents of blood which dyed our decks. [...] I was busily supplying powder when I saw blood suddenly fly from the arm of a man stationed at our gun. I saw nothing strike him; the effect alone was visible. [...] The cries of the wounded now rang through all parts of the ship. These were carried to the cockpit as fast as they fell, while those more fortunate who were killed outright were thrown overboard. [...] A man named Alderich had one of his hands cut off by a shot and almost at the same moment he received another shot which tore open his bowels in a terrible manner. As he fell two or three men caught him in their arms, and as he could not live, threw him overboard."

The Trafalgar Companion (Mark Adkin)

STEP 7: JOURNEY HOME

After selling its cargo, the smuggler's fleet must return to its base of operations; however, the trip home might not always be as expected. All players roll 1D10 on the Journey Home Table (below).

STEP 8: PURCHASE, REPAIR SHIPS & UPGRADES

Players should keep track of the money accumulated during Step 4: Sell Cargo. This money can be spent to buy and repair ships (at a cost of £5 for every 1 Ship Points repaired), as well as upgrading damaged or existing ones and purchasing cargo made available for the next round.

At this stage the player may also sell ships. To do this, the ship must have half or more of its original Ship Points; the player will obtain half of the value of its List Price without upgrades (upgrades cannot be sold and will be lost). Alternatively, a player can scuttle any ship at any point. Remove it and any cargo it might have been carrying from the roster.

At this point, all players re-calculate their Infamy, remembering to add the value (including upgrades) of their company's ships, the Purchase Cost of all stored Trade Goods, and any cash. This number is then divided by 100, rounding down. Once all players have completed all these steps, return to Step 1.

Journey Home Table

Score	Result
1	Random Act of Piracy: On their homeward journey, the smugglers stumble across a heavily laden merchant ship. The company gains 5x TUs of Timber and 2x TUs of Silk (or up to the maximum TUs that the fleet just used can carry).
2	Blown Off Course: Foul weather drives some of the flotilla off course. Choose one ship that participated in the last battle. It may not participate in the next game.
3	Concealed Injury: The return journey reveals battle damage that was not initially noticed. Choose one of the ships that survived the last battle without damage. Roll 1D10 to determine the amount of damage received and record it.
4	Hot Pursuit: Customs agents trail the smugglers back to their lair. For the next campaign Turn only, increase the smuggler's Infamy by 10.
5	Tinkering Shipwrights: Cultivating contacts in neutral shipyards has paid dividends. Choose a damaged ship; it can be repaired by up to 10 Ship Points for free.
6	Raided Warehouse: Customs agents or rival smugglers have ransacked the company warehouse. The smuggler loses 1D6 x £100 worth of stock. This can be removed in TUs and/or from the Company Purse, as they choose.
7	Rudimentary Training: Some captains have taken the time to instruct their crews in the basics of ship manoeuvres. Choose one unrated, non-merchant ships that did not participate in the previous battle. It gains a Veteran crew for free. Make sure the £ value is updated to reflect this change.
8	Shipwreck: The smugglers encounter flotsam, presumably from a shipwreck. They find secret despatches in a crate. The company gains 1 TU of Espionage Materials.
9	Shallows: One ship of the fleet owner's choice crashes onto rocks in the shallows and sustains damage. Halve the current Ship Points for that ship.
10	Protection Racket: The company's criminal activities begin expanding into extortion and blackmail. The company gains 1D6 x £100.

Additional Company Details

Players wanting to flesh out their criminal enterprise can use the tables on the following pages to add colour to their ships and organisation.

Be aware that some of the results will have an in-game effect. While these are lots of fun, they can unbalance the campaign, so make sure that all players in the campaign agree to the use of the tables.

SHIP NAME

Roll 1D100 on the Ship Names table to determine the ship's name.

COMPANY NAME

Roll 1D100 twice on the Company Names table, one for each column of the table, to generate a random name for your company.



Ship Names Table

Score	Result
1-5	<i>Aphrodite</i>
6-10	<i>Hermes</i>
11-15	<i>Unicorn</i>
16-20	<i>Themis</i>
21-25	<i>Harpy</i>
26-30	<i>Adonis</i>
31-35	<i>Bellerophon</i>
36-40	<i>Black Bart</i>
41-45	<i>Godfrey</i>
46-50	<i>Elizabeth</i>
51-55	<i>Matilda</i>
56-60	<i>Golden Pheasant</i>
61-65	<i>Rouge</i>
66-70	<i>King Alfred</i>
71-75	<i>Dragonfly</i>
76-80	<i>Constantine</i>
81-85	<i>Swiftspray</i>
86-90	<i>Tickler</i>
91-95	<i>Kingfisher</i>
96-100	<i>Nightingale</i>

Company Names Table

Score	1st Roll	2nd Roll
1-5	Foxglove	Gang
6-10	Hawkhurst	Clan
11-15	Moreton	Company
16-20	De Vries	Syndicate
21-25	Scarlett	Band
26-30	Cannon	Family
31-35	Pope	Crew
36-40	Hedley	Brothers
41-45	Flynn	Mob
46-50	MacKay	& Sons
51-55	MacGregor	Exports
56-60	Douglas	Trading
61-65	De Haven	& Co
66-70	Van de Laar	Limited
71-75	Callaghan	Shipping
76-80	Rasmussen	of Bruges
81-85	Macauley	of Aarhus
86-90	Hyland	of Plymouth
91-95	Moriarty	of Galloway
96-100	De Klerk	of Belfast

Darkness and fog are a boon to smugglers when unloading contraband.



SHIP ORIGIN

Roll 1D10 on the table below to determine where the ship comes from.

Ship Origin Table

Score	Result
1	British: The ship is crewed mainly by ex-Navy British sailors. +1 to hit when Shooting.
2	Northern European Shipyard: This ship does not need to test to sail over sandbanks and ignores the effects of shoals/shorelines and the result '9- Shallows' on the Journey home table.
3	French Shipyard: The ship is crewed mainly by ex-Navy French sailors. +1 to hit when Aiming High.
4	Spanish Shipyard: This ship has access to more guns. The Overgunned upgrade costs £50.
5	Mediterranean Shipyard: This ship does not need to test to sail over sandbanks and ignores the effects of shoals/shorelines and the result '9- Shallows' on the Journey home table.
6	Barbary Coast: The crew is well-versed in boarding merchants. The ship has the Privateer upgrade.
7	American Shipyard: Its sturdy design allows this ship to take more cannons. You can buy the Overgunned upgrade twice.
8	Exotic Origins: The ship was built in some far-flung place, to an unknown design that is incredibly unusual in European waters. +£50 to the first TU sold in every turn.
9	Military Shipyard: The ship was built to military specifications in a government-owned shipyard, then stolen or decommissioned. +1 to all Skill Tests.
10	Ex-Merchant Navy: This ship can transport +1 TU but has -1 Rate of Knots.

SHIP QUIRKS

Roll 1D100 on the table below to determine some of the strange quirks that affect your vessel.

You can either use them as colourful descriptors of the ship or, optionally, also implement the accompanying rule

amendments. In this instance, roll for every ship and accept all additional rules. Each ship can only have one quirk unless stated otherwise. Additionally, each quirk can only appear once in each fleet. Re-roll if the same result appears twice.

Ship Quirks Table

Score	Result
1-4	Horrific Curse: -1 to all shooting. Will always score a result of 9 (Turn a Blind Eye) on the Consequences table.
5-8	Flamboyantly Dressed Crew: Luxury goods transported by this ship (Spirits, Silk, Tobacco, and Coffee) sell for £50 more per TU.
9-12	Secret Compartments: +2 to all Consequences Table rolls.
13-16	Incredibly Cramped: -1 TU max capacity. +2D10 in every boarding action.
17-20	Leaks like a Sieve: At the start of every activation, take 1 damage. Cannot catch fire. If this is the result on the critical table, ignore it.
21-24	Foreign Crew Members: Communication is difficult: -1 to the first Skill Check of every activation. The first TU of Iron, Wheat, or Timber is sold for £450.
25-28	Mad Captain: The ship must attempt to board an enemy that is within 3" at the end of its full movement. All boarding actions have a +1.
29-32	Embellished Hull: Add 10% to the initial full Ship Points of the ship, rounding up.
33-36	Haphazard Repairs: Reduce the initial full Ship Points of the ship by 10%, rounding up. Also reduce the cost of the ship by 20%, rounding up.
37-40	Piratical Past: The ship can be targeted even if it is not the closest. Gains the Privateer upgrade at no extra cost.
41-44	Unusual Colour Scheme: In the Smuggling Run scenario, the ship can be targeted when at 20" or less. Reduce the cost of the ship by 10%, rounding up.
45-48	Sumptuous Cabins: The crew is well rested. +1 to the first Skill Test of every activation.
49-52	Coloured/Patterned Sails: +1 Danger Rating when using this ship in a scenario. +1 to all Skill Tests.
53-56	Superior Block and Tackle: On the first turn of unloading TUs, unload double the allowance.
57-60	Cunning Disguise: The ship cannot be shot at unless the enemy is within 10".
61-64	Infested with Vermin: Customs are reluctant to search the boat. +2 to all Consequences Table rolls.
65-68	Rich Previous Owner: Choose one £20 upgrade for free.
69-72	Interest in Biology: May use the ability of the ship's surgeon once per game.
73-76	Great Construction: If the ship is sunk, roll a Skill Test. If passed, consider the ship as having Struck its Colours instead.
77-80	Exotic Pets: The crew's animals join in the fight. Add 1D10 during boarding actions.
81-84	Covered in Barnacles: When moving at Battle or Full Sails, reduce its Rate of Knots by 1". Add 2 Ship Points to its total.
85-88	Very Quirky: Roll twice on this table and apply both results to the ship. This can only be applied once. Re-roll if this is one of the two successive rolls.
89-92	Whaling Paraphernalia: +1 to grappling other ships.
93-96	Fire-Blackened Hull: While on fire, the ship takes 1D3-2 damage each activation (cannot gain Ship Points) instead of the usual 1D3.
97-00	Haunted by a Ghost: -1 to all Skill Tests. If the ship Strikes the Colours, do not roll on the Consequences Table. Instead, the ship will bring all its goods to market as normal, except in the Smuggling Run and Rival Companies scenarios (where the scenario rules apply).

RIVAL COMPANIES

By some (un)fortunate chance, two smuggling companies are using the same secluded cove to deliver their cargo. It's safe to say these rivals will exchange more than insults!

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 4' x 4' area. The wind is blowing from the south.

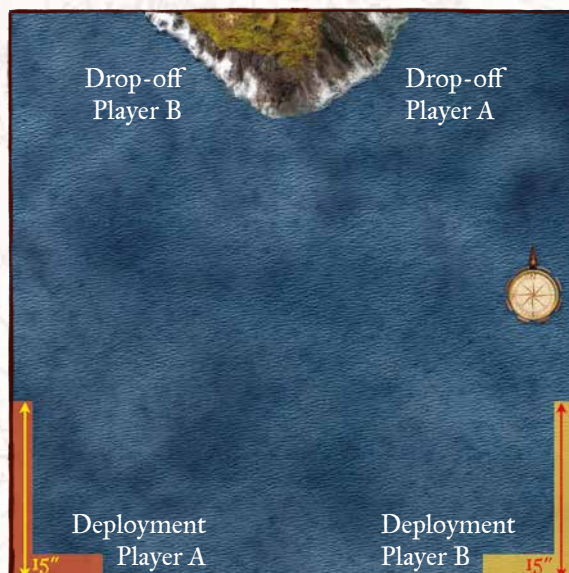
DEPLOYMENT

Randomly decide who deploys first. Then alternate positioning one ship each in the appropriate deployment zone. All ships are deployed at Battle Sails with the backs of their wakes touching the edge of the gaming area.

SPECIAL RULES

Each fleet must unload their cargo in the specified drop-off zone. To unload, a ship must be anchored within 3" (4" for Medium- and Large-sized ships) of the drop-off area at the start of its activation. Up to two TUs can be unloaded per activation per ship. In step 4, only sell what you unloaded; return the rest to the Company Warehouse.

Ships that Strike the Colours can be captured (see page 84).



For every five points of damage suffered, each ship loses one TU of cargo (the ship's owner decides which) to the murky depths. It is lost forever.

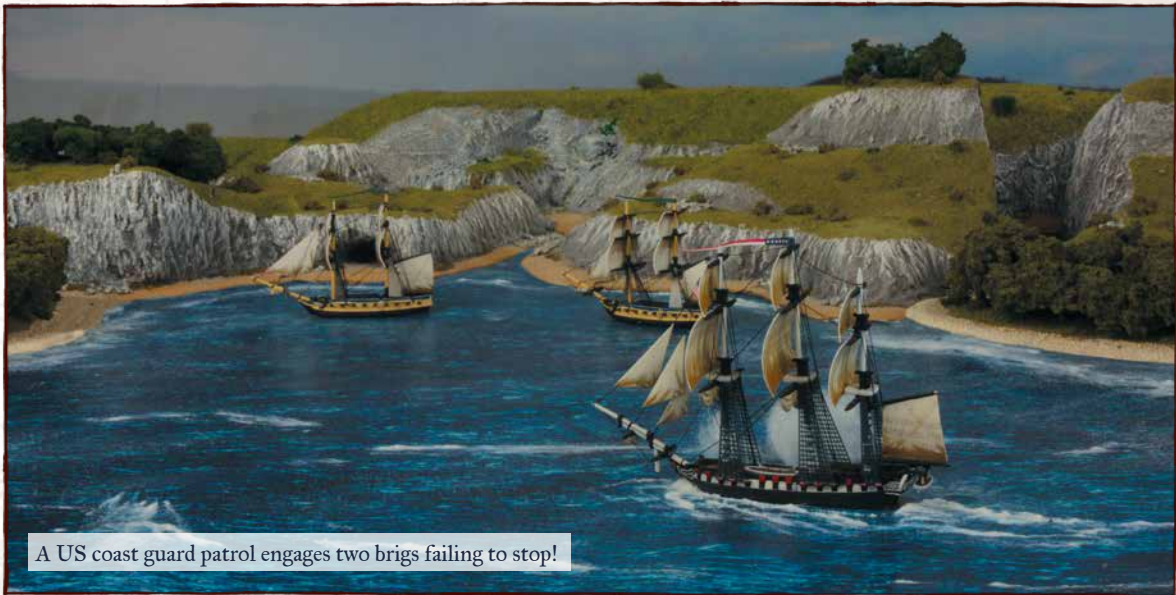
VICTORY

The company that unloads the largest number of TUs by the end of Turn 8 will be the first to market and will therefore earn an extra 10% (rounding up to the nearest £50).

Do not roll for sunk ships or ships that Strike the Colours in the post-battle Step 5. Instead, all captured ships will be transferred to the capturer. Strike them from the current company roster and add them to the roster of the company that captured the ship.

All sunk ships are lost! All other ships return to the owner's roster without any additional effects.





A US coast guard patrol engages two brigs failing to stop!

SMUGGLING RUN

All that stands between the misbegotten smugglers and a big payday is the coastal patrol. On land, hooded lanterns blink against inky blackness – the signal that a shore party is waiting.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 4' x 3' area. The wind is blowing from the south.

DEPLOYMENT

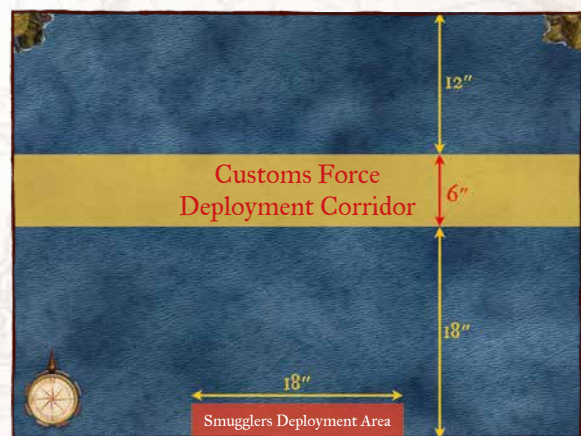
Deploy the customs force in the 6" wide yellow deployment corridor, sailing with Battle Sails. Deploy the smuggler's fleet in the red deployment area, also at Battle Sails, with the backs of their wakes touching the table edge.

SPECIAL RULES

It is the dead of night and all shooting rolls suffer -1. Visibility is a problem, so no target can be accurately fired upon when outside 14". Any ship beyond that cannot be targeted.

Additionally, all Customs ships must keep within their deployment corridor (unless manoeuvring to reverse their course), sailing at their initial speed until a Customs ship activates while at least one enemy ship is within 14".

The goods must be unloaded. A ship must be within 3" (4" for Medium- and Large-sized ships)

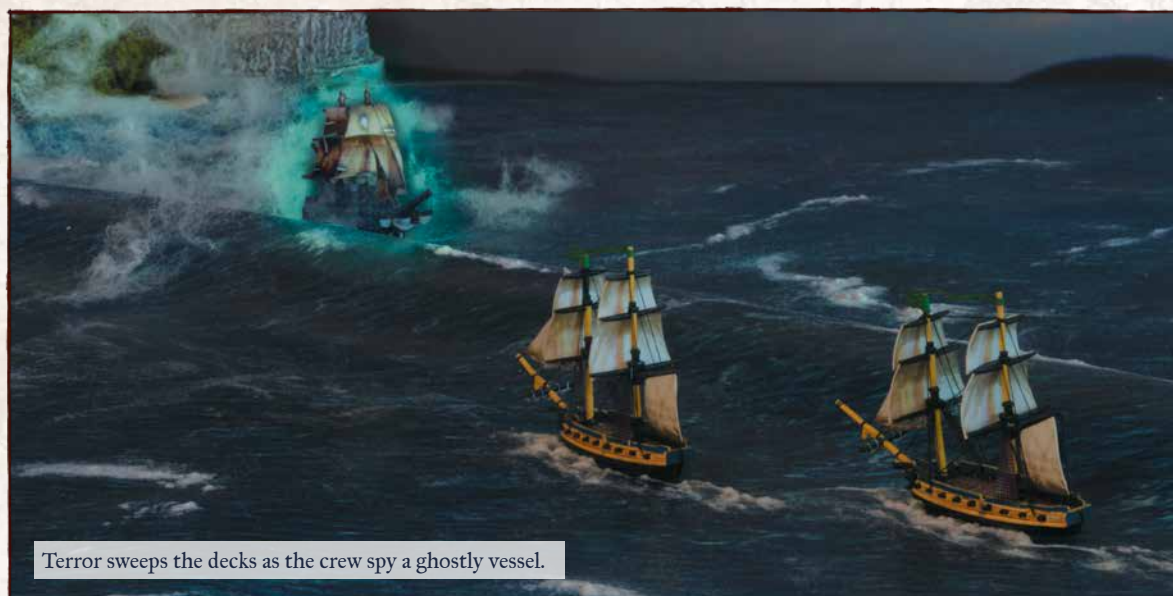


of any land and Anchored at the start of its activation to unload up to 2 TUs of cargo per Turn.

VICTORY

The game lasts 8 Turns, or until every TU has been unloaded or lost.

There are no Victory Conditions. Instead, the company will sell all TUs unloaded during the scenario for 50% more (for example, Iron would be sold for £300 instead of £200). All other goods are sold as normal.



Terror sweeps the decks as the crew spy a ghostly vessel.

HAUNTED COVE

The company needs to unload its cargo, but the chosen destination hides an ancient horror.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 4' x 3' area. The wind is blowing from the south.

DEPLOYMENT

Deploy the customs force in the 8" wide yellow deployment corridor, sailing with Battle Sails.

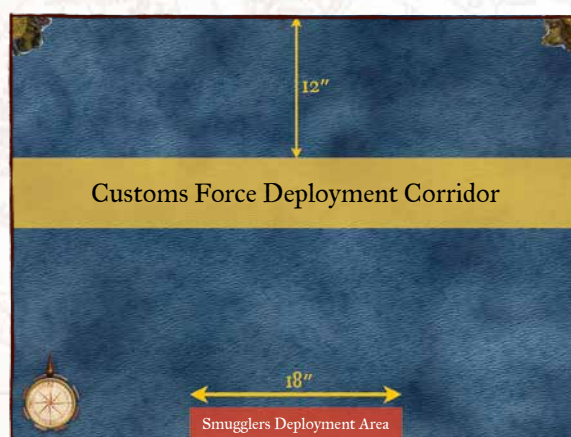
Deploy the smuggler's fleet in the red deployment area, also at Battle Sails, with the backs of their wakes touching the table edge.

SPECIAL RULES

At the beginning of Turn 2, place a Ghost Ship in the yellow corridor entering on the eastern edge of the map. Use the rules on page 93 of this supplement.

During this scenario, all ships suffer the quirk Horrific Curse, found on page 13.

In this scenario, the customs force is taken by surprise. They can sail and turn as normal, but because the seamen are scrambling to their positions, they can only shoot from Turn 2 onwards.



The goods must be unloaded. A ship must be within 3" (4" for Medium- and Large-sized ships) of land and Anchored at the start of its activation to unload up to 2 TUs of cargo per Turn.

VICTORY

The game lasts 8 Turns or until every TU has been unloaded or lost. There are no Victory Conditions. Instead, the company will sell all unloaded TUs during the scenario for 50% more (for example, Iron would be sold for £300 instead of £200). All other goods as sold as normal.

LIEUTENANT TO ADMIRAL

The career of a seaman in the late 18th century could be as hard as it was exhilarating. This campaign explores the potential career path of a young officer in the Navy.

Lieutenant to Admiral can be played as a campaign in which players gather Tournament Points. However, because it has a finite number of Turns, it is better suited to be played as a simple tournament over one or two intense days. It is intended for a larger group of players. The winner is the player with the most Tournament Points at the end of the fourth Turn.

Tournament Points can also be used to pair up players in all the Turns by using a Swiss-style system. Using this method, not all players will compete against all others, but opponents are determined in forthcoming games based on the results of the previous

ones. Only the match-ups used in the first round are random.

An interesting extension to Lieutenant to Admiral is that it could be used to play a game of *Black Powder* between the third and fourth Turns, using the accumulated Tournament Points to provide one regiment for each point. If this is done, additional Tournament Points can be awarded based on who wins (i.e., 0 for a draw, 1 for a minor win and 2 for a major win).

At the end of the campaign, the player with the most Tournament Points is declared the winner.



A Royal Navy line returns fire on a French convoy.

TURN I – THE FIRST COMMAND

The captain of the frigate you are serving on has been taken ill and is currently indisposed. As first lieutenant, it is up to you to take charge of the small fleet of vessels on this journey: a frigate and two unrated ships escorting a small merchant.

All players start by commanding a small fleet made up of one Frigate, two Brigs, and one Small Merchant ship. They must bring home the cargo stowed in the merchant at all costs. They must also potentially commandeer the valuable resources guarded by the enemy.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 4' x 4' area. The wind is blowing from the south.

DEPLOYMENT

Randomly decide who deploys first. Then alternate positioning one ship at a time in the appropriate deployment zone. All ships are deployed at Battle Sails with the backs of their wakes touching the edge of the battle area.

SPECIAL RULES

Each merchant ship must exit the battle area in the opposite corner from where they entered. Also, each merchant ship has three loot counters (place them on the respective ship card).

For every 5 points of damage suffered, each ship will lose one loot counter into the murky depths. It is lost forever. The merchant ships can be captured as per the advanced rule on page 84.

Once captured, the new owner will gain all of that ship's available loot counters; however, the merchant can still lose them when taking damage.

The merchant ship will not have to roll to see if she Strikes the Colours again unless she



takes further damage. Do not use any other Advanced Rules from the *Black Seas* rulebook.

VICTORY

As soon as both merchants are out of play (either by leaving the Battle Area, striking their colours, or being sunk), the game ends immediately.

Each of the loot tokens that safely exited on the opposite corner amounts to 1 Tournament Point. Each loot token captured from the opponent's merchant is worth 2 Tournament Points.

"Before this time tomorrow, I shall have gained a Peerage or Westminster Abbey."

Nelson on the eve of the Battle of the Nile, 1798

TURN 2 – MASTER & COMMANDER

After some time spent on half pay, you are now at the helm of your own frigate. You have joined forces with a small fleet to hunt down the enemy.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 4' x 3' area.



DEPLOYMENT

Place a small number of islands, sand banks and rocks around the battle area (alternately placing items of scenery until each player is happy with the arrangement).

There are two fleets, each consisting of three 5th Rate Frigates with Regular crew and up to 200 points of any unrated ship that does not have Veteran crews. All ships begin with Battle Sails.

Randomly decide which fleet will deploy first, then deploy the entire fleet with their wake markers touching the northern edge of the table. Next, deploy the opposing fleet with their wake markers touching the southern edge of the table.

After deployment, roll 1D6 to determine where the wind is coming from: on a result of 1–3, the wind is blowing from the west; on a result of 4–6, it is gusting from the east.

SPECIAL RULES

In this scenario you can capture enemy ships as per the advanced rule on page 84.

Use the following other Advanced Rules from the *Black Seas* rulebook: Fire as She Bears and Sailing in Lines.

VICTORY

The game finishes at the end of Turn 9 or as soon as half the ships of one fleet have either sunk or Struck the Colours.

Players receive 1 Tournament Point for each unrated ship damaged and 2 for each Frigate damaged. These points are doubled if the ship is sunk and tripled if the ship is captured.



Royal Navy Captain in undress uniform, Revolutionary Wars (1793–1802), by Steve Noon © Osprey Publishing. Taken from *Warrior 131: Nelson's Officer & Midshipmen*

TURN 3 – POST CAPTAIN

In this Campaign Turn and after the players have been paired up, the player with the most Campaign/Tournament Points will be the invader. In case of a tie, roll a dice to see who is the invader.

INVADER: You have progressed in your career and are now in command of a mighty 74-gun ship! You have the delicate task of beginning a secret invasion, the first step of which is to land a key contingent of troops on enemy soil!

DEFENDER: You have progressed in your career and are now in command of a mighty 74-gun ship! You have the formidable task of heading off an invasion into your lands with only a small force at your disposal.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 6' x 4' area, with the wind blowing from the north.

DEPLOYMENT

The invader deploys a fleet built to 1,000 points on the western edge, sailing in three lines, with the rear ships' wake markers touching the edge of the battle area. In addition, deploy one Large and one Small Merchant ship within the attacker's fleet (representing troop-carrying vessels). These have no cannons and therefore cannot shoot.

The defender will deploy a fleet built to 1,000 points in the red deployment zone, with their wake markers touching the southern edge of the battle area. All ships begin at Battle Sails.

Neither force can include 1st or 2nd Rates, but each must include at least one 3rd Rate. These receive the Veteran upgrade at no further cost.

SPECIAL RULES

The Large Merchant carries six troop tokens, and the Small Merchant has three. Each Turn a merchant ship spends Anchored within 4" of the islands, transfer one troop token from the merchant ship onto the island.



If a merchant is boarded, it will fight boarding actions as if the crew were Veteran. Additionally, they gain 2 extra D10s and will have the Trained Marines upgrade at no extra cost (see the *Black Seas* rulebook, page 75).

For every full 10 points of damage a merchant ship receives, remove one of its remaining troop tokens from the game.

Use the Advanced Rule Awe and Fear. Also, if two ships began the game with a difference of more than 10 Ship Points between them, the smaller ship may never attempt to board the larger one.

VICTORY

The game finishes at the end of Turn 10. Alternatively, it will end when all available troop tokens are either on the island or have been removed from play.

The invader gains 1 Tournament Point for each successfully landed troop token. The defender gains 1 Tournament Point for every two troop tokens the invader has lost.

Optionally, for an extra 5 Tournament Points each, play a game of *Black Powder* using the following forces: Each side begins with two

infantry units each, +200 points for every token landed/prevented from landing.

The victor of this *Black Powder* game will receive 5 Tournament Points if it was a Major Victory and 2 if it was a Minor Victory. This is in addition to the 5 points gained for playing.

TURN 4 – WITH GREAT POWER...

By now, you are a veteran of the seas and have at your command the best that the Navy has to offer. All that remains is to engage the enemy in the open seas and bring home a great victory!

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 6' x 4' battle area, with the initial wind direction determined randomly.

DEPLOYMENT

The two fleets should be built to 1,800 points per side, plus 100 points for every 10 full Tournament Points accumulated. Each player takes turns deploying one of their ships until all ships are deployed. Each ship is at Battle Sails and is deployed with the back of its wake marker touching either the edge of the battle area or the bow of a friendly ship. No ship can be deployed further than 12" from their own table edge.

SPECIAL RULES

After both fleets have deployed, roll 1D6 to determine wind direction: on a result of 1–3, the wind is blowing from the west; on a result of 4–6, it is coming from the east.

If two ships begin the game with a difference of more than 10 Ship Points between them, the smaller ship may never attempt to board the larger one. Use the following Advanced Rules from the *Black Seas* rulebook: Fire as She Bears, Sailing in



Lines, Initial Broadside, Damaged Ships, Musket Fire, Rules of Engagement, and Awe and Fear.

VICTORY

The game finishes at the end of Turn 15 or when half of one fleet's ships have sunk or surrendered. Calculate victory points as follows. For each ship that suffered more than half its Ship Points in damage:

- Unrated – 1 point
- 5th, 4th, or 6th Rate – 2 points
- 3rd Rate – 3 points
- 1st Rate – 5 points

For each ship sunk or disabled (either having Struck the Colours or no crew), double the values listed above.

SCENARIOS

Presented here are several more scenarios to add to the ones described in the *Black Seas* rulebook.

CAT AND MOUSE

A British frigate is patrolling a specific stretch of sea to protect a frequently used merchant lane. This action is hampering the efforts of a couple of French privateers, who have decided to work together and eliminate the obstacle.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 4' x 3' area. The wind is blowing from the west.

DEPLOYMENT

Randomly decide who will sail the Frigate and who will control the two privateer Brigs.

Place the 5th Rate Frigate in the specified area on the north edge of the table, then place the two Brigs in the specified area on the south edge.

All ships are sailing with Battle Sails. The back of their wake counters must touch the table edge.



SPECIAL RULES

The crews of both Brigs and the Frigate are Regular. The French privateers are trained in grappling targets. They gain +2 to the Skill Test when attempting to grapple.

VICTORY

The British Frigate wins if it disables at least one Brig and inflicts at least 10 points of damage to the other. The French Brigs win if they sink or disable the British Frigate.

The game will last until either one of the victory conditions is met or until the end of Turn 6, in which case the game is a draw.



British 44
Gun Razeed

SHIPWRECK

A Merchant ship full of treasure and carrying important dignitaries has hit a submerged reef and is sinking. The passengers and the cargo must be saved – or illegitimately taken.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 3' x 4' area. The wind is blowing from the east.

DEPLOYMENT

Place a model in the middle of the board to represent the wreck of a 3rd Rate ship. Place three troop counters, three loot counters and three rocks scattered evenly around the model.

Both attacker and defender deploy 900 points on opposing sides of the board, sailing with Battle Sails and with their wakes touching the edge of the table. Take turns to deploy one ship per side until all ships are deployed.

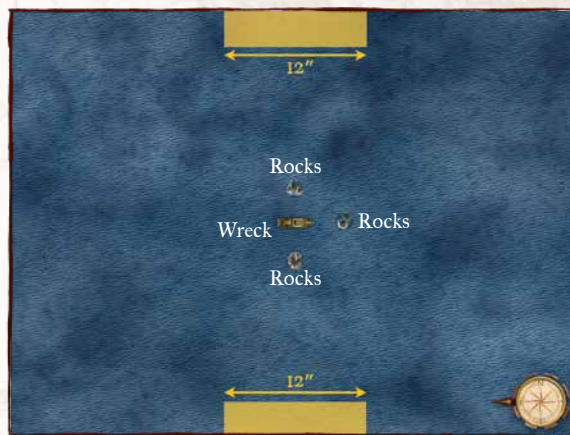
SPECIAL RULES

At the start of every Turn (including the first), and if there are more than four counters in the water, roll 1D10 for each counter still in the water. On a roll of 1 or 2, remove the counter from play.

Both fleets need to save or capture as many troop and loot counters as possible. To take a counter, a ship must sail within 1" of it while using Light Sails. Place it on the ship card of the capturing vessel.

Whenever a ship carrying counters takes damage of 5 points or more, it must drop a counter into the sea. Whenever a ship carrying counters loses a boarding action, it must surrender a counter to the ship that won the action (In this case, place the lost token onto the card of the winning ship).

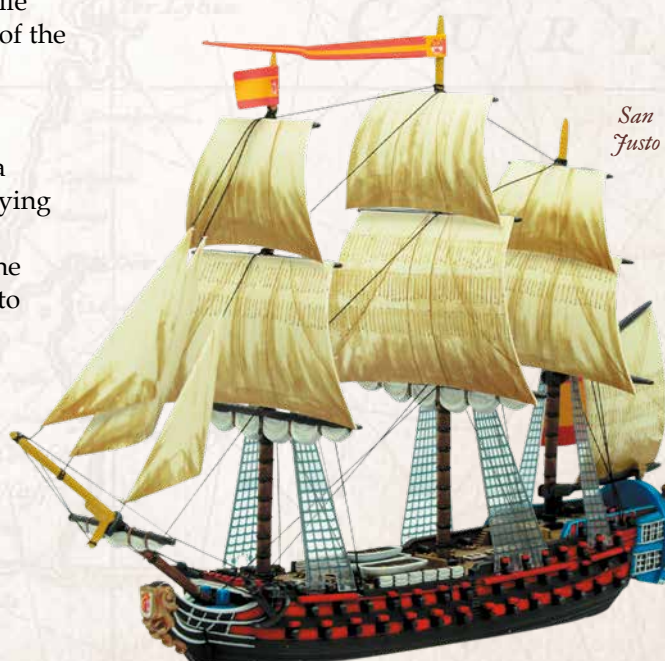
To permanently secure a counter, a ship must leave the gaming area via the edge it first deployed on.



VICTORY

The game finishes at the end of Turn 8 or when ships carrying a total of at least four counters have left the battle area.

The player who secured the most counters via their starting edge is the winner. If both players secure the same number of counters, then the player with the most counters on their ship cards is the winner. If this number is equal, the game is a draw.



FIRE SHIPS!

As a preliminary move in a full-blown attack, the enemy has sent fire ships against an unsuspecting anchored fleet. The alarm is raised and all hands scramble to repel the assault.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 6' x 4' area.

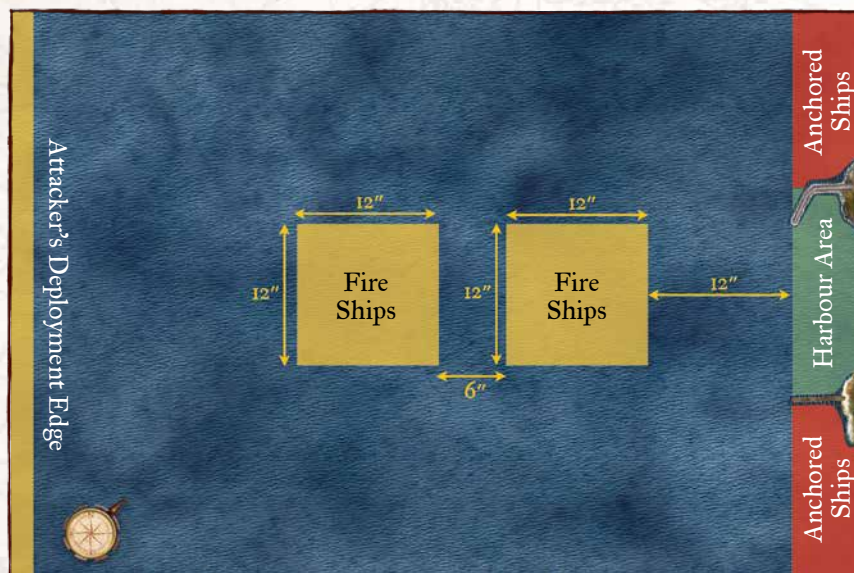
The wind is blowing from the southwest.

DEPLOYMENT

The defender places three 3rd Rate ships with Regular crews and no upgrades within the harbour area as marked on the diagram.

Additionally, place a shore gun emplacement on each terrain marker and a further 600 points of Anchored ships anywhere within the red zones.

The attacker places three Fire Ships sailing with Battle Sails in each of the central square areas (for a total of six Fire Ships altogether) and a further 1,200 points of ships sailing with Battle Sails, with the backs of their wake markers touching the western edge of the board.



SPECIAL RULES

Use the Advanced Rules for Fire Ships, Awe and Fear, and Land Fortifications in this scenario.

Every Fire Ship that reaches the harbour area or a terrain marker will sink on impact and disable the closest shore gun.

VICTORY

The game finishes at the end of Turn 10 or when half a fleet's ships have either Struck the Colours or sunk. Calculate victory points as follows For each damaged ship (i.e., less than half Ship Points):

- Unrated (except Fire Ships) – 1 point
- 4th, 5th, or 6th Rate – 2 points
- 3rd Rate – 3 points
- 1st Rate – 5 points

For each ship disabled or sunk, double the valued listed above.

Each Fire Ship sunk will give 1 point to the defending player while each disabled shore gun will gives 3 points to the attacking player.

The player with the most victory points wins.



TRADE ROUTES

Merchant trade routes were sometimes used simultaneously by different warring parties. In this scenario, two opposing escorts and their precious cargo ships cross paths.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 4' x 3' area. The wind is blowing from the south.

DEPLOYMENT

The two fleets are of equal strength. Both are composed of: two Large Merchant ships, one Frigate, and three Brigs, all with Regular crews. Randomly decide who goes first.

The first player places two merchant ships in the middle of their chosen deployment zone, both sailing with Battle Sails and with the wake of the first ship touching the edge of the table and the wake of the second touching the bow of the first. The player then places the rest of their fleet anywhere in the deployment zone with all ships sailing with Battle Sails.

The opposing player then does the same on the opposite side of the board.

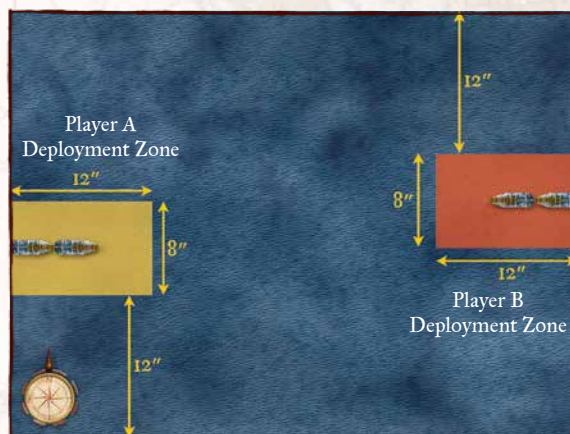
SPECIAL RULES

Place three loot counters on each merchant ship's ship card. The crews of all merchant ships are Inexperienced, while the crews of all other ships are Regular.

Merchant ships may throw one loot counter overboard to add 1 additional point to their Rate of Knots. Remove the loot counter from the ship card and place it in the sea next to the merchant where it was dumped.

For every 10 points of damage suffered, a merchant ship loses one loot counter. Remove a counter and dump it in the same way described above. In this instance, however, the merchant does not add 1 point to their Rate of Knots due to the weight lost being substituted by water leaking in.

Loot counters floating in the sea can be retrieved by any vessel sailing with Light Sails. The ship in question must come into contact with the loot counter and succeed at a Skill Test,



adding +2 to the result if it isn't a merchant ship. Ships retrieving loot from the sea cannot shoot during their activation.

Any ship that is not a merchant can only contain a maximum of two loot counters.

VICTORY

The game lasts until the end of Turn 10 or until at least four loot counters have been taken out of the gaming area by a ship. A player gains 1 victory point for each loot counter that leaves the gaming area on the opposite side of their initial deployment zone. The player with the most victory points is the winner.



AN IMPORTANT PASSENGER

A noble lady, dignitary, or spy is travelling home from the Colonies on a merchant convoy. Having got wind of this, a squadron of privateers closes in to kidnap the passenger for ransom.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 3' x 4' area. The wind is blowing from the southwest.

DEPLOYMENT

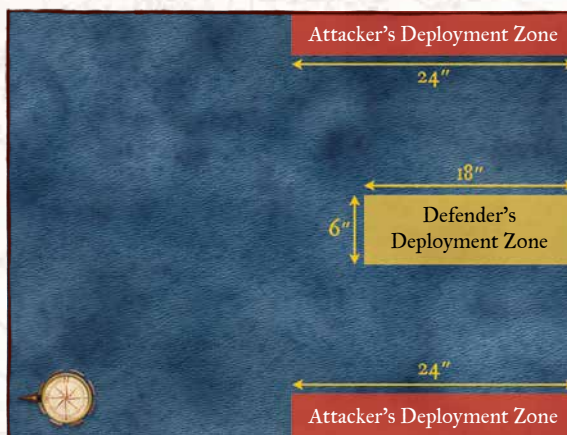
The defender places three large merchant ships in a line in the yellow deployment zone, sailing at battle Sails.

The attacker then deploys six Brigs. This player may place any number of the Brigs in each of the red deployment zones, sailing with Battle Sails and their wakes touching the edge of the table.

SPECIAL RULES

One of the merchant ships has a Veteran crew while the other two have Inexperienced crews. Three of the Brigs have Veteran crews and three have Regular crews. All Brigs have the Privateer upgrade.

If the attacking player initiates a boarding action with a merchant who has Struck the Colours, they gain a loot counter representing the passenger, if she was on board.



The defender secretly writes down which merchant ship the passenger is on. If the passenger is currently located on a Brig, a defender's ship can win her back by successfully boarding that Brig. If the ship carrying the passenger is sunk, she drowns and the game ends in a draw.

Use the Advanced Rule Damaged Ships.

VICTORY

The game will last until the end of Turn 6. Alternatively, it will end if the passenger's ship leaves the battle area or the passenger drowns.

The attacker will win if a Brig leaves the gaming area with the passenger on board. The defender will win if the passenger is on a defender's ship when it leaves the board via the western edge. In any other instance, the game is a draw.



"Goals are set in stone; but plans are set in sand."

Unknown

BERMUDA TRIANGLE

You encounter the enemy in a mysterious and dangerous area filled with unexplained phenomena. Despite the terror, you attempt to stay and fight!

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 6' x 4' area. The wind is blowing from the east.

DEPLOYMENT

Each side deploys 1,000 points of ships in a line, parallel to one another on opposite sides of the board. Both of these lines are westward bound.

Place one Megalodon in the central circle, as shown on the map. If a Megalodon is killed or scared away, place a new Megalodon in a random unoccupied area at the start of the next Turn, after rolling for the wind.

SPECIAL RULES

This scenario uses the Sea Creatures rules on page 90 of this supplement.

Other than sharks, only one Terror of the Deep can be on the board at the same time.

If there is no Terror of the Deep out at the beginning of a round, roll 1D10 to see if one appears (see the table, right). If it does, roll a further 1D6 to see where it appears. Place the Terror in the correct area of the board and activate it immediately as per the rules on page 90 of this supplement.

VICTORY

Calculate victory points as follows.

Damaged ship (less than half Ship Points) and enemy ships that leave the area:

- Unrated – 1 point
- 4th or 6th Rate – 2 points



Terrors of the Deep Table

Score	Result
1-3	Nothing happens
4-5	White Whale appears
6	Sea Serpent appears
7	Megalodon appears
8	Ghost Ship appears
9	Leviathan appears
10	Kraken appears

- 3rd Rate – 3 points
- 1st or 2nd Rate – 5 points
- Disabled or Sunk ships: Double the points for damaged ship.
- Sea Serpent or Megalodon killed (not scared away) – 3 points
- Leviathan or Kraken killed (not scared away) – 5 points
- Sharks and White Whales – no points

The player with the most victory points is the winner.

THE BATTLE OF LAKE ERIE

A battle for the control of one of the US lakes, which was strategically very important. It was one of the biggest naval battles to take place during the War of 1812.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 4' x 4' area. The wind is blowing from the southwest.

DEPLOYMENT

The British deploy three Sloops, one Brig, and two Schooners, all with Regular crews, in a line in the northern deployment zone. The US deploy one Brig with Veteran crew as well as one Sloop, two Brigs, and five Schooners with Regular crews, all sailing in a line in the southern deployment zone.

All ships start at Battle Sails.

SPECIAL RULES

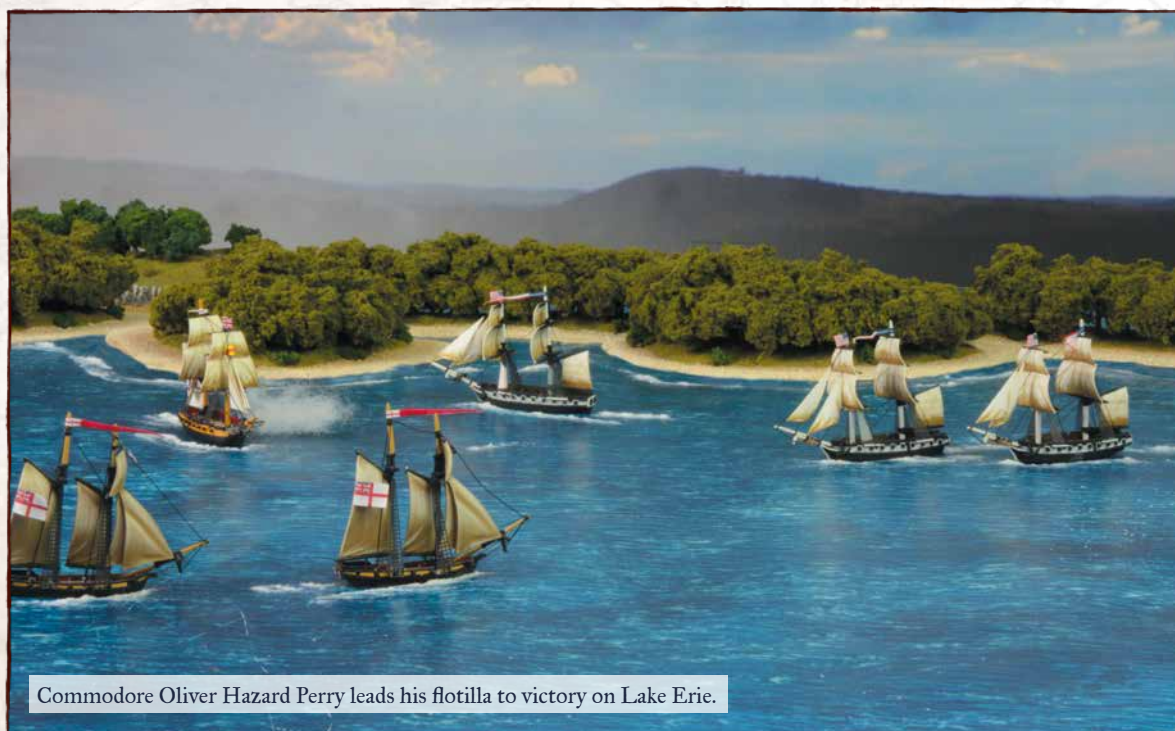
Use the Advanced Rules for Sailing in Lines and Capturing Ships.

As soon as a vessel's Ship Points dip below their Break Point, they will automatically Strike the Colours.



VICTORY

The game finishes at the end of Turn 8. Each player scores 2 victory points for each enemy ship that has Struck the Colours and an additional 1 victory point for each ship captured. The player with the most victory points is the winner.



Commodore Oliver Hazard Perry leads his flotilla to victory on Lake Erie.

*"Wherever wood can swim, there I am
sure to find this flag of England."*

Attributed to Napoleon Bonaparte, 1815



French
3rd Rate

THE MACAU INCIDENT

A Franco-Spanish fleet attempts to disrupt a British escort and prevent it from reaching and escorting a merchant convoy.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 3' x 4' area. The wind is blowing from the east.

DEPLOYMENT

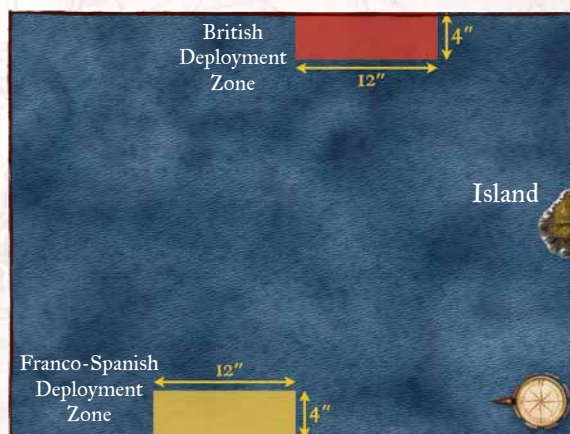
The British player deploys two Small 3rd Rate ships with Veteran crews and one Frigate with Regular crew in the northern deployment zone. They also deploy two Large Merchants at anchor within 5" of the island.

The Franco-Spanish player deploys two Large Spanish 3rd Rate ships, two Spanish 5th Rate Frigates, and two French Frigates in the southern zone, all with Regular crews. All non-merchant ships start sailing at Battle Sails, with the backs of their wakes touching the respective table edges.

SPECIAL RULES

Use the National Special rules found on page 76 of the *Black Seas* rulebook.

A British merchant may set sail as soon as it is within 8" of any British (non-merchant) escort.



VICTORY

The game ends when both merchants are out of play, either by leaving the board or being sunk or disabled.

The British win if both merchant ships exit the area on the western edge with at least one escort ship.

The Franco-Spanish win if they sink or disable both merchants. Any other outcome is considered a draw.



The Greek fleet fighting to prevent the Ottomans from passing through.

AMBUSH

Greek independence fighters used large fleets of small ships amongst the Greek islands to ambush small Ottoman squadrons, aiming to isolate and surround individual ships. Often, they would target the lead warship with fire ships.

BATTLE AREA

On a 4' x 3' table, place two islands anywhere off-centre. The wind is blowing from the east.

DEPLOYMENT

The Ottoman player deploys one 3rd Rate ship with Regular crew and two Frigates, one with Regular crew and the other with Inexperienced crew, anywhere within 12" of the table's centre, sailing in any direction.

The Greek independence fighters' player deploys two Fire Ships, two Gunboat squadrons and five unrated ships (any mix of Brigs, Schooners, Xebecs, and Galleys) on either long table edge (the fleet may be divided into two for deployment). All crews are Regular and all ships begin at Battle Sails.

SPECIAL RULES

The aim of the Ottoman player is to escape with minimum damage. All three ships must leave the table by the same edge.



VICTORY

Ottoman player: All ships must leave the game area by the same table edge.

Greek independence fighters' player: Capture, sink, or Strike the Colours of all the Ottoman player's ships.

All other results are considered a draw.

GUNBOAT WARS

The Royal Dano-Norwegian Navy used fleets of oared gunboats to mob becalmed warships and British merchants.

BATTLE AREA

On a 4' x 3' table, place two islands anywhere off-centre. The wind is blowing from the east.

DEPLOYMENT

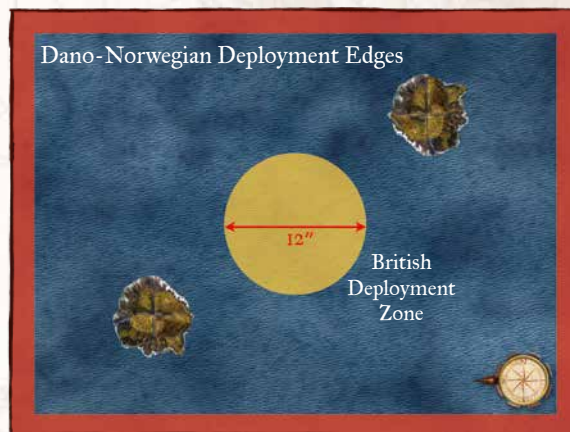
The British player deploys either: 1) between one and three Frigates, or 2) two Brigs in place of one frigate, anywhere within 12" of the table centre, sailing in any direction at Light Sails.

The Dano-Norwegian player deploys six Gunboat squadrons for each Frigate or every two Brigs, each with Regular crews. They may be deployed along any table edge.

SPECIAL RULES

All Gunboat squadrons use the Squadrons Advanced Rule (page 34 of the *Black Seas* rulebook). Additionally, they can opt to move twice during their activation and turn up to two times after each movement. However, they cannot shoot if they do this.

The wind is weak in this scenario, with a high chance of dropping to Becalmed. When rolling for wind direction, any doubled numbers result



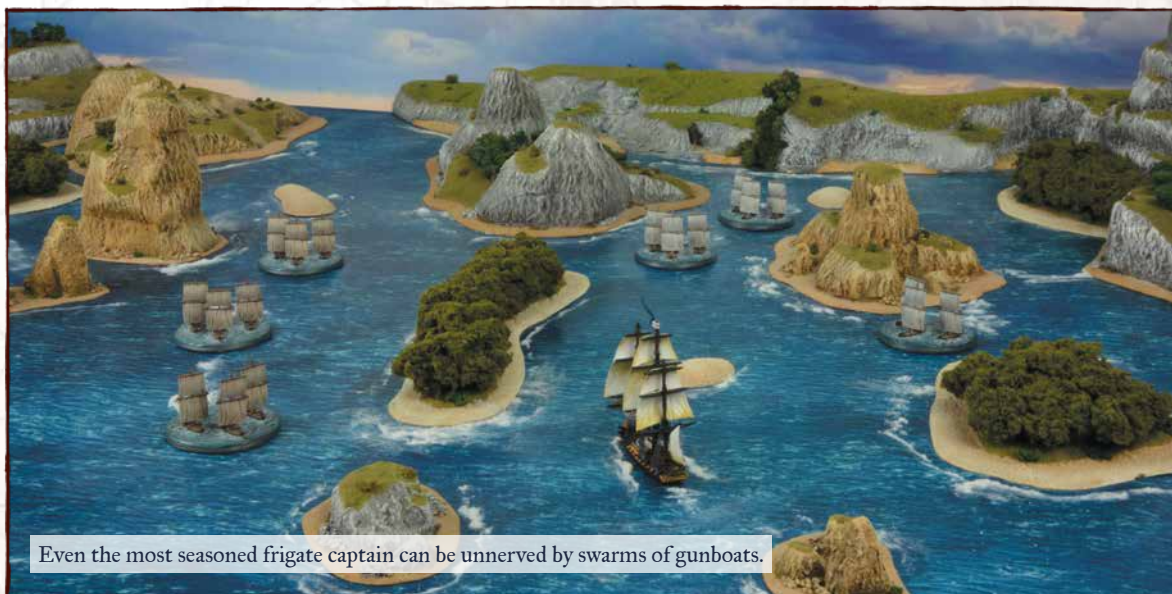
in Becalmed. In addition, no ship may move faster than Battle Sails.

The game is played until one of the Victory Conditions is met.

VICTORY

The British player wins if three or more Gunboat Squadrons are sunk.

The Dano-Norwegian player wins if any of the British player's ships are captured, sunk, or Strike the Colours.



Even the most seasoned frigate captain can be unnerved by swarms of gunboats.

ISLAND CHASE

The Swedish and Russian Coastal Fleets fought many battles in the narrow channels around Finland. Similarly, the Ottomans fought both Russian and Greek coastal squadrons amongst the islands of the Aegean and the Black Sea coast.

BATTLE AREA

On a 4' x 3' table, place a series of channels and narrows bounded by islands, shallows, and perhaps a coastline on one or two table edges. It may be helpful to ask a neutral party to do this.

Alternatively, both players can opt to place four hazards each, alternating one at a time. The wind is blowing from the east.

DEPLOYMENT

For the competing fleets, use only Small or Tiny ships such as Brigs, Cutters, Schooners, Galleys, or Small Xebecs and Gunboat Squadrons (some only with sails, some also having oars).

Player A can have any four Small (unrated) ships, but only two can be of the same type. Instead of placing their ships on the battle area, they instead place six activation markers anywhere on the battle area, at least 6" apart, measured as the crow flies. Two of these are 'blinds' and the other four represent ships; Player A should make a secret note of which token represents each ship. Player B will not know which is which. All ships begin as Anchored.

Player B deploys one 5th Rate Frigate and two Small (unrated) ships, which must be different types, on the eastern table edge.

All crews are Regular.



SPECIAL RULES

Spotting: Whenever an activated ship has line of sight to one of the six placed activation markers, that token is removed and, if appropriate, replaced with the correct ship model.

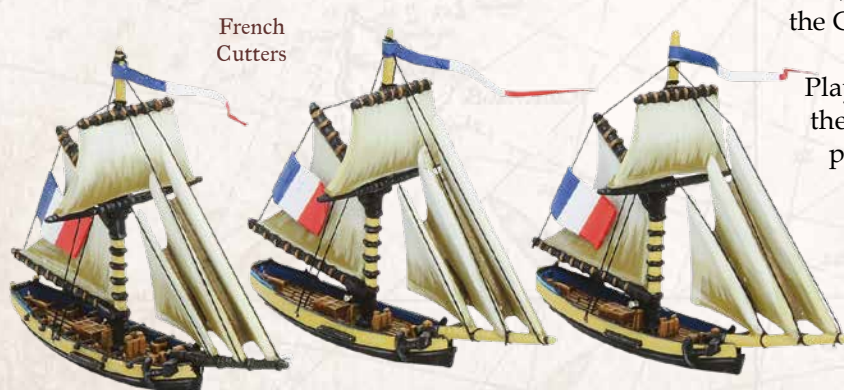
Activation: When one of the six placed activation markers is the next (potential) ship to activate in Weather Gage order, Player A can either choose to activate or pass. In effect, if the marker represents a hidden ship, that ship misses its Turn but remains hidden.

VICTORY

The game lasts 10 Turns or until the victory conditions are met.

Player A wins if Player B's Frigate is sunk, captured, or Strikes the Colours.

Player B wins if, at any point in the game, the Frigate is still in play and the total Ship Points for Player A's fleet fall below half their original.



MUTINY

Though unusual, it wasn't unheard of for a crew to mutiny against its captain when it felt a combat wasn't going as planned or where loyalties were divided, as was the case during the War of Brazilian Independence against the Portuguese.

BATTLE AREA

Use a 6' x 4' table, set up in any agreed way. If no agreement can be reached, combat takes place in the open sea.

DEPLOYMENT

The attacker deploys a fleet of 1,500 points along the western edge.

The defender deploys a fleet of 1,000 points along the eastern edge.

All the defender's crews are Regular. One of the attacker's crews must be Veteran; this is the flagship vessel. All the other crews are Inexperienced. Consider this during fleet point calculation.

SPECIAL RULES

Mutiny: The first time any crew in the attacker's fleet fails a Skill Test, roll to see if it also mutinies. Do so by rolling 1D6 and adding the number of enemy ships nearer than a friendly ship. If the total result is exactly 6 the crew mutinies. On its next and all subsequent activations, that ship makes best possible speed towards the nearest table edge. If the total result is greater than 6, the crew goes over to the enemy. All subsequent activations of that ship are carried out by the defender.



VICTORY

The game lasts until the end of Turn 8 or until half of a fleet's ships have Struck the Colours or sunk.

Calculate victory points as follows.

- For each damaged ship (i.e., less than half Ship Points):
- Unrated – 1 point
- 4th, 5th, or 6th Rate – 2 points
- 3rd Rates – 3 points
- 1st Rate – 5 points
- For each ship disabled or sunk double the values shown above.

The player with the most victory points is the winner.

"First gain the victory and then make the best use of it you can."
Admiral Lord Nelson before the Battle of Nile, 1798

HOIST THE BLACK FLAG

It's 1610 in the Caribbean Sea and a large unguarded convoy of merchant ships has been spotted near a den of pirates. It's a free for all, but who will end the day the richest?

BATTLE AREA

On a 6' x 4' table place a quarter island in each corner of the table.

DEPLOYMENT

This game can be played by two, three, or four players. Players can choose any number of unrated ships up to 200 points, including experience and upgrades. All players' ships have the Privateer upgrade at no extra cost.

Randomly decide the sequence of play and then deploy each player's ships in order as shown on the map.

Deploy a Galleon or Large Merchant ship in the centre of the gaming area, then deploy a second between the first and the eastern table edge. Both are sailing at Battle Sails.

SPECIAL RULES

This scenario uses the Simpler Times and Capturing Ships rules from this supplement.

Pirate-on-pirate action is not only allowed but actively encouraged!

At the start of each Turn including the first, place a new merchant ship sailing at Battle

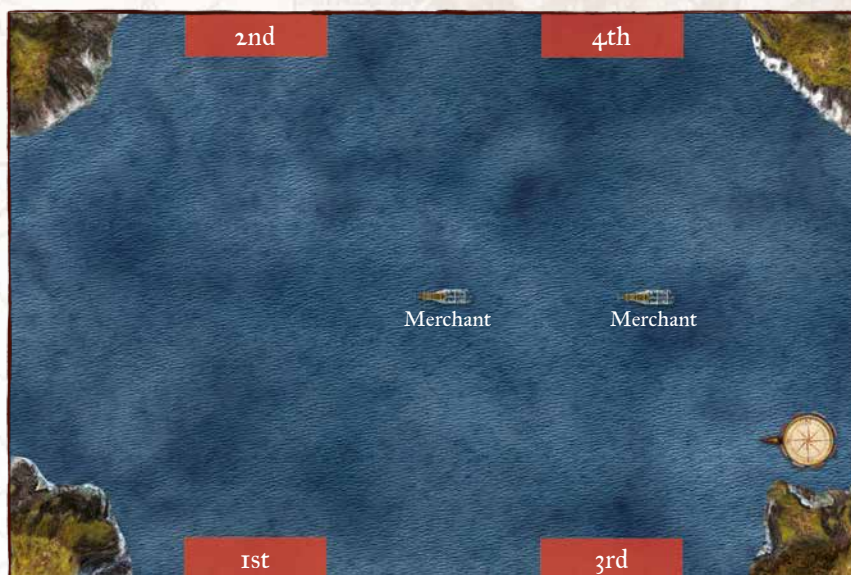


Vicious pirate fleets engage for control of the contents of fully laden merchants holds.

Sails with the back of its wake touching the eastern table edge. It should be in the same line as the other merchants. Alternate between placing a Small Merchant and a Galleon (or Large Merchant) each Turn.

After deploying the new vessel, immediately move all the merchants forward and shoot at the closest target in range (or targets, counting both broadsides on each merchant). This action takes place outside the normal sequence of play.

Once a merchant takes any damage from shooting, it will slow to Light Sail speed. If a



merchant would end its move on top of another merchant, move it forward until its wake is completely in front of the previous merchant.

As soon as a pirate wins a boarding action against a merchant, the merchant will Strike the Colours and surrender its precious cargo.

On the following activation, the pirate may disengage and sail off with all the loot. Galleons and Large Merchants have two loot counters each; Small Merchants have one.

If a pirate ship is Anchored within 5" of an island they can bury their treasure. The ship must spend one whole Turn Anchored in order to bury all its loot tokens. Pirates can only bury treasure on one island and, once loot counters have been buried, no other pirate may bury tokens on the same island.

VICTORY

At the end of Turn 6, roll 1D6. On a result of 6, the Royal Navy is spotted on the horizon and the game ends at the conclusion of the following Turn. If the Royal Navy never appears, the game ends after Turn 12.

The player with most loot tokens wins the day! Buried tokens are worth 2 points each.



RIVER BATTLE

This is based on the Battle of Shubra Khit (or Chobrakit or Chebreisse), fought in 1798 as Napoleon's forces invading Egypt worked their way up the Nile. Mameluke forces opposed them on land and on the river in two separate, simultaneous battles.

The vanguard of Napoleon's Nile fleet sailed into a narrowing section of the river, on both shores of which the Mamelukes had erected a battery of 9-pounder cannons. At least seven Mameluke gunboats (and perhaps as many as twelve) came downriver or launched from the banks to meet the French, boarding and capturing a galley and two gunboats in quick succession before a Mameluke ship exploded, causing the fleet to retreat.

BATTLE AREA

On a 4' x 3' table, place a large island or promontory in the middle of the eastern edge. Then, roughly parallel to this piece of terrain, place strips of land along both the east and western table edges to represent a narrowing of the channel. These are the riverbanks, to which the normal rules for grounding apply.

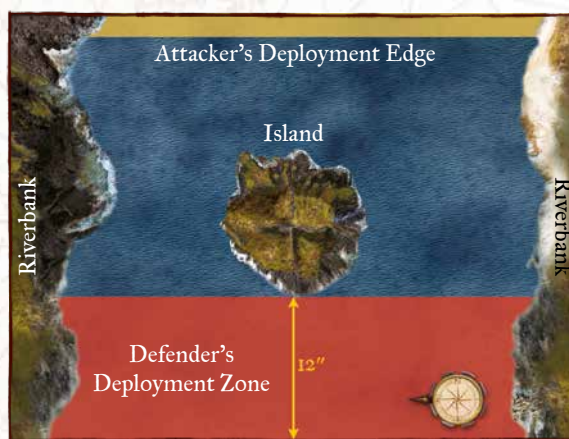
The wind is blowing from the east.

DEPLOYMENT

The defending player places two shore gun emplacements anywhere on the riverbanks. They then place eight Gunboat Squadrons anywhere in their red deployment area.

The attacking player places a Small Xebec, a Small Galley, and three Gunboat Squadrons anywhere against the northern edge of the board, at anchor.

All ships have Regular crews.



SPECIAL RULES

There are no special rules in this scenario.

VICTORY

The attacker wins if the Xebec and/or Galley manages to exit the table by the southern edge. Otherwise, the defender wins.



Napoleon's vanguard sailing up the river Nile.

ASSAULT ON A BARBARY PORT

Various nations attacked Barbary ports in a bid to stop piracy or slavery. This is a generic version of those attacks, such as those carried about by a Danish squadron led by the frigate HDMS *Najaden* against Tripoli in 1797.

BATTLE AREA

Place a coastline, roughly 4" to 6" deep, along the southern edge of a 3' x 4' battle area, with a central area of at least 10" x 6" marked out as the harbour. The harbour is deep water, so there is no risk of grounding while within it.

The defender places three target markers anywhere on land, representing the palace, the treasury, and the magazine. They also place two shore gun emplacements. Each of the targets should be at least 2" x 2" and these five items must be at least 2" away from each other and 6" from the edges of the table.

The wind is blowing from the east.

DEPLOYMENT

The defender deploys one Large Xebec or Galley, one Small Xebec or Galley, and a Brig anywhere along the coast or in the harbour.

The attacker deploys one 5th Rate Frigate, one Brig, and one Small Xebec anywhere on the northern table edge, sailing at Battle Sails.

All crews are Regular.

SPECIAL RULES

The palace and the treasury have 5 Structure Points each, whilst the magazine has 10 Structure Points. If the magazine is reduced to 0 points, it will explode and any ship, emplacement, or target marker within 6" will take D10 damage.



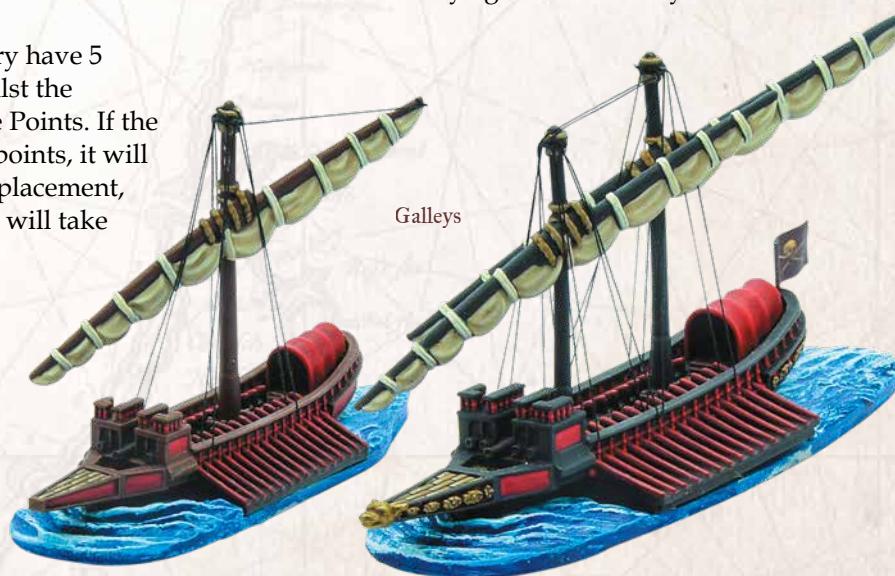
The attacker's objective is not to sink the enemy fleet, as such, but to pound the port into submission.

VICTORY

The game lasts until the end of Turn 8.

The attacker wins if the port suffers 30 or more Structure Points of damage. The defender wins if the Frigate is sunk, captured or Strikes the Colours.

If neither of these events occur, the game is a draw. The attacking vessels will withdraw to return and try again another day.



THE BATTLE OF THE NILE

In 1798, during the initial stages of the French Revolutionary War of the Second Coalition, Napoleon planned an invasion of Egypt. At that time Egypt was under Ottoman control and Napoleon desired to threaten Britain's interests in India.

Napoleon sailed across the Mediterranean with nearly 40,000 troops and landed near Alexandria on 1 July. This led to a decisive victory against the Mameluke armies protecting Cairo, leaving Napoleon dominant in Egypt.

However, the British, indeed feeling threatened by this move, decided to send a large squadron of ships of the line to hamper Napoleon's invasion plans and regain naval superiority in the Mediterranean.

After hunting the French contingent, led by Vice Admiral Francois Brueys, down across the Mediterranean, Admiral Nelson, in charge of the British force, found them anchored in Aboukir Bay on 1 August.

The bay was protected by a small peninsular and a small island to the northwest. The French had anchored parallel to the coastline, in a rough line, with their starboard sides facing seaward and their port sides facing the shore, in tight formation to prevent the British from breaking the line.

Nelson planned to attack in line against the sea-facing (starboard) sides of the French ships. However, when Captain Thomas Foley on board the lead ship, HMS *Goliath*, saw that there was sufficient space in front of the leading French ship to pass and engage the enemy on their port side, he took the initiative and went straight for the gap.

Nelson had trained his captains to be flexible and to take the initiative when opportunity

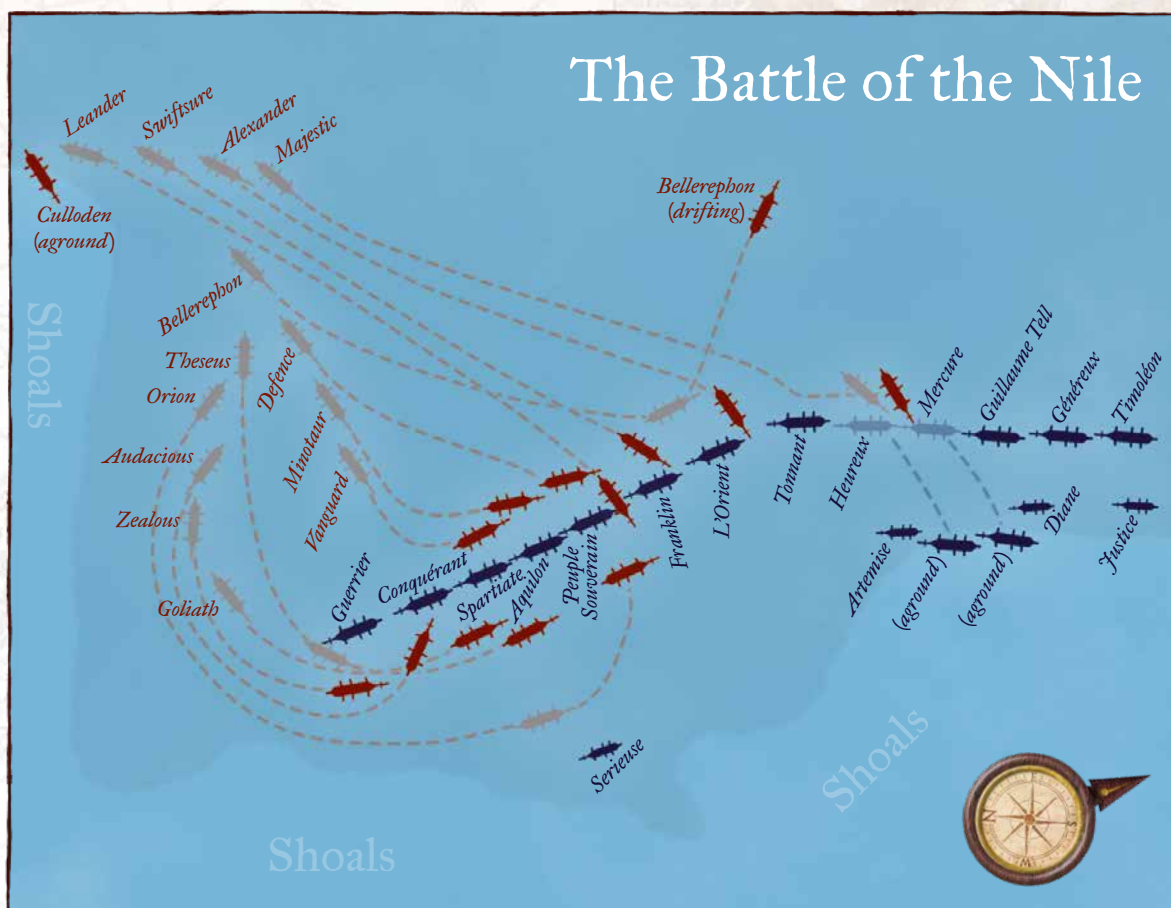
arose, which proved decisive for this battle as the next four ships followed Foley on HMS *Goliath* and copied his manoeuvre, whilst Nelson saw this and took the rest of the fleet against the French's starboard side to catch them in a deadly crossfire.

Ultimately, all but two of the French ships of the line and two frigates struck their colours or were destroyed. Famously, *L'Orient* exploded when the fire raging on its decks reached the magazine.

This made Britain the major power in the Mediterranean and meant that, without support, the French land campaign in Egypt eventually failed, encouraging other European countries to turn against France.

Historically the two opposing lines were formed as follows, with a list including ship names and number of guns. The British fleet, from the ship at the head: HMS *Goliath* (74), HMS *Zealous* (74), HMS *Audacious* (74), HMS *Orion* (74), HMS *Theseus* (74), HMS *Vanguard* (74) – which was the flagship with Nelson on board, HMS *Minotaur* (74), HMS *Swiftsure* (74), HMS *Defence* (74), HMS *Alexander* (74), HMS *Bellerophon* (74), HMS *Majestic* (74), and HMS *Leander* (74).

The French from the northern-most ship: *Guerrier* (74), *Conquérant* (74), *Spartiate* (74), *Aquilon* (74), *Peuple Souverain* (74), *Franklin* (80), *L'Orient* (124), which was the ship with Brueys on board, *Tonnant* (80), *Heureux* (74), *Mercure* (74), *Guillaume Tell* (80), *Généreux* (74), *Timoléon* (74). They also had four frigates: *Sérieuse* (36), *Artémise* (40), *Diane* (40), *Justice* (40), and several gunboats.



THE BATTLE OF THE NILE

In this *Black Seas* scenario, players are presented with decisions and significant hurdles that imbue proceedings with the specific flavour of the Battle of the Nile. The game's outcome may differ wildly from historical events, as the players should by no means feel obliged to make the same decisions as Admiral Nelson and Vice Admiral Brueys.

Before the start of the game, the British player must decide which ships to deploy immediately and which start off the board, to enter in consecutive Turns.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 6' x 4' gaming area. The wind is blowing from the north-west.

DEPLOYMENT

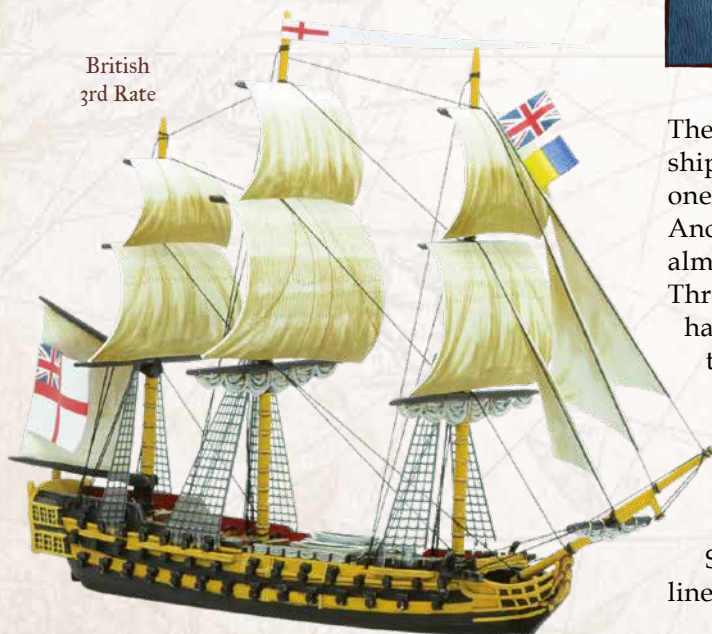
The British deploy six Large 3rd Rate ships of the line in the yellow deployment area, sailing due west at Battle Sails in a line formation. Use the Advanced Rule Sailing in Lines found on page 35 of the *Black Seas* rulebook.

At the end of each of the first three Turns, two new 3rd Rate ships are placed on the table. At the end of Turn 4, one new 3rd Rate ship is placed. All new ships are placed in the same yellow deployment area, all sailing with Battle Sails in a line of two with the back of the rearmost ship's wake touching the eastern edge of the board.

Once moved, these ships can become part of the main line. Five of the British ships have Veteran crews, the others have Regular crews.



British
3rd Rate



The French deploy twelve Large 3rd Rate ships of the line in the red deployment area, one in front of the other. These ships are all Anchored with the bowsprit of each ship almost touching the stern of the ship in front. Three have Inexperienced crew and the rest have Regular crew. *L'Orient* is deployed in the centre of the line. The French player places four 5th Rate frigates with Regular crew anywhere between the French line and the western table edge, at least 10" from the head of the French line. They also place two Gunboat Squadrons anywhere between the French line and the western table edge.

"On the whole our ships are very poorly manned, and [...] it needs much courage to command such an ill-prepared fleet."
Report to Bonaparte prior to the Battle of the Nile, 1798

SPECIAL RULES

The French did not expect to be attacked from the port, so they cannot fire a broadside facing that side until Turn 4. Furthermore, at the start of the battle they did not have their full complement of crew on board, so for the first six Turns they will shoot each broadside with one less heavy cannon and one less carronade than their full complement.

Finally, they were securely anchored, so they cannot move or turn. To weigh anchor, a ship needs to roll a successful Skill Test with a -1 modifier. As soon as the Skill Test is passed, it is free to move on that same activation. To keep track of which ship can move, use a small marker.

The scenario uses the National Special Rules, the special rules for *L'Orient*, François-Paul Brueys d'Aigalliers and Lord Admiral

Nelson, as well as the Advanced Rule, Sailing in Lines. Note that anchored ships cannot use this rule, as they are not technically sailing. Any other Advanced Rules may be implemented in this scenario, as long as all players agree to their use.

VICTORY

The game ends when at least eight ships of the line (3rd Rates or above), including both French and British ships, have Struck the Colours, been captured, or sunk.

The players gain victory points as follows: 5 victory points for every enemy 3rd Rate ship or larger that Struck the Colours, sunk, or was captured, and 1 victory point for every enemy Frigate that Struck the Colours, sunk, or was captured. The player with the most victory points is the winner.

WHAT IF?

One method of playing this scenario is to alter the odds. Players may improve one, two, or all of the limiting factors for the French player. Below are some options for changing the scenario to make it more balanced.

What if the French ships had not been at anchor? Would it have been easier to turn with the wind and attempt to meet the British in more favourable conditions? To use this option, remove all mention of ships being at anchor. This means French ships can move using normal activation rules straight away.

What if a lookout had spotted the arrival of the British and the French admiral re-called all hands before the battle? To use this option, allow French ships to shoot as normal from

all positions (except the port broadside) from the start of the game.

What if the port cannons were made ready in case British ships broke through the line? To use this option, allow the French to fire their port broadsides from the start of the game.

What if the British advance had happened a little earlier, giving the fort located on a small nearby island the opportunity to soften up the British fleet? To use this option, place an additional two French gun emplacements on the island located in the northern part of the gaming area.

Finally, a completely different option is to see what would have happened if the fleets had met at sea (as nearly occurred). Use the same fleet lists but play Scenario 12 from the *Black Seas* rulebook – Pitched Sea Battle.

Westward Ho!

By 1796, nearly every family in England had lost someone in the pestilential West Indies – a ‘cemetery turned battlefield’. However, the vast gains in colonial trade in the Caribbean bankrolled the coalitions’ wars against Napoleon and greatly expanded the British commerce that funded them. C. S. Forester’s fictional hero, Horatio Hornblower, sailed to Nicaragua for just such a cause...



‘El Supremo’ watches all who enter harbour from his fortress eyrie.



The Spanish ship *Natividad* is spotted prowling offshore.



Valuable supplies are loaded while the crew enjoy shore leave.



A Caribbean town – a welcome sight to sailors after months at sea.



‘Colour’s Aloft!’ Ships can once again safely leave port once HMS *Lydia* has defeated the *Natividad*.

BRITISH CAPTAINS OF RENOWN AND FAMOUS SHIPS

Additional National Rules

TACKLING PROFICIENCY

British sailors were well-trained and excellent all-round seamen. All Royal Navy ships receive a +1 when rolling a Skill Test for tacking.

Special Characters

THOMAS COCHRANE (1775–1860) 70 PTS

Possibly the most daring and colourful captain of the time. He started his career in the British Navy but also became the first Vice Admiral of Chile and Commander-in-Chief of the Chilean Navy, then of the Brazilian and Greek Navies. He would tackle battles head-on and, on several occasions, won against all odds.

- A ship that has Cochrane on board starts the battle with a different flag to the rest of the fleet. It cannot be targeted until after it opens fire on an enemy ship.
- A ship commanded by Cochrane gets an extra +1C when firing broadside at any ship one rate higher. It gets an extra +1C and +1H when firing on a ship two rates or more higher.
- Cochrane favoured a direct approach. Wherever possible and only if the enemy is more than 8" away from his ship, Cochrane must steer his ship towards an enemy vessel.



CAPTAIN RICHARD HALL GOWER (1768–1833) 50 PTS

An inventor, philosopher, entrepreneur and humanitarian, Captain Gower introduced several innovations to the world of naval technology. He was employed by the British East India Company.

- Captain Gower can only be used on merchant ships.
- The ship gains a Veteran crew at no cost.
- Once per activation, a ship with Gower on board can sail an extra inch.



CAPTAIN GEORGE DUFF (1764–1805)40 PTS

Captain Duff was a Scottish captain of the Royal Navy that was very strict on discipline and cleanliness. After a very successful career that saw him participate in several of the battles of the time, he was struck dead at the Battle of Trafalgar.

- +1 to all Skill Tests



Famous Ships

HMS *SPEEDY* (1782–1806)

A 14-gun brig with a very colourful history. She was captured by France in 1794, then re-taken by the British in 1795, captured again by France in 1801 and finally donated to the Papal States in 1802. Furthermore, HMS *Speedy* was one of the ships that made Thomas Cochrane famous for capturing so many enemy vessels, sometimes even those much larger than his own.

- HMS *Speedy* can be used by both Great Britain and France.
- Enemy ships targeted for shooting must re-roll successful tests to Strike the Colours.
- Boarding Actions launched from HMS *Speedy* have a +1 to the target number on the Boarding to Hit Table.

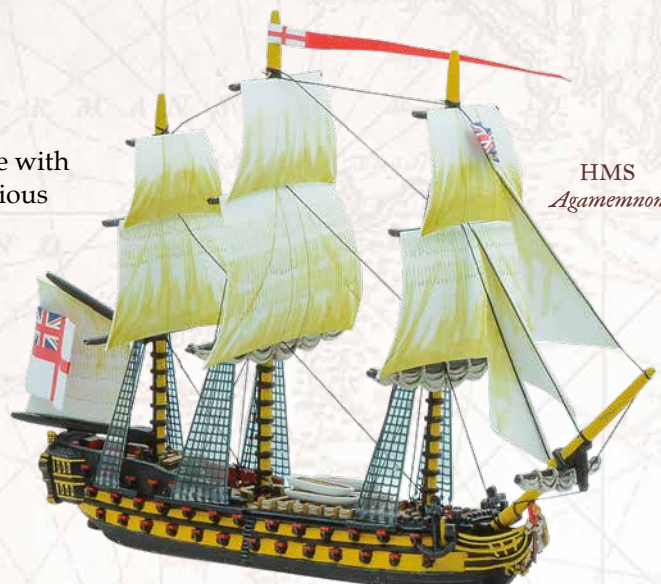
HMS *Speedy* heads a small flotilla bearing down on a French frigate.



HMS *AGAMEMNON* (1781–1809)

Known to be Lord Nelson's favourite ship, HMS *Agamemnon* was a 64-gun 3rd rate ship of the line with a sleek hull. During her life, she was often at various stages of disrepair.

- Once per activation, HMS *Agamemnon* can sail an extra inch.
- *Agamemnon* starts any game with 6 Ship Points fewer than its maximum total, which can be repaired during a game.

**HMS *COLOSSUS* (1803–1826)**

A 3rd rate, 74-gun Royal Navy ship of the line. At the Battle of Trafalgar, she engaged and disabled the *Swiftsure* and the Spanish ship *Bahama* after an exchange with the French vessel *Argonaute*.

- Colossus does not suffer any penalties for shooting her third- and fourth-gun positions.

HMS *NAIAD* (1797–1898)

A 5th rate ship that saw action in the French Revolutionary Wars as well as the Napoleonic Wars. She was very successful in capturing several enemy ships.

- A ship that rolls to Strike the Colours due to direct action of the Naiad will have to re-roll if the first roll was successful. The player must accept the second result.
- Once per game, a player may declare a repair action on the Naiad and still shoot and move as normal.

HMS *SURPRISE* OR *UNITÉ* (1794–1802)

A 5th rate ship launched as the *Unité*, sailing for the French Navy before being captured in 1796 by the Royal Navy.

- This ship can be used by both the Royal Navy and the French Navy
- Once per game HMS *Surprise* (*Unité*) can re-activate one ship within 8" that Struck the Colours. Add to the target ship enough Ship Points to return them exactly to their Break Value.

Ship	Size	Broadsides	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
HMS <i>Speedy</i>	S	2L	-	-	20	Red	5	7	80
HMS <i>Agamemnon</i>	L	2H-2L-2C	-	1H	64	Red	4	22	250
HMS <i>Colossus</i>	L	3H-2L-2C	1L	1H	74	Red	4	24	290
HMS <i>Naiad</i>	M	2H-1L-1C	-	1L	36	Red	5	12	160
HMS <i>Surprise</i>	M	2H-1L-1C	-	1C	38	Red	5	12	160

FRENCH CAPTAINS OF RENOWN AND FAMOUS SHIPS

Special Characters

LOUIS-ANTOINE-CYPRIEN INFERNET (1757-1815).....30 PTS

An officer of the French Navy who demonstrated considerable heroism at the Battle of Trafalgar. His crew ultimately surrendered only after his ship was severely damaged. He also performed a difficult manoeuvre to get back into the battle.

- A ship that has Inernet on board will automatically pass the first three Break Tests it has to make.
- When sailing with Light Sails, Inernet's ship may make an additional turn of up to 30-degrees (yellow) before its initial move.



A mighty French fleet heads out into open water.

CHARLES RENÉ MAGON DE MÉDINE (1763–1805).....50 PTS

A contre-amiral (counter admiral, a similar rank to Rear Admiral) of the French Navy. He fought in many conflicts of the period and died at the Battle of Trafalgar in 1805. He was known for being very chivalrous.



- Magon's ship has a +1 to hit modifier against any British ship when aiming low.
- Magon's ship has a +1 modifier to all Skill Tests.
- Any ship Magon sails on must always follow the Rules of Engagement found on page 35 of the *Black Seas* rulebook, as well as the Awe and Fear rule on page 84 of this supplement.

FRANÇOIS-PAUL BRUEYS D'AIGALLIERS (1753–1798).....40 PTS

Born to an aristocratic family, Brueys enlisted in the French Navy and rose through its ranks. During the French Revolution, he was temporarily stripped of all titles but retained his naval rank and was even promoted to contre-amiral. He further distinguished himself in the Adriatic. He was on *L'Orient* at the Battle of the Nile, where he lost his life a short time before *L'Orient* exploded. Despite being wounded multiple times, he refused to strike the colours and surrender to the British.



- He provides a +1 to hit to the first broadside performed by his ship.
- Whilst François-Paul Brueys d'Aigalliers is alive, the ship he is on will not Strike the Colours, even if the Ship Points go below Break Value.
- Every time the ship he is on takes a critical hit, roll a D10. On a result of 10 he is mortally wounded and his special rules cease to have effect.



British and French lines exchange broadsides.

Famous Ships

TONNANT (1790–1821)

After a distinguished service in the French Navy, the *Tonnant* was captured and put into service in the Royal Navy. She was the last ship to strike her colours in the Battle of the Nile and was at the Battle of Trafalgar as part of the Royal Navy. She was also employed in the War of 1812 and participated in the capture of many enemy ships.

- This ship can be used by both the French Navy and the Royal Navy.
- The *Tonnant* has a +1 to hit once her Ship Points drop below half the original value.
- When capturing ships, the *Tonnant* does not deduct Ship Points for the first ship captured. Instead, only add Ship Points to the captured ship as described on page 84.

FORMIDABLE (1795–1818)

The French ship *Formidable* was a 3rd rate 80-gun ship of the line in the French Navy. She famously inflicted significant damage to the British 3rd rate ship HMS *Venerable* in a one-to-one combat off the coast of Cádiz.

- As long as there are no more than one enemy ships of the line (3rd Rates or above) within 20" of the *Formidable*, she has +2 on all to hit rolls when aiming low.

REDOUTABLE (1791–1805)

A 3rd rate 74-gun ship of the line in the French Navy. At the Battle of Trafalgar, the sharpshooters on this ship were the ones to hit Lord Horatio Nelson on HMS *Victory*.

- Has the Sharpshooters upgrade at no extra point cost.

L'HERMIONE (1779–1793)

A 32-gun frigate active in the Anglo-French War of 1778 and the American War of Independence. This ship became famous for ferrying French general La Fayette to the United States so that he could aid in the latter. She was one of the first ships in the French Navy to have copper sheathing and was very fast.

- Once per activation, *L'Hermione* can sail an extra inch.
- *L'Hermione* may also be used by the US Navy but must retain the French Flag.

Ship	Size	Broadsides	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
<i>Tonnant</i>	L	3H-3L-2C	1L	1H	80	Red	4	22	360
<i>Formidable</i>	L	3H-3L-2C	1L	1H	84	Red	4	32	330
<i>Redoutable</i>	L	3H-2L-2C	1L	1H	74	Red	4	23	300
<i>L'Hermione</i>	M	1H-2L-1C	–	1L	32	Red	5	10	190

SPANISH CAPTAINS OF RENOWN AND FAMOUS SHIPS

Additional National Rules

TACKLING DIFFICULTIES

Spanish sailors spent long periods of time in port because they were blockaded. Consequently, they often failed to practice their

skills as often as they would have liked. All Spanish Navy ships (apart from all Famous ships) have a -1 to Skill Tests when tackling.

Special Characters

COSME DAMIÁN DE CHURRUCA Y ELORZA (1761–1805) 30 PTS

An officer of the Spanish Navy who demonstrated considerable heroism and defiance in the face of danger. He showed particular heroism at the Great Siege of Gibraltar. At Trafalgar, he ordered that his ship should not strike its colours while he lived, despite being under attack from six British vessels. His officers followed this order, only relenting when he was mortally wounded.

- Whilst Cosme Damián de Churruca y Elorza is alive, the ship he is on will not Strike the Colours, even if the Ship Points go below its Break Value.
- Every time the ship occupied by de Churruca y Elorza takes a critical hit, roll a D10. On a result of 10, he is mortally wounded and his special rule ceases to have effect.



FEDERICO CARLOS GRAVINA Y NÁPOLI (1756–1806) 50 PTS

Commander-in-Chief of the Spanish fleet in 1805, Gravina was renowned as a superior tactician. He was educated not only in Spain but also in the British Royal Naval Academy in Portsmouth. He successfully fought the Algerian pirates in the Mediterranean and participated in the Great Siege of Gibraltar and the expedition against Menorca (which was under British control at the time).

- Every Spanish ship within 16" of Gravina's ship, including his own, gains a +1 to the dice roll of every Skill Test.
- Gravina's ship adds +1 to hit versus privateers.



Famous Ships

SANTA ANA (1784–1816)

A 112-gun 1st rate ship of the line of the Spanish Navy who saw her most famous action at the Battle of Trafalgar, where she was involved in a tremendous battle with Collingwood's HMS *Royal Sovereign*.

- The *Santa Ana* has +1 to hit against all Royal Navy ships.

ARGONAUTA (1798–1805)

The Spanish ship *Argonauta* was a 3rd rate 80-gun ship of the line in the Spanish Navy. She handles well and her crew found her easy to quickly repair.

- The *Argonauta* has +2 to Skill Tests for repairing and will restore 1D6+3 points of damage.
- The *Argonauta* also has +1 to Skill Test when tacking.

MONTAÑÉS (1794–1810)

A 3rd rate 74-gun ship of the line of the Spanish Navy that was renowned for her superior speed, which was used to evade a force of eight French ships of the line in 1795. After the Battle of Trafalgar, she was used to help re-capture the *Santa Ana* and the *Neptuno*.

- While within 8" of the *Montañés*, any Spanish ship that has Struck the Colours raises its colours once more. That ship does not have to test again unless it is forced to by circumstance, it opens fire, or is involved in a boarding action. In the two latter instances and starting with its next activation, the ship will have to test again as normal, every activation.

SAN JUAN NEPOMUCENO (1765–1816)

This Spanish Navy 3rd rate ship of the line had an intense and distinguished initial career, fighting in the Caribbean and around the coasts of France and Spain. However, it was during the Battle of Trafalgar that she acquired enormous respect from her opponents, as she refused to surrender until she was almost sunk.

- The *San Juan* has +1 to all Skill Tests.
- She has a +2 on all Strike the Colours tests.



Ship	Size	Broadside	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
<i>Santa Ana</i>	XL	6H-3L-2C	1H	2H	112	Yellow	3	37	370
<i>Argonauta</i>	L	3H-3L-2C	1L	1H	84	Red	4	32	370
<i>Montañés</i>	L	3H-2L-2C	1L	1H	78	Red	5	26	350
<i>San Juan Nepomuceno</i>	L	3H-2L-2C	1L	1H	72	Red	4	20	350

THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA IN THE AGE OF SAIL

The War of 1812

The War of 1812 began in June of that year, continuing until 1815. The reasons for the war's outbreak have been hugely debated over the years, with answers dependent upon whether one speaks to British, American, or Canadian historians. Many Americans were angered by British violations of American rights, from economic sanctions to the impressment of American seamen.

In 1806 Napoleon, knowing that he had no chance of invading Britain after Trafalgar, decided to hit the British economically instead. He issued the Berlin Decree, with the aim of excluding British trade from the continent. In retaliation, Britain imposed economic sanctions in 1807, declaring a blockade on any harbour excluding British commerce and forcing neutral vessels to visit



All hell breaks loose as Royal Navy and United States vessels clash.

British ports and pay a transit fee. The Americans reacted by implementing several embargoes. Unfortunately, these caused more problems for the US than they did Britain, further enraging American citizens.

Throughout both the French Revolutionary and Napoleonic Wars, it was claimed that vast numbers of American merchant sailors were taken by press gangs and forced into service of the Royal Navy.

On 22 June 1807, HMS *Leopard*, a 50-gun 4th rate was patrolling the waters off the coast of Virginia when they came across the USS *Chesapeake*, bound for the Mediterranean. The British ship requested permission from the Americans to search the ship for deserters; not an unfounded request, as there were a number of British deserters who had found their way aboard. The commanding officer of the USS *Chesapeake* refused a crew muster, to which the British response was a swift broadside. In the ensuing fight, several Americans were killed or wounded, the British boarded the *Chesapeake*

"I have not yet begun to fight!"

*Captain John Paul Jones during the famous battle between
USS Bonhomme Richard and Serapis, 1779*

and took the British deserters (later tried for mutiny and desertion before being hanged from the fore yardarm of their former ship, HMS *Halifax*) with them.

The Americans were both humiliated and angered by this event, which came to be known as the Chesapeake-Leopard Affair, and both Republicans and Federalists began calling for war with Britain.

Of interest is that whilst it is claimed British impressment was one of the key reasons for the outbreak of war, the numbers of those impressed are not as high as one would imagine with, it's thought, fewer than 10,000 Americans being impressed between 1790 and 1815.





Heroic American frigates are caught in the crossfire in a heated exchange with a small British fleet.

The Americans also took part in reciprocating impressment of British sailors. Famously, the crew of HMS *Havannah* once came across a person in the water that they thought to be an American deserter – actually an Irish seaman, Charles Davis – who claimed to have escaped ‘forced servitude’ in the US Navy aboard the USS *Constitution*.

In 1812, President Madison decided it was time to take the US to war against Britain. Beginning with an attack on Canada to gain land and cut off British supply lines, the American troops faced inexperience, poor morale and, in some cases, inept leadership. They were forced into a surrender in Detroit, Michigan, which opened a number of states to British incursion. In January 1813, Great Britain declared war on the US. The two nations fought on both land and at sea over the ensuing months, including engagements at Ogdensburg, Frenchtown, Hampton, and Fort Mims.

Earlier that year, President Madison had realised the importance of regaining northern territory and understood the best way to do so would be taking control of Lake Erie. Not only was British occupation of the area threatening the supply and movement of American troops, but the move would also prevent British invasion from the north. Captain Isaac

Chauncey was appointed as Commodore of the Great Lakes, with Master Commandant Perry in command. On arrival, there were no American ships but eight British vessels present. By August, the American ships numbered nine.

On 10 September 1813, Perry was made aware of the British fleet, under Barclay’s command, advancing with six vessels. In a battle lasting just over three hours and despite extensive damage to their ships, the Americans, who had the firepower advantage, won a decisive victory. It was during this engagement that Perry famously raised his flag emblazoned with the text, ‘Don’t Give Up the Ship’. Victory at Lake Erie was to be the first in a long line of victories against Britain, and victory on the lakes allowed America to take back a large proportion of the territory they had lost.

In 1814, British troops landed in Chesapeake Bay, bound for Washington. The Americans were focused on stopping their ships falling into British hands and, believing the attack would be on Baltimore, left Washington largely undefended. The two forces met at Bladensburg on 24 August, culminating in a British victory: once more due to a substantial number of inexperienced American troops. The British marched on to Washington and headed for the Presidential Mansion, now

known as the White House, setting it alight along with the Treasury, War Office, and other government buildings in retaliation for the prior burning of Canadian government buildings.

By September, the Americans had 10,000 men and 100 cannons blocking a British advance into Baltimore. The British did not expect such a strong defence and were outnumbered almost two to one, meaning a reliance on naval firepower and the destruction of Fort McHenry. Due to a requirement for a shallow draft, Admiral Cochrane used smaller bomb vessels. These and a rocket ship bombarded the fort. For over 27 hours the British fleet fired on the fort but were unsuccessful in taking it. This forced the British to abandon their land assault in

Maryland and instead sail for New Orleans. It was also in September that the Americans, in a much smaller naval force under the command of Master Commandant Macdonough, came up against a superior British squadron being led by Captain Downie. After several hours spent fighting, the Americans forced the British to surrender. This victory led to the conclusion of negotiations in Belgium and both sides signed the Treaty of Ghent on 24 December 1814.

Unfortunately, due to news of the treaty travelling slowly, Cochrane had already landed British troops in Louisiana and the Americans, led by Andrew Jackson, defeated the British at the Battle of New Orleans, ending the war after official peace was declared.

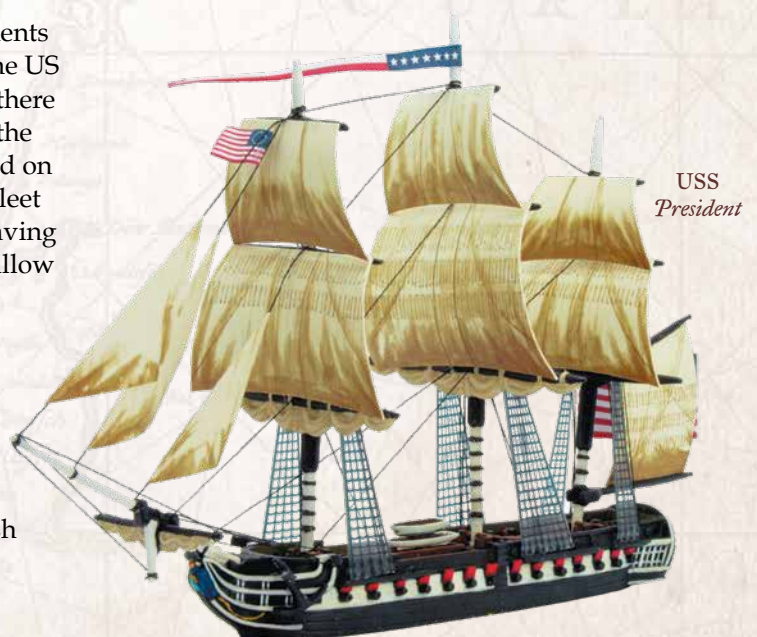
The First and Second Barbary Wars: 1801–1815

Whilst Britain, France, and Spain were fighting the Napoleonic Wars, the United States and Sweden were fighting for a different cause, against the Barbary States and their corsairs. The crews from the Barbary States, of which three (Tripoli, Algiers, and Tunis) formed part of the Ottoman Empire while a fourth (the Sultanate of Morocco) was independent, caused misery for merchant vessels. Their *modus operandi* involved, amongst other things, capturing ships and enslaving crews before demanding ransom money. If these ransoms were not paid then the victims would be sold as slaves.

For immunity from these attacks, governments could pay the rulers of these four states. The US had been doing so since around 1795, and there was an American consul in each state. For the British also, there was an importance placed on being able to resupply the Mediterranean fleet in these ports, when required, as well as having access to strategic positioning that would allow them to contain Napoleon.

However, when by 1801 the monetary requests had become larger and after the Pasha of Tripoli threatened war on the United States, President Jefferson decided to send a squadron of four ships to Tripoli to mount a blockade. The Swedish Navy agreed to assist.

During this blockade in 1803, the Barbary pirates took an American frigate, the USS *Philadelphia*, and, upon capturing the vessel, enslaved the majority of her 307 crew. A few crew members managed to escape and, under the command of Lt Stephen Decatur, mounted a daring raid in the middle of the night. They sneaked on board whilst the ship was in harbour, killed the guards, and set fire to the ship. In doing so, they prevented the enemy from making use of it. Horatio Nelson actually stated that this act was “the most bold and daring act of the Age”. Once news of the prisoners being freed had reached Jefferson, he decided to send more ships.



A new tax and spending plan was created for the Navy and, in 1804, Commodore Samuel Barron was tasked with commanding a fleet twice the size of the original blockading force, with a mix of frigates, brigs, and other vessels. A plan was made to lead one of the ex-rulers overland to mount an attack on Tripoli.

William Eaton, the former American naval agent in the region, drew from Greek and Arab supporters and, along with some marines, they took the town of Derne. Three ships, including the *Argus*, provisioned them on the journey and assisted in the capture.

A combination of a strong naval blockade and land expedition brought the war to a close, with a peace treaty finally signed on 4 June 1805. There was to be no annual sum paid to the Barbary States going forward and a ransom was agreed for the release of men.

After the War of 1812 was over, the Barbary States came up once more, but this time President James Madison would handle the issue. The corsairs had made a return to harassing American merchant ships and, in February 1815, Madison decided there was once more a requirement for American intervention. He declared war on Algiers in March of that year.

Now Commodore, Stephen Decatur was to head up the task force of ten ships that left New York in May, ordered to engage any Algerian vessels he happened upon. In June, shortly after passing Gibraltar, he took two ships before

sailing on to Algiers, where he once more mounted a blockade. Decatur used the ships he captured as leverage to release American prisoners and, in a show of American naval dominance for the region, went on to do the same in Tunis and Tripoli.

Of course, it wasn't just the Americans who came up against the Barbary States. The British, under Admiral Edward Pellew and working alongside the Dutch, mounted a campaign against Algiers in 1816 with the aim of freeing Christian slaves and putting an end to the practice of enslaving European sailors.

After the Napoleonic Wars ended, Britain no longer required the use of these North African states for resupply, which meant Britain could exert its influence. Whilst the rulers of Tunis and Tripoli agreed to stop enslaving Christians, the ruler of Algiers was less easily persuaded. Pellew travelled home, believing he had put an end to it, only to later hear that Algerian troops had massacred 200 fishermen under British protection.

The Royal Navy dispatched a squadron made up of two 1st rates, five frigates and four bomb vessels. In addition to these, there were four sloops and eight ships armed with rockets, as well as five Dutch frigates. The task force bombarded the Algerian ships and batteries for around 12 hours, causing utter devastation and killing or wounding hundreds of people on both sides. A treaty was signed on 24 September 1816, which led to the release of around 4,000 slaves.



US frigates teach the Barbary Coast pirates a costly lesson.

US CAPTAINS OF RENOWN AND FAMOUS SHIPS

Special Characters

JOHN PAUL JONES (1747–1792)..... 30 PTS

A major player in the American War of Independence, John Paul Jones was viewed as a hero by some and a pirate by others. He attempted to attack the coast of England and finished his career as an officer in the Imperial Russian Navy.



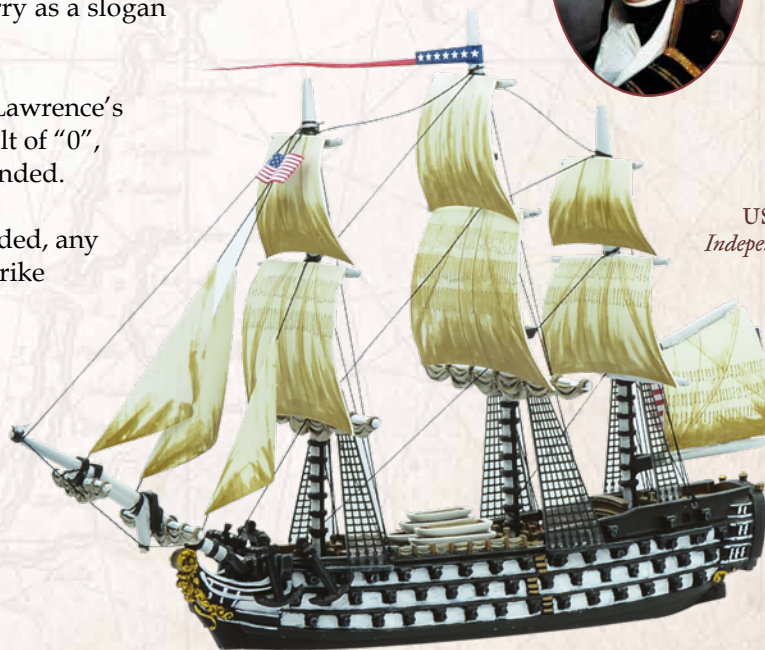
- If the current Ship Points of Jones' ship fall below half its starting value, he and his crew can take over another ship. To do this, he declares a boarding action against any ship that has Struck the Colours. He will then command this new ship, abandoning the old one. The boarded ship's Ship Points will be reset to half their initial value.
- This character may also be used by the Russian Navy.

JAMES LAWRENCE (1781–1813)..... 40 PTS

A fine captain who mostly commanded smaller vessels before becoming captain of the USS *Chesapeake*. He was killed in a fight with HMS *Shannon*, in which he famously uttered the command, "Don't give up the ship. Fight her till she sinks" after being mortally wounded. "Don't Give Up the Ship" was later adopted by Oliver Hazard Perry as a slogan on his flag.



- For every critical hit suffered by Lawrence's ship, roll a further D10. On a result of "0", Lawrence has been mortally wounded.
- Until Lawrence is mortally wounded, any ship with him on board cannot Strike the Colours.



USS
Independence

Famous Ships

USS *INDEPENDENCE* (1814–1912)

USS *Independence* was the first ship of the line launched by the US Navy. She operated mainly as a deterrent as, during her lifetime, she was not involved in any major conflict. This ship can be used in 'what if...?' scenarios.

- The USS *Independence* follows all US National Special Rules.

USS *OHIO* (1820–1884)

One of the few US 3rd rates ships built after the War of 1812. She did not see action until after the period covered by the *Black Seas* rulebook. This ship can be used in 'what if...?' scenarios.

- The USS *Ohio* follows all US National Special Rules.



USS *PRESIDENT* (1800–1818)

USS *President* was one of the original six US Navy frigates. She was involved in the Quasi-War with France and the War of 1812.

- When in the same fleet as the USS *Congress*, this ship receives +1 to all Skill Tests.

USS *CONGRESS* (1799–1834)

Another of the original six US Navy frigates, the USS *Congress* was involved in the same conflicts as the USS *President* and participated in several actions alongside her.

- When in the same fleet with the USS *President*, this ship receives +1 to all Skill Tests.

USS *CHESAPEAKE* (1799–1819)

One of the original six US Navy frigates, the USS *Chesapeake's* encounter with HMS *Leopard* was probably a contributing factor to the War of 1812. She was captured by HMS *Shannon* and put to service in the Royal Navy in 1813.

- Any enemy merchant ship that tests to Strike the Colours due to being attacked by USS *Chesapeake* receives -1 on the test.
- This ship can also be used by the Royal Navy.

USS *NIAGARA* (1813–1815)

The relief flagship for Oliver Hazard Perry, Niagara's primary directive on Lake Erie was to protect vulnerable American coastline from the British. She played a pivotal role in the battle for the lake.

- When playing on any of the North American Great Lakes, a raking shot by the USS *Niagara* will add +3 damage to the final total (after doubling/trebling).



US vessels set sail in strength.

"The rocket's red glare, the bombs bursting in air..."

From the American national anthem, the Star Spangled Banner, describing the bombardment of Fort McHenry by the British in 1814

Ship	Size	Broadside	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
USS Independence	XL	9H	1H	2H	96	Yellow	4	32	450
USS Ohio	L	5H-3C	1L	1H	80	Red	5	27	350
USS North Carolina	L	6H-1L	1L	1H	79	Red	4	28	300
USS President	M	2H-2C-2L	-	-	44	Red	5	15	260
USS United States	M	2H-2C-2L	-	-	44	Red	5	15	260
USS Congress	M	3H-2L	-	1L	40	Red	4	13	180
USS Chesapeake	M	2H-2L	-	-	40	Red	4	13	180
USS Essex (alternative profile)	M	1L-3C	-	1L	45	Red	5	15	190
USS Niagara	S	2C	-	-	26	Red	5	9	90

Note: The table of US ships above includes the USS United States and USS North Carolina, which do not have Special Rules but do have a special series of statistics, plus an alternate profile for USS Essex.

THE RUSSIAN NAVY

Russia in the late 18th century had two main naval concerns: In the Baltic, she faced Sweden and, to a lesser extent, Denmark-Norway, whilst in the chain of seas which lead to the Mediterranean, she faced the Ottoman Empire.

The Russian Baltic Fleet was established during the Great Northern War (1700–1721). Based in the newly developed port of St Petersburg, it contained several hundred ships including a large number of galleys. Following advances against the Ottomans in the Sea of Azov, Russia also maintained fleets in the Crimea after 1770 and in the Black Sea after 1783.

Like Sweden, Russia maintained both coastal and ocean-going fleets in the Baltic Sea. Both suffered major defeats in the Russo-Swedish War of 1788–90 but Russia regained the upper hand over Sweden in the Finnish War of 1808–9. The former war included two of the largest naval battles in Western European history, both lost by Russia.

In the Russo-Swedish War, the ocean-going Russian fleet generally lost out to the combined fleets of Sweden and her ally Britain. However,

Russia's coastal fleet was a major factor in holding Swedish forces at bay and protecting the armies that conquered Finland and invaded Sweden.

Friction between Russia and the Ottoman Empire was frequent. In 1768, this flared into another war between them, kindled by a Greek rebellion against their Turkish rulers. For the first time in her naval history, Russia sent a squadron from the Baltic to sail around Northern Europe to the Mediterranean, attacking the Ottomans in the Aegean.

Several small victories pushed the Ottoman fleet back until the climactic battle of Chesma in July 1770, where the outnumbered and outgunned Russian fleet virtually destroyed the Ottoman fleet of more than 60 ships. This gave Russia control of the Aegean Sea and the Danube estuary. Its resulting presence in the Eastern Mediterranean (the Levant) signalled a significant regional shift of power, as it blockaded Turkish ports. In 1771, the Russian fleet in the Sea of Azov (developed to cope with shallow coastal waters by using Russian copies of Ottoman xebecs) entered the Black Sea for



The pride of the Russian Navy.

the first time. This strategic pincer of Russian fleets at both ends of the Black Sea posed a quandary for the Ottoman fleet, potentially requiring it to fight on two fronts as well as largely preventing the resupply of Ottoman ports and fortifications by sea. In turn, this had the knock-on effect of improving the success rate of Russian operations on land.

By the 1780s, the Russian Navy had the world's fourth-largest fleet, growing to 28 ships of the line and 149 frigates. Russia was able to build ships quickly, partly by relaxing criteria for the quality of timber, which led to a rapid turnaround time for ship construction.

Turkish attempts to break out to the Black Sea were squarely defeated, leading to a peace settlement in 1782 by which Russia was to occupy the Crimea, founding there the major port of Sevastapol.

Unsurprisingly, conflict between the two nations recurred in 1787. This time Russia was unable to

reinforce her Mediterranean fleet from the Baltic, as Sweden chose the same moment to launch an attack on Russian Finland.

In the Black Sea, Russian success was limited, although storms were as much of a factor as Ottoman actions. Russia nevertheless achieved the victory at Ochakov in June 1788, during which one Russian squadron was led by John Paul Jones, a naval hero of the American Revolution.

Russia again defeated the Ottomans in the Dardanelles and the Battle of Athos, both in 1807. The last major battle of these conflicts was the joint Russian, British, and French victory against the Ottomans at Navarino in 1827, with the aim of supporting Greek independence.

The Allied fleet of 22 ships and 1,258 guns faced 78 Ottoman ships carrying 2,180 guns – but more effective Allied gunnery destroyed the Ottoman fleet and one further Russo-Turkish war in 1828–9 secured an independent Greece.

National Rules

FIREPOWER OVER MANOEUVRABILITY

Many of the Russian Navy's early engagements were instrumental in developing naval tactics of the period, in particular the emergence of ships of the line favouring firepower over manoeuvrability. However, Russian ships were of poor workmanship, and did not last long or sail particularly well.

- Russian ships of the line (1st to 3rd Rates) may take the Overgunned upgrade at a discounted cost of 80 points.
- Russian ships of the line suffer -1" to their Rate of Knots their first movement of each turn and may not purchase the Streamlined or Sturdy upgrades.
- Reduce the initial Ship Points values of all Russian ships by 10% (rounding down).

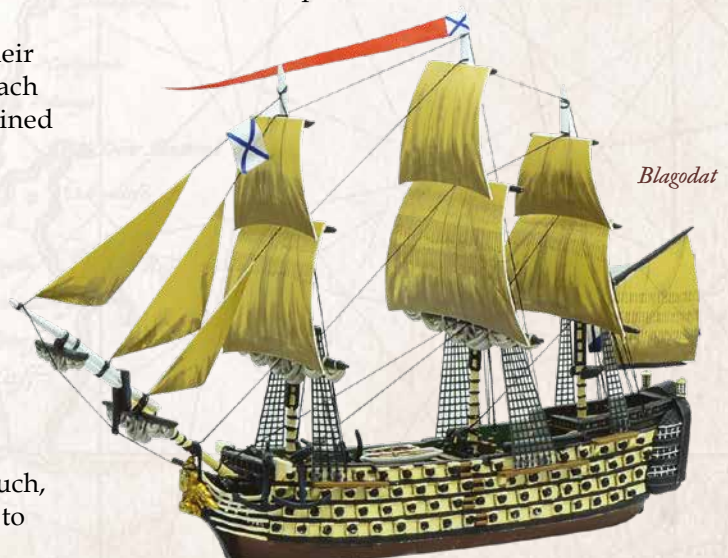
EDINOROGS

Larger ships of the Russian Navy had an armament of edinorog guns: long range, accurate cannons with a flat trajectory. As such, each turn one cannon shot by a Russian 1st to

3rd Rate ship suffers no penalty for firing at targets over 10" away.

RESILIENCE

Both men and boys of the Russian Navy bore an unnaturally strong will when compared to other nations' crews. Russian ships that fail a Strike the Colours test may re-roll the test, but the result of the second test must be accepted.



Special Characters

ADMIRAL DMITRY NIKOLAYEVICH SENYAVIN (1763–1831)... 30 PTS

Widely renowned as one of the greatest seamen of the Napoleonic Wars, this admiral had a tendency to follow his own orders rather than those of his superiors.

- May not benefit from the Special Rules of any other friendly ship or character.
- Ignores the -1" Rate of Knots penalty in the Russian Firepower over Manoeuvrability rule. In addition, conveys a +1 to Skill Tests to his own ship.



ADMIRAL FYODOR FYODOROVICH USHAKOV (1745–1817)... 70 PTS

Regarded as one of the most illustrious Russian naval commanders and admirals of the period, Admiral Ushakov is infamous for never losing a ship in battle and for being one of the founders of the line tactic.

- Ushakov has +1 to Skill Tests on his own ship, as well as ships of his fleet within 20".
- Ushakov's ship gains a +1 to hit when shooting at the enemy flagship. This is either the largest ship in the enemy fleet or, if two or more are of equal rates, one agreed beforehand to be the flagship.
- When sailing in a line formation that includes Ushakov's vessel, all other ships in the formation gain a +1 to hit bonus when shooting at the same target as Ushakov's vessel.
- Ushakov's ship will never Strike the Colours. Friendly ships within 20" gain a +1 bonus when rolling a Strike the Colours test. This is in addition to the Skill Test bonus given above.



ADMIRAL MIKHAIL PETROVICH LAZAREV (1788–1851) 50 PTS

An experienced Russian fleet commander and explorer, with three circumnavigations and a multitude of meteorological research to his name.

- After leaving by a table edge, Lazarev's ship may be brought on from any position on the same edge. It may also enter from another table edge as long as the following penalties are applied: Lazarev's ship must remain off the table and out of play for two full Turns if he re-enters via an edge adjacent to his exit position, or three Turns for the opposite edge.



- May not benefit from any other friendly ship or character's special rules.
- Ignores the -1" Rate of Knots penalty in the Russian Firepower over Manoeuvrability rule. In addition, he conveys a +1 to Skill Tests by his own ship.

Famous Ships

BLAGODAT (1800–1814)

A huge 130-gun first rate ship of the line, possibly based on the designs of the Spanish *Santisima Trinidad*.

- *Blagodat's* first broadside of the game may re-roll any missed shots.

ST PAVEL (1794–1810)

A 2nd rate ship of the line built on the Black Sea and became part of the Black Sea fleet. She also saw action in the Mediterranean, where she helped capture several coastal towns and fortifications.

- *St Pavel* has +1 to hit bonus when shooting at shore targets.
- She also has +1 to Skill Tests.

AZOV (1826–1831)

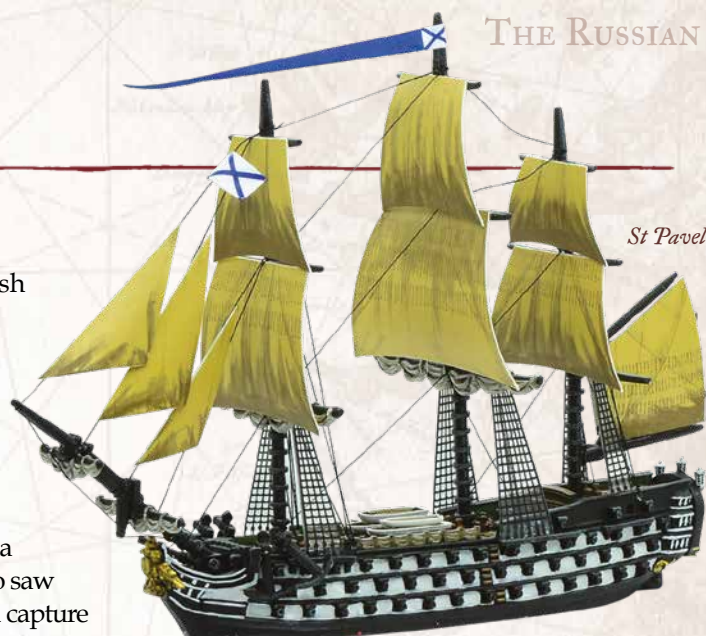
A 74-gun ship of the line armed with 24-pdrs and 36-pdrs. This ship was at the centre of the fight in the Battle of Navarino in 1827. She was regarded as the finest ship in the Russian Navy for at least four years, after which she was left to rot.

- *Azov* does not suffer the -1" Rate of Knots penalty from Firepower over Manoeuvrability.
- For every hit rolled against *Azov*, roll a D6. On a result of 6, the hit is ignored. Critical hits ignore this rule.
- The *Azov* cannot be repaired during battle.

MERCURT (1820–1857)

A 20-gun brig launched in 1820 for coastal work in the Black Sea. She had a shallow draught and was, unusually, equipped with oars. Slower than other brigs, she still fought several times. She and two other brigs held their own against a fleet of 14.

- Can use the Advanced Rule Moving Under Oars.
- Has the upgrade Shallow Draught at no extra cost.



Ship	Size	Broadsides	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
<i>Blagodat</i>	XL	5H-5L-3C	1H	1H	130	Yellow	3	40	620
<i>St Pavel</i>	XL	4H-3L-3C	1L	1H	90	Yellow	3	30	440
<i>Azov</i>	L	3H-3L-2C	1H	1H	74	Red	4	25	360
<i>Mercury</i>	S	2H	–	–	30	Red	4	8	100

THE SWEDISH NAVY

As with the competing Baltic powers of Russia and Denmark-Norway, much of Swedish naval action took place in a topography of fjords, islands, narrow channels, and estuaries. This demanded ships with shallow draft such as galleys (in 1770, for example, Denmark had 13 galleys, Sweden 51 and Russia 56), particularly to support essential trade. Furthermore, territorial gains could only be made on land with ships that could move and support troops.

Sweden had both an ocean-going fleet of large warships and a Coastal, or Archipelago, Fleet made up of transport ships, escorts, and bombarding vessels. It contained galleys, gun sloops with both oars and sail as well as two 24-pdrs, and gun pramms (shallow draft, three masters carrying 12-pdrs and swivel guns).

Most effective was the 'archipelago frigate', adapted from a traditional warship design. These were versatile, with a mix of guns that

outgunned Russian galleys while remaining useful against smaller warships.

The most significant battle won by the Archipelago Fleet was the second Battle of Svensksund (1790) in the Russo-Swedish War of 1788–90. In 1788, the Swedes planned to attack St Petersburg but were stalled at the drawn Battle of Hogland, then blockaded; then, in 1789, beaten back at the first Battle of Svensksund.

A renewed attempt in 1790 against St Petersburg was bottled up by the Russians in Vyborg Bay, though a determined action led by the 64-gun *Dristigheten* (*The Boldness*), under Johan Puke, eventually broke the blockade.

The reinforced Coastal Fleet of nearly 200 ships then took the offensive, facing an enemy fleet of larger ships with double the number of guns. Less capable of manoeuvring than the Swedes, the Russians became over-extended and

The Archipelago fleet

Originally founded in 1756, the archipelago fleet, also called *arméns flotta* (the fleet of the army), was composed of different ships, most of which had a shallow draft. This was necessary to navigate the shallow waters that are typical of the Swedish and Finnish Fjords and the various small inlets and islands close to the coast.

When founded, a large part of the ships that made up the fleet were galleys. However, in the later stages of the 18th century, it became obvious that these were unsuitable for the naval warfare of the time due to the limited firepower and exposure of the crew. Even if Sweden still maintained a contingent of these, they designed and built specific ships with a shallow draft and more fire power. Among these were a type of gunboat with a 12-pounder gun, schooner rigging and 7–8 pairs of oars and four types of frigate-like shallow draft ships, all with rows of oars.

A turuma was a 24–36 gun frigate with oars on the main deck. An udema was a galley-frigate hybrid with three masts, rows of oars on the open lower deck and a centreline of 10–20 cannons on the main deck that could be pivoted and shot either side. A pojama was mostly an evolution of the galley; the front facing guns could be dragged and aimed on the sides if needed with a lot of effort. Lastly, a hemmema was similar to a turuma but smaller with the rows of oars on the gun deck and carried 16–20 heavy cannon.

outflanked, losing half their men and 71 ships. Peace followed this huge success.

In the 1807 Treaty of Tilsit, Napoleon acceded to Russia's claim on Finland, precipitating The Finnish War (1808–1809). Marshall Bernadotte threatened to attack Sweden from Denmark whilst a Russian army invaded Finland. The fortified port of Sveaborg quickly fell, losing its Archipelago Fleet to the invaders.

At that point, Britain joined Sweden. The Allied fleets bottled the Russians up in Estonian Baltiski port (Baltic port) whilst Sweden rebuilt her Coastal Fleet, leading to Swedish victories at Rimito Kramp and Sandöström with little strategic gain.

By autumn of 1808, Russia outnumbered Swedish land forces, but Allied control of the Baltic enabled Sweden to land troops and harass Russian positions, though with little lasting effect. More successful were the Battle of Grönviksund, when Swedish gun sloops overwhelmed a Russian fleet, preventing an attack on Åland, and Palva Sund, when the Swedes defeated a Russian fleet of twice its size; again, with little strategic gain.

In 1809 the Russians crossed the frozen Gulf of Bothnia to invade Sweden itself, capturing Umeå. Before suing for peace, Sweden sailed a small force to the Russian rear, isolating the invaders. The resulting Battles of Sävar and Ratan inflicted heavy losses, but the Swedes had to withdraw and Finland passed into Russian control.

National Rules

SHALLOW DRAFTS

All Swedish Medium ships or smaller ignore the terrain rules for sandbanks and shoals/shorelines.

Special Characters

ADMIRAL JOHAN AF PUKE (1751–1816)..... 30 PTS

Participated in the battle of Hogland (1788) as captain of the frigate *Fröja* and at Öland (1789) commanding the Dristigheten, on which he led the break-out from the Russian blockade at Vyborg Bay (1789). In the Finnish War, he commanded the squadron that sailed behind the lines of Russia's invading forces, precipitating the final Battles of Sävar and Ratan (1809).

- Once per Turn, a ship carrying af Puke can re-roll a single dice, for any reason. The player must accept the second result.



Famous Ships

CARLSKRONA (1749)

A 6-gun galley in the Coastal Fleet. Took part in the Battle of Stettiner Haff against Prussia in 1759.

- The *Carlskrona* does not have to spend a full Turn without shooting to switch from oars to sails. At the start of the ship's activation, decide what movement it will use, then use that until the ship's next activation.

Ship	Size	Broadsides	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
<i>Carlskrona</i>	S	–	–	1H	40	Red	4	16	80

THE DANO-NORWEGIAN NAVY

The two countries of Denmark and Norway were ruled as one. As the weakest of the three Baltic powers, they nevertheless potentially controlled access to the Baltic through their narrow channels. Denmark managed to maximise trade for most of the 18th century, although she did have to act against Tripoli's corsairs in 1797. However, Britain's insistence on boarding neutral ships to police trading with her enemies led Denmark, in 1801, to follow Russia's policy of 'Armed Neutrality', refusing to allow British interference while protecting her convoys with armed escorts. Britain treated this as a hostile act and set out to show the Baltic nations the error of their policy by bombarding Copenhagen.

Copenhagen was approached along a difficult channel. Three of Nelson's 12 attacking ships were grounded in the approach. The fire endured by the British ships, particularly the lead frigates, was intense but matched by British return fire. After Nelson's attack was fully committed, Sir Hyde Parker made the signal to retire, the signal Nelson famously

refused to see, as it would have forced the British ships to undergo the gauntlet of defensive fire a second time.

Denmark lost 12 defending ships and over 1,000 men. Britain lost 900 men and her damaged ships were mostly soon repaired. As Copenhagen was now effectively undefended, Britain controlled access to the Baltic. Russia soon reversed its policy of Armed Neutrality but the 1807 Treaty of Tilsit then allied Russia with France against Britain, arranging for Napoleon's seizure of the Dano-Norwegian fleet.

In response, Britain again bombarded Copenhagen, hoping to capture or destroy the fleet. Unsurprisingly, this forced Denmark into the arms of Napoleon. Having lost much of her fleet in this attack, Denmark built hundreds of smaller craft, initiating what became known as the Gunboat War. Gunboats were cheap to build, oared, and of shallow draft. In large squadrons, they could surround their target so that some enemy guns could not be brought to bear, collectively bringing a superior weight

Gunboats

Gunboats were used by most navies throughout the Napoleonic era and later were further developed and modernised, remaining a great tool in coastal naval warfare. Small and easy to maintain and operate, they were oared and single (or double) masted smaller vessels that carried between 1 and 3 heavy or light cannons.

Their usefulness was mostly demonstrated in shallow waters or on stretches of water with many shoals or sandbanks. They were also very cheap and quick to build and if deployed in great numbers could seriously damage or even sink a frigate.

There are many examples of their efficacy, from their use on the lakes in the American Civil War to the Gunboat War of 1807-1814.

of shot. Being rowed, they could also take advantage of becalmed ships.

Such tactics worked against smaller warships, including brigs such as HMS *Allart* (1809), but not against larger vessels. However, the 64-gun HMS *Africa* was almost lost to 25 gunships in 1808, saved only by nightfall. Gunboat flotillas were also successful against British merchant convoys. For example, in June 1809 a convoy of 70 merchants lost their escorting brig HMS *Turbulent* and 12 merchants to a flotilla of gunboats.

Despite such successes, Britain dominated the Baltic seaways throughout the war of 1807–14, and Dano-Norwegian trade was so crippled that Norway began to starve. In 1808 Sweden threatened to invade Norway, although the only serious naval action at Furuholm was inconclusive, leading to peace in 1809. However, in 1813 Sweden again aligned with Britain in the Sixth Coalition against Napoleon; Denmark, now overwhelmed, sued for peace, ceding Heligoland to Britain and Norway to Sweden under the 1814 Treaty of Kiel.

National Rules

GUNBOATS FLOTILLAS

Gunboat Squadrons cost 30 points instead of 40; however, they always follow the Awe and Fear rule.

Special Characters

JOHAN OLFERT FISCHER (1747–1829).....40 PTS

Commodore of the Dano-Norwegian fleet at the Battle of Copenhagen in 1801, against Nelson. He began the battle aboard the flagship *Dannebrog*, then transferred to *Hosteen* and finished by commanding from the nearby fortress. As a result of Fischer's actions, the Danes were almost able to regard the battle as a victory.



- A ship occupied by Commodore Fischer gains one re-roll of all dice used in her first broadside.
- When Fischer's flagship falls under half its Ship Points, he may move his command to the nearest ship in the same fleet within 20" range. After he transfers, the new ship gets one re-roll of all the dice used in its first broadside.

Famous Ships

NAJADEN (1795–1812)

A 40-gun frigate that led the action against Tripoli in May 1797. She was then taken at Copenhagen in 1807 by the British, to become HMS *Nyaden*.

- When sailing at Battle Sails or faster, at any point in the middle of your second Rate of Knots move, you can perform a turn in addition to the maximum number of turns you are usually allowed to do, using the yellow (narrow) side of the turn marker.

Ship	Size	Broadsides	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
<i>Najaden</i>	M	2H-1L-1C	-	1L	40	Red	5	13	170

THE DUTCH/ BATAVIAN NAVY

The powerful Dutch Navy of the 17th century that had dominated most other nations, including both the British and the French, had radically declined by the mid-18th century. In the Fourth Anglo-Dutch War of 1780-1784, Dutch shipping suffered quite badly, especially at the hands of British privateers. Britain declared war in 1780, as the Dutch had secretly been supplying munitions to the Continental forces fighting Britain in the American War of Independence.

The following year saw several naval encounters between the two nations. In February, three British ships attacked a Dutch convoy of 30 merchants protected by only one Dutch frigate, the *Mars*, at Sombrero in the Caribbean. Despite the frigate's furious defence to delay British attackers, none of the Dutch merchants escaped. In May, a second, more

evenly matched action was fought between a pair of Dutch frigates and two British, in which the British captured one frigate while almost losing one of their own.

The most notable encounters, however, were at Saldanha Bay and Dogger Bank. Saldanha Bay was part of the Dutch colony near the Cape of Good Hope, where a surprise attack by the British (initially flying French colours) on a Dutch merchant fleet captured four ships and destroyed a fifth. At Dogger Bank, two enemy fleets convoying merchants fought each other to a draw with heavy casualties on both sides, although one of the Dutch ships, the *Holland*, subsequently sank.

This action effectively conceded control of the North Sea to Britain as the Dutch remained in port in Texel for the remainder of the war.

The Cutlass

The cutlass was the main cut-and-thrust short sword utilised in boarding actions for many years, both before and after the period covered by the *Black Seas* rules. Designs varied significantly, but in general the blade was between 26- and 29-inches long, of normal thickness with a single sharp edge (although double edge cutlasses also existed) and could be found with both a slight curve and straight blade. The large hand guard was made from a variety of metals such as brass and iron.

Most navies had drills and training that used the 'single stick', which was a wooden replica of the cutlass used to avoid major injuries whilst the sailors practiced fighting with them.

The cutlass could be used single-handed in conjunction with a flintlock pistol, as described in the 1812 training manual treatise of Lieutenant William Pringle Green. They were incredibly effective and when wielded well during boarding actions could make the difference between defeat and victory.

British privateers also captured Dutch merchant prizes in raids on the Dutch Guiana colonies of Demerara and Essequibo.

Dutch debt and political unrest following the war led to the Batavian Revolution, forming the Batavian Republic of 1795. In effect the French Revolution was imported to Holland, and the Dutch Navy came largely under French control, partly due to a French cavalry regiment's unique capture of the fleet frozen in harbour at Den Helder (1795). The Batavian Navy did no better than its predecessor. It lost 11 ships, mainly 3rd and 4th rates, to the British fleet at the Battle of Camperdown in 1797 and, because of the Anglo-Russian invasion of North Holland (part of the War of the Second Coalition against

Napoleon), surrendered a further 12 ships without a fight at Vlieter in 1799.

In 1806 Napoleon appointed his brother Louis Napoléon Bonaparte as King of Holland. Thereafter the Dutch Navy simply became part of the French. It spent much of the Napoleonic Wars in various campaigns protecting Dutch possessions in the East Indies from British attacks, notably the Java campaign of 1806–7 and British attacks on the Spice Islands in 1810, in both cases yielding to overwhelming force.

However, with independence in 1813, the Netherlands regained some of its lost possessions and in 1816, six Dutch ships joined the British fleet fighting to end slavery in Algiers.

National Rules

SHALLOW DRAFT

All unrated Dutch/Batavian ships have the Shallow Draft upgrade at no extra cost. This does not count towards their maximum upgrades allowed.

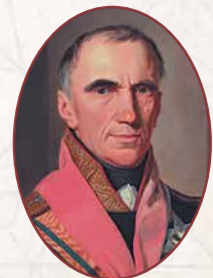
Special Characters

VICE ADMIRAL JONKHEER THEODORUS

FREDERIK VAN CAPELLEN (1762–1824) 50 PTS

With a reputation as a very honourable man, van Capellen fought the British in the Fourth Anglo-Dutch War. He later commanded a gunboat flotilla and led the Dutch contingent in the 1816 bombardment of Algiers.

- Any ship in van Capellen's fleet shoots with +1 to hit against privateers.



Famous Ships

STAATEN GENERAAL (1787–1806)

A 74-gun 3rd rate ship in both the Dutch and Batavian Republics. Flagship of Vice Admiral Samuel Story at the Battle of Camperdown, 1797. This ship caught fire twice, but the crew managed to extinguish the flames on both occasions.

- All Skills Tests to extinguish fire on this ship get a +1 bonus.

Ship	Size	Broadsides	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
<i>Staaten Generaal</i>	L	3H-2L-2C	1L	1H	74	Red	4	25	290

THE PORTUGUESE NAVY

Many of the actions of the Portuguese fleet took place around its colonial territories in South America or the Far East. In the Battle of Calicut (1752) a single Portuguese ship, the *Nossa Senhora da Misericórdia*, protected the city of Calicut from a Marathas fleet. In Portugal's war with Spain in 1776–7, naval battles took place not around the Iberian Peninsula but rather the South American territories of the two colonising nations.

In 1776, Portuguese fleets bombarded the Rio Grande de São Pedro but were defeated by the loss of two ships to a Spanish counter-attack. Subsequently, Portugal spent most of the war avoiding a much greater Spanish fleet sent from Cadiz.

An Iberian fleet attacking Algiers in 1784 contained four Portuguese ships alongside ships from Spain and the Kingdom of the Two Sicilies. It defeated the opposing Algerian fleet and bombarded the city, compelling the ruling Dey to end piracy against the Iberian Peninsula for several years.

With the French Revolutionary, and then Napoleonic, Wars, Portugal attempted neutrality but primarily found herself allied with Britain. When Napoleon threatened invasion of Britain in the 1790s, ten Portuguese ships were sent to protect the English Channel. After the British victory at the Nile in 1801, a Portuguese squadron assisted in the siege of French-occupied Malta. Most significant for the navy, however, was the 1807 French invasion of Portugal, effectively initiating the Peninsular War. The Portuguese royal court retreated across the Atlantic to Brazil. From there, a joint British and Portuguese force captured French Guiana in 1809.

During the War of Brazilian Independence (1821–1825), rebellious Brazilians seized many Portuguese ships to form the Brazilian Navy, although crewing and equipping the Revolutionaries' ships proved difficult. The Portuguese often had the upper hand, as at the Battle of 4 May, where Brazilian crews mutinied and surrendered their ships back to Portugal. However, for much of the war, ships still loyal

The Flintlock Pistol

The mechanism of the flintlock is an evolution of the matchlock and wheellock. All of these work by igniting a charge of black powder through a small hole on the base of the barrel, with only the initial ignition method changing. In the flintlock, a piece of flint strikes a steel plate (frizzen) when the trigger is pulled, that ignites a small amount of black powder in the pan that in turn ignites the main charge in the barrel, forcing the projectile forward at high velocity. They were handed out to sailors before a boarding action, for use in hand-to-hand combat. They were probably used to only shoot the initial pre-loaded shot and then discarded or used to parry or as a club-like weapon.

to Portugal found themselves blockaded, so actions typically involved attempted breakouts, such as at the key Battle of Montevideo (1823). Here, a Portuguese squadron failed to break the blockade, a failure that led to the city's surrender and hastened the end of the war.

In the Portuguese Civil War (also known as the Liberal Wars, 1828–1834) the navy was itself divided and Portugal's relationship with other European powers became complex. A French squadron attacked a Portuguese fleet fighting for the pretender to the throne, Miguel I, in the Tagus in 1831 and both sides fired on a British squadron in the Douro.

At the Battle of Cape St Vincent (1833), a fleet of ten Miguellite ships, including four ships of the line, a frigate and a xebec, were defeated by an inferior squadron of three frigates and

*"The great receipt for
quieting a country is a good
thrashing first and great
kindness afterwards."*

Sir Charles James Napier

three smaller ships, commanded by the Briton Charles Napier, who was fighting on behalf of Pedro I. Aggressive action by Napier and, apparently, the superiority of his ships' crews, many of whom had come from the British Royal Navy, led to the capture of all four Miguellite ships of the line.

Special Characters

ADMIRAL D. DOMINGOS XAVIER DE LIMA,

MARQUES DE NIZA (1765–1802).....50PTS

This admiral took part in the attack on Algiers (1784), served in the English Channel squadron (1793), and protected the Portuguese coast from corsairs. He also supported the attack on Naples (1789) and, with his flagship *Príncipe Real*, led the Portuguese squadron in the Siege of Malta (1789).



- When de Lima is admiral of a fleet, any friendly ship within 8" of the ship de Lima is on can re-roll its first Skill Test.

Famous Ships

***PRÍNCIPE REAL* (RENAMED IN 1794 FROM**

THE ORIGINAL *NOSSA SENHORA DA CONCEIÇÃO*) (1771–1823)

A 2nd rate ship with 90 guns, which acted as flagship to the squadron assisting Britain in patrolling the English Channel against French invasion in 1793, during the two-year blockade and Siege of Malta (1798). She was a part of the Anglo-Portuguese fleet that captured a treasure-bearing Ragusan polacca in 1800. She was also flagship to the fleet that carried the Portuguese royal court to Brazil in 1807. After Brazilian independence in 1823 she became part of the Brazilian fleet.

- The *Príncipe Real* must pass a Skill Test to change her Level of Sail.

Ship	Size	Broadsides	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
<i>Príncipe Real</i>	XL	4H-3L-2C	1H	2H	90	Yellow	3	30	350

SAILING & FIGHTING IN THE MEDITERRANEAN

Weather, geography, history, politics, and personal ambition all affected conflict in the Mediterranean.

Although generally serene, Mediterranean weather was often (and continues to be) unsettled, especially in spring and autumn, when contradictory winds of variable force, even storms, became common. In summer temperatures could soar, especially along the Barbary Coast, whilst winter in southern Europe often saw snow.

Despite the Mediterranean generally being more friendly and predictable than many oceans, sailing ships tended to favour routes via friendly or neutral ports, often within striking distance of a coast. This and the combined need to resupply gave many islands of the Mediterranean strategic importance or tactical usefulness, with island geography determining much naval action. For example, when Greeks sought independence from the Ottoman Empire, they leveraged the narrow channels of the Ionian Islands to give ad hoc fleets of small



A bloody encounter between Franco-Spanish and Royal Navy fleets.

"Not in a lifetime, my ship has just been painted fresh!"

Louis-Antoine-Cyprien Infernèze at Trafalgar, when pressed to surrender his ship, the Intrepide

ships great advantage over unwieldy Ottoman ships of the line.

The Rock of Gibraltar is arguably the single most significant location in the region. Though not quite an island, this peninsular at the southern tip of Spain dominates a passage only 14 nautical miles wide, effectively controlling entrance to the Mediterranean, through which much European trade had to pass. After 1713, Gibraltar was a British possession despite several Spanish attempts to regain it, most notably the Great Siege (1779–83).

Sicily is another island of strategic importance. As a British protectorate, it gave ships secure harbour, a respite during long journeys (it

could take two to three weeks to sail the length of the Med) and a station for relaying communications, as well as being a vital source of citrus fruits. Moreover, it offered a stepping stone for actions against Napoleon's possessions in Italy and for operations in both the Tyrrhenian Sea and Adriatic Seas.

In the Adriatic, Napoleon's control of the Venetian shipyards potentially allowed a revitalisation of French shipping lost at the Nile and Trafalgar, whilst the Ionian Islands became bases for French operations deeper in the Mediterranean.

Britain therefore harassed French Adriatic bases with increasingly stronger forces, each readily countered by France until British victory at the frigate Battle of Lissa in 1811.

As political and military landscapes changed, naval forces were affected, too. For example, when Spain revolted against French control in 1808, precipitating the Peninsular War, France had to secure and garrison Spanish ports, reducing the troops available to her land armies.

Otherwise, British ships could support land operations across the region, providing troop landings, communication, and supply. In such situations, coordinated land and sea operations could also be important, as shown by Russian success in the Dardanelles against the Ottomans.

Blockading enemy ports could also serve major strategic objectives; for example, during the Barbary Wars conducted by the USA. Blockades could limit trade, supply, communications, and shipbuilding.

Even when new ships were built, an effective blockade could mean that those ships never put to sea. All fleets, however, whether blockading or invading, needed their own support via large numbers of small craft, leading to many small-scale naval actions.



Galleys and Xebecs

Xebecs were vessels used almost exclusively in the Mediterranean Sea between the 16th and 19th centuries, both as merchants and as warships. They ranged in size but had an average armament of 24 guns. They were very agile and fast but would not withstand the heavier weather of ocean sailing and were not built with toughness in mind. If the wind died, the xebec could also deploy a set of oars, making them extremely versatile.

Originally designed in antiquity, galleys were used throughout history, especially in and around the Mediterranean Sea. With much the same design perfected in the 16th and 17th centuries, they were still in use in significant numbers during the 18th century. They rarely had cannons on their broadsides due to the space given to rows of oars; instead, a galley preferred to position as many cannons as it could fit on the ship's bow.

The Ottoman Empire and its vassal states made extensive use of both galleys and xebecs (for example, they had 21 xebecs at the Battle of Fidonisi in 1788). Many other nations continued to use both classes of ship until the end of the 18th century.

Galleys were used particularly in coastal fleets, especially as late as 1788 during Russia's fights with both the Ottomans in the Black Sea and the Swedes in the Baltic. Russia also developed her own variants of the xebec, sometimes referred to as the 'chebec'.

Sweden built large fleets of galleys, augmenting them with more versatile 'archipelago frigates' to operate in the Finnish archipelago. These were hybrid, shallow draft ships like the *turuma* and *hemmema*, similar to xebecs but unique in

design, originally rigged with lateen sails but later square-rigged. At the Battle of Svensksund (1790) the Russian fleet included 13 xebecs and 26 galleys, while the Swedish had 15 galleys and several of their unique archipelago ships.

Similarly, Denmark-Norway used a fleet of 13 galleys in the Baltic, though it seems its only use of a xebec was the hiring of one to accompany the frigate *Najaden* while bombarding Tripoli in 1797.

Both France and Spain used galleys until late in the 18th century, such as the French *La Duchesse* and *Brave*, although they were largely used as transports and eventually retired as prison hulks around the end of the century.

Spain sent 12 xebecs to take part in the bombardment of Algiers in 1783, in a fleet which also included xebecs from the Kingdom of the Two Sicilies and galleys from Malta.

The French built several xebecs and half-xebecs (smaller, similar ships) for Mediterranean use in the Napoleonic Wars, such as the *Pierre*, captured by HMS *Terpsichore* in 1798. Napoleon's Italian fleet also employed both galleys and xebecs taken from the Venetian and Sicilian fleets.

British xebecs seem to have been used mainly by privateers, operating largely in the Mediterranean. This includes both the *Good Intent*, captured in 1793, and the *Good Union*, taken by the French in 1799 and recaptured by the British in 1801.

During the American Revolution, the riverine navies of both Virginia and Pennsylvania made extensive use of galleys. Patrolling the Delaware River to protect Philadelphia, the Pennsylvanian Navy's 13 galleys were a major factor in restricting the movement of British and Tory forces. In 1777 it also fought alongside the USS *Champion*, perhaps the only xebec serving in any of the States' navies.

Ships similar to xebec were also widely used in the Arabian and Indian seas, although these had many names and many variants. For example, the *baghlah* was quite similar to the xebec, though not oared, and saw a great deal of use in the Persian Gulf and Indian Ocean, especially by pirates (leading, for example, to the British Gulf Campaign against them in 1809).



Small
Galley

THE BARBARY COAST PIRATES

Because of a thriving network of trade across the region, the Mediterranean offered opportunities for pirates and states to establish large fleets that could be used to overwhelm merchant convoys. Morocco, an independent state, and Algeria, Tripoli (today, Libya), and Egypt, all vassal states of the Ottoman Empire and collectively referred to as the 'Barbary Coast', were the refuges of corsairs, largely operating with the sanction of their governments.

They made money by capturing ships, selling crews as slaves, and raiding Mediterranean coastal settlements. To protect themselves from this piracy, countries including Sweden, Britain, Denmark, and the Mediterranean states all paid tribute to Barbary States. Smaller countries depended on agreements made by the larger ones for their protection.

In the case of the three Ottoman states, a tithe of this income was sent to the Sultan in Constantinople. In this way, the Ottoman Empire gained income and slaves, extended the influence of Islam (sometimes through forced conversion of captives), and developed several experienced fleets and captains that could be called upon in conflicts. The Barbary States, however, though generally ruled by ex-Janissaries from the Ottoman forces, also valued their independence, and so often operated outside Constantinople's control. The corsairs themselves also maintained their own semi-independence from their governments, sometimes operating with official sanction, sometimes following their own aims.

Any country not protected by another country's agreement or navy was seen as fair game by the corsairs. In the latter part of the eighteenth century, this was a particular problem for the newly developing United States of America. Its War of Independence had driven it into debt. Trade with European countries, especially



Large Galley

those around the Mediterranean, was a critical element of its economic recovery, as well as the business of establishing itself as a major power.

The Barbary pirates were a significant threat to both these ambitions. US merchants were unprotected, as President Washington had dismantled the navy once peace had been declared. As a consequence, American trade suffered, and its citizens were enslaved.

Although much of the US economy itself relied on enslaved Africans, many Americans were horrified to hear of Christian men being enslaved by African nations. It nevertheless took ten years of negotiation to get treaties with all four North African nations. During this period, Congress also built a small navy.

This proved wise for, in 1801, Tripoli reneged on the agreement and declared war on the USA, claiming the tribute insufficient and too long delayed. President Jefferson had already despatched the US fleet to enforce the treaty, not knowing war had been declared against him. This became the First Barbary War.

Barbary fleets were not large and were generally made up of relatively small ships with shallow draft, useful in coastal waters and

able to flee where larger ships could not pursue. Their larger vessels were often captured from other nations, so uniformity of appearance across a fleet was uncommon.

They used oared craft, such as galleys, as rowing could give an advantage when the wind was against them, but oared ships required large crews, which generally meant slaves and in turn meant they did not necessarily have the most reliable crew.

On the other hand, some crews were hardened veterans, spending most of their lives aboard ship and potentially highly motivated by the prospect of loot. Xebecs, whilst perhaps not the fastest ships, combined oars with lateen sails and could be very manoeuvrable. As such they were common in Barbary fleets.

Tactically, the pirates usually aimed to surround target vessels and board them, so the defensive tactic of a ship under attack from pirates was to use gunfire to keep the pirate vessels at a distance. Consequently, any encounter where the corsair vessel or fleet appeared outgunned would often result in an early flight.

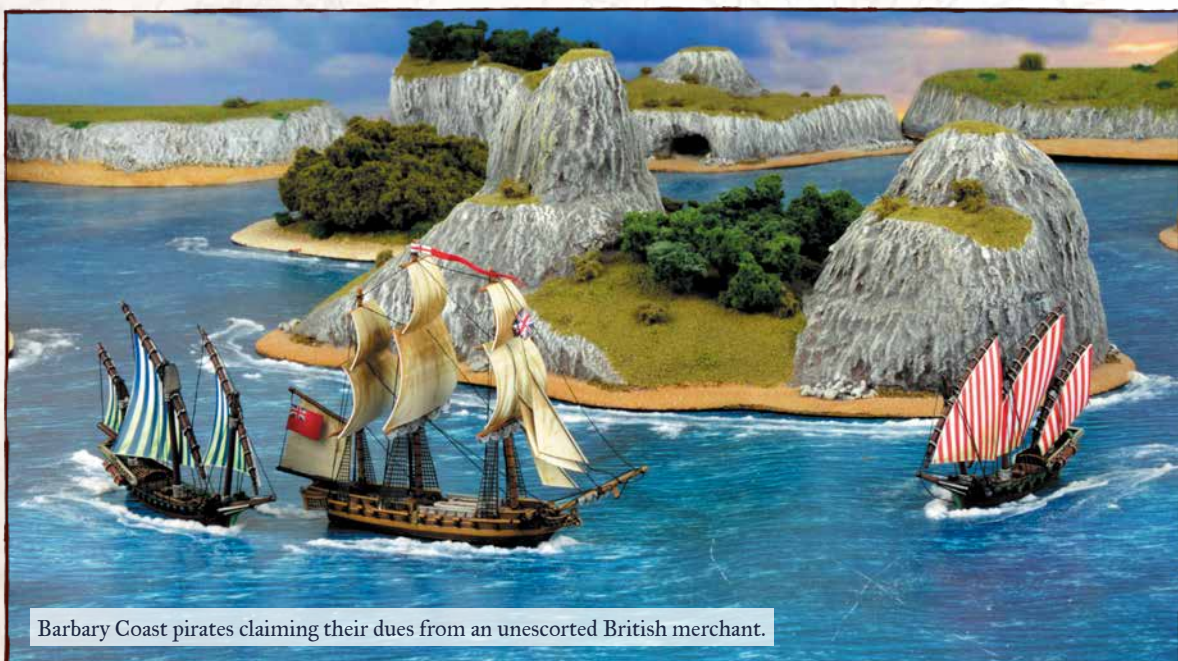
Piracy was by no means limited to the Barbary Coast, though whether a particular action was piracy or legitimate military action depended often upon point of view. Similar situations could be found in many regions. Twice in the early 19th century (1809 and 1819) British forces

operated against 'pirates' in the Persian Gulf who threatened British trade with India.

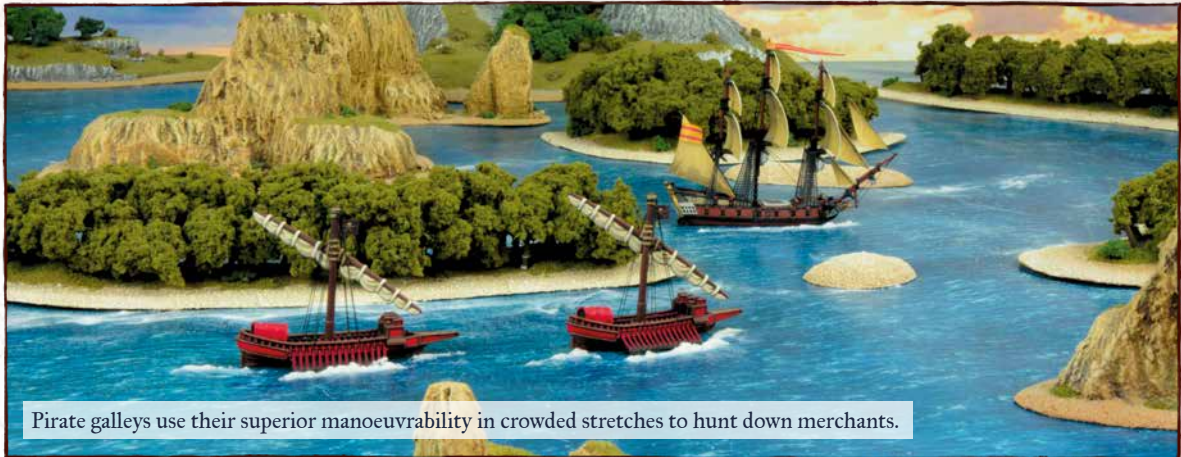
This coastline, inhabited by Arab tribes, was known as 'the Pirate Coast' by the British. It was a common belief in Western Europe that piracy was the main livelihood of some of these tribes. It seems there was a significant increase in piracy here around 1805 and at least one reason for this is probably French encouragement. The Gulf pirates could command large fleets of dhows and bhagalas (a two-masted, lateen-rigged vessel similar to a xebec) of perhaps 50 ships, used to mass around and overwhelm isolated prey. One estimate suggests the fleet of the Al Qasimi Arabs operating in the Gulf was well over 800 ships and nearly 20,000 men strong.

The East India Company patrolled with just two ships. Britain's 1809 raid on the Al Qasimi took two Royal Navy frigates, nine smaller EIC warships and three battalions of troops. After driving off the Arab fleet and landing the troops under cover of the ships' cannons, the British overcame the defences of the Arabs at the Battle of Ras al-Khaimah and destroyed 50 of their ships.

However, it took less than two years for the pirates to get back to strength and a slightly larger operation was conducted in 1819, with similar British success. More notably, it resulted in the General Maritime Treaty of 1820, which banned piracy and slavery in the region.



Barbary Coast pirates claiming their dues from an unescorted British merchant.



National Rules

GALLEY MASTERY

Barbary Coast Pirates were masters at sailing galleys. Galleys do not have to spend a full Turn without shooting to switch from oars to sails. Decide what movement the ship will use at the start of its activation; use this until the ship's next activation.

Special Characters

RA'IS (CAPTAIN) HAMIDOU (1773–1815) 5 OPTS

A noted Algerian corsair of the late 18th century, known for his gallantry and chivalry. He was a captor of several ships and regarded as a hero in Algiers. Whilst captain of the flagship *Meshuda*, he was killed by the US attack led by Stephen Decatur at Cape Gata in 1815.



- Hamidou's flagship has the Lucky upgrade at no extra cost.
- Hamidou gives any friendly ships currently within 8" of his flagship the Privateer upgrade.

Famous Ships

MESHUDA

There were several Barbary ships of this name. The Algerian flagship captured by Stephen Decatur in the Second Barbary War of 1815 was a 46-gun frigate, apparently 'as big as any of the American frigates'. When pursued by Decatur, it responded with musket fire rather than cannon fire.

- This ship has the Privateer upgrade for free.
- It also has a free Sharpshooters upgrade and always uses the Advanced Rule Musket Fire.

Ship	Size	Broadside	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
<i>Meshuda</i>	M	1H-1L-1C	-	1L	40	Red	5	13	140

THE OTTOMANS

The sprawl of the Ottoman Empire – from Morocco to the Persian Gulf and Poland to the Sudan – meant that the Ottomans had multiple enemies and depended on subject nations to crew a wide variety of ships. The gunships of the Levant were manned by Greek levies, the Nile was policed by Mamelukes and the Barbary States used piratical fleets of captured vessels to maintain the economies of their nations.

Ottoman fleets could be vast and varied, often using a mix of craft including copies of Western European design and traditional Mediterranean designs. Galleys, though largely outmoded by 1750, were greatly used in the coastal waters of the Black Sea and the Aegean. Xebecs proved more versatile, offering manoeuvrability and power independent of the wind. Generally, they had a relatively shallow draft, enabling coastal operations. However, they required large crews, which frequently meant depending on slaves for rowing.

Whilst the galley was essentially an oared craft that could set a sail, the xebec was a sailing craft which could also be rowed. The lateen sails of most xebecs also gave them some flexibility of movement compared with similar sized square-rigged vessels.

At the 1770 Battle of Chesma, for example, in addition to 16 ships of the line and six frigates, the Ottoman fleet also contained 13 galleys, six xebecs and at least 30 smaller ships (all of which were lost to the Russian victors). In the same period, the Ottomans also commandeered armed merchants to military service when required. In the wars with Russia, armed merchants were used, typically with 40 guns.

These were generally larger than equivalent ships in Western European fleets, so often sluggish and prone to ‘hogging’; i.e., distortion of the ship’s shape due to excessive stress, which meant that caulking was at times a significant issue. An Ottoman fleet might

therefore contain quite a variety of vessels, especially for coastal operations, where ships of the line might protect large numbers of xebecs, galleys, bomb craft, and transports.

Operating under the aegis of Russia, one privateer named Lambros Katsonis gathered a small fleet to attack Ottoman shipping in the Aegean and blockade the Dardanelles. With only nine vessels, Katsonis took on a combined Turkish and Algerian fleet of around 30 vessels in the 1790 Battle of Andros. Although a significant victory for the Ottomans, Katsonis lost nearly all his ships and the Ottoman fleet suffered roughly six times the Greek losses, rendering it ineffective.

The Dardanelles were no longer blockaded in 1791, so the Turks were able successfully to summon the subject fleets of the Barbary States to the Black Sea, where they assembled a fleet of 60 ships seeking revenge for the loss to the Russians at Tendra (1790). The fleet included 18 ships of the line and 17 frigates, with over 2,000 guns between them. However, this fleet was caught off guard by the Russian admiral Ushakov, who defeated them at Kaliakra with a fleet of only 16 ships of the line and two frigates.

The second half of the 18th century saw the Ottoman Navy suffer several such defeats, largely at the hands of Russian expansion. Between 1760 and 1830 there were four distinct



Russo-Turkish wars and, of course, friction between the two countries for much of the time they weren't officially at war, as towns and territories changed hands.

The Ottoman fleet suffered continually from political infighting within its commands, where a single failure might mean the end of an admiral's career (or even his life). Its crews were often of lesser quality, having been forced into the labour, and were often slaves who weren't overly keen to obey their masters.

The Turks' Russian opponents also believed that Ottoman fleets would flee or surrender once they lost their flagship, and so would sometimes focus on attacking that one ship. In 1807 Napoleon persuaded the Sultan to block passage through the Dardanelles to all non-French traffic. In exchange, France would help recover Ottoman territory lost to Russia.

Russia responded by invading Wallachia and Moldavia, whilst Britain exerted pressure on the Sultan to reverse the decision, accede

to Russian demands, declare war on France, and surrender her fleet. The Sultan refused, so a British fleet under Sir John Thomas Duckworth on HMS *Royal George* destroyed a Turkish squadron in the Marmara Sea and blockaded Constantinople. However, powerful shore batteries installed by the French sank two British warships and Duckworth withdrew.

In the Greek War of Independence (1821–32), several ad hoc Greek fleets operated against Turkish ships in the Aegean Sea. Revolts against Ottoman rule occurred in many Greek islands, with independent fleets operating from Hydra, Spetses, and Psara. The Ottoman fleet in the Aegean included of 20 ships of the line, whilst the inferior Greek fleets were mainly converted merchant ships with light guns.

The Greeks often used fire ships, generally directed against the larger warships in Turkish fleets, for maximum impact. After a few spectacular successes with this tactic, some Ottoman captains were reluctant to



Ottoman ships attempt to fend off a Russian attack.

close for action. In the course of the war, Greeks made 39 successful attacks with fire ships.

Although these revolts were responded to piecemeal, and usually successfully, it was clear to the Ottomans that a more extensive imposition of order was needed. Therefore, an Egyptian force under Muhammad Ali was sent to the Greek peninsular and, by late 1826, had almost completely suppressed revolt. At this point Russia, France, and Britain allied, deciding it was advisable to intervene on behalf of Greek independence; they came together against Ottoman and Egyptian fleets at Navarino in October 1827.

The Ottoman fleet consisted of 78 fighting ships (plus many smaller ships) carrying 2,180 guns, whilst the allied fleet had only 22 ships with 1,258 guns. However, the allied guns were generally more powerful and better crewed, giving a better rate of fire and more accurate shooting. Moreover, many of the Ottoman vessels were brigs and corvettes, of relatively little use against the allied ships of the line.

The Ottoman defeat was so substantial that her fleet in the Aegean was effectively destroyed. However, that did not end the war, as Ottoman armies still controlled much of Greece. It was left to the Russo-Turkish War of 1828–9 and some complex politicking fully to secure Greek independence.

National Rules

OARS EVERYWHERE

Because of the erratic nature of wind patterns in the Mediterranean Sea, several ships of the Ottoman Navy were also equipped with oars.

All ships of 4th rate and lower can use the Advanced Rule Moving Under Oars.

Special Characters

CEZAYIRLI GAZI HASAN PASHA (1713–1790) 50PTS

A Georgian slave who fought as a Barbary corsair out of Algiers, then ascended through the ranks in the Ottoman Navy. He was one of the few commanders who did well at the disaster of Chesma (1770), successfully blockaded Acre, harried Russian shipping, governed Egypt, and died in the Russo-Turkish War of 1787–92.



- Hasan Pasha may be used by either the Ottoman Navy or the Barbary Coast pirates.
- Once per game, each ship in Hasan Pasha's fleet may re-roll a single Skill Test.

Famous Ships

MASUDIYA

A 1st rate ship of the line with 120 cannons and the flagship of Admiral Pasha.

Ship	Size	Broadsides	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
Masudiya	XL	6H-4L-2C	1H	2H	120	Yellow	3	40	500

SOLO GAMING

Sometimes it is not possible or easy to find an opponent to play against. It might also be useful to put in some practice on your own in preparation for an important game. In these circumstances, there are several approaches to play a game that follows a series of pre-scripted actions.

A simple method is to adapt the various scenarios and deploy forces for the opponent yourself, then follow a prescribed mechanic when activated. For example, all the opponent's ships could always sail towards the closest enemy ship and shoot

whenever possible. As this is not very intuitive and can lead to deliberately or subconsciously weak strategies on behalf of the (imaginary) opponent, here we present three scenarios designed for playing solo games.

MONSTER HUNT

Something terrible is lurking under the water and, rather than being caught on the back foot, you and your fleet are on the chase.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 3' x 4' area. The wind is blowing from the east.

DEPLOYMENT

Place one 3rd Rate ship and one 5th Rate Frigate in the north-west corner, sailing with Battle Sails.

Using the descriptions on pages 91–93, decide which Terror(s) of the Deep to use, making adjustments depending on the level of difficulty you want to experience. When using the weaker Terror(s) of the Deep, you could double or treble their number. Place the Terror(s) of the Deep in the middle of the gaming area.

SPECIAL RULES

Activate the Terror(s) of the Deep and ships as per rules on page 90 of this supplement.

As soon as a Terror of the Deep takes a hit that reduces its Hit Points to under half of its starting value, it will immediately dive under the surface and, on its next activation, re-appear at the side of the closest ship. Then it will proceed to attack.

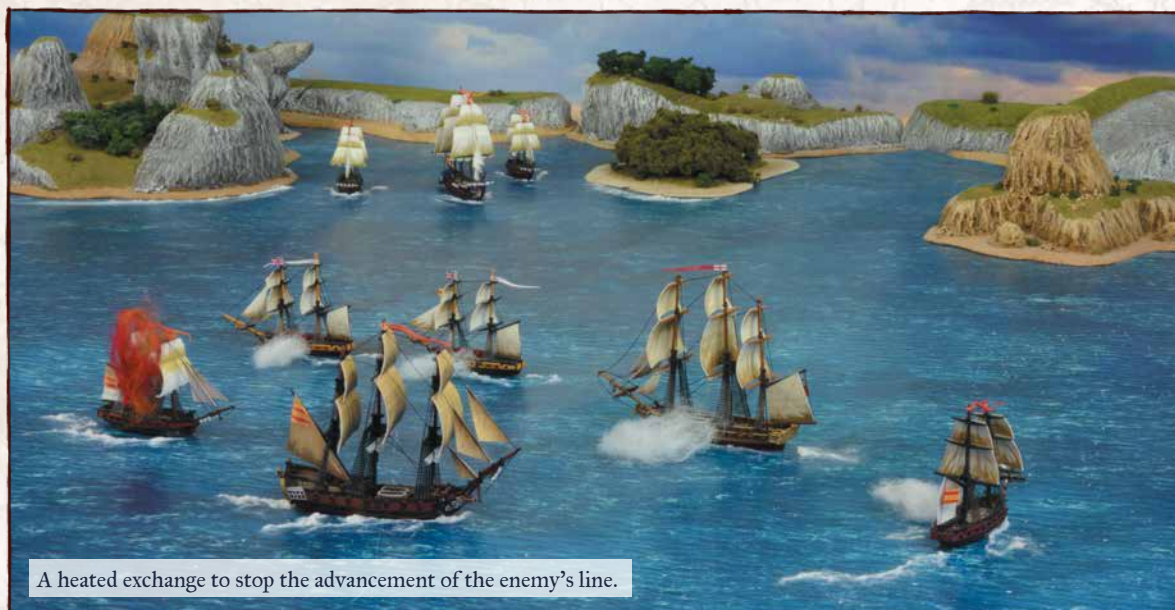


When shooting at a Terror of the Deep in contact with another ship, apply the damage to both the Terror and the ship, as if you were shooting into grappled ships.

Contrary to the rules on pages 90 the creature(s) will keep attacking until they are killed. For more challenge, continue adding Terrors of the Deep to the scenario.

VICTORY

You win if you kill the Terror(s) of the Deep.



AGAINST THE ODDS

You are at the vanguard of a fleet of merchant ships laden with precious cargo when you encounter an enemy patrol. The odds are stacked against you. However, iron hearts are forged in such battles! You must destroy or disable enough of the enemy's forces to allow the rest of your fleet to get by.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 3' x 4' area. The wind is blowing from the northeast.

DEPLOYMENT

Place two Brigs and one 5th Rate Frigate in a line sailing with Light Sails from southeast to northwest. Behind them, place another two Brigs and one 5th Rate Frigate in the same line. The two Frigates have Veteran crews and all the Brigs have Regular crews. These will be the enemy ships.

Deploy one Frigate and two Brigs in the northeast corner, sailing at Battle Sails, with the backs of their wakes touching the table edge. These will be your ships.

SPECIAL RULES

When activated, the enemy ships will maintain course and speed until they get close to the table corner, at which point they will turn south. As soon as at least one game ship reaches the southwest corner, the game will end. When



activated, the enemy ships will shoot with all available guns at the closest target.

Use the Advanced Rule Sailing in Lines; boarding actions are not permitted.

VICTORY

You must sink or disable at least half of the enemy ships whilst you still have at least two of your ships.

TREASURE FLEET

A heavily laden merchant convoy has been spotted on the horizon, but you have only a slim window of opportunity before they get in range of a friendly port.

BATTLE AREA

This scenario is best played on a 3' x 4' area. The wind is blowing from the east.

DEPLOYMENT

Place two Large Merchants and, behind them, two Small Merchants sailing in a line with Full Sails in the yellow zone. Then place a fleet made of 500 points in either or across both red zones. Also place Martello towers and gun emplacements where indicated.



SPECIAL RULES

The Martello towers will shoot at the closest target at the end of every Turn. The merchants will continue going at Full Sails until they are past the halfway point between the eastern and western edges of the table, after which they will leave the line and slow to Battle Sails. They will shoot with all available guns at the closest enemy ships.

Merchants can be captured following the rules on page 84. Captured merchants will become

part of the player's fleet and can therefore be shot by other merchants or the land batteries.

Use the Advanced Rule Sailing in Lines.

VICTORY

The game ends as soon as all merchants are either captured or have left the gaming area. Capturing a Large Merchant is worth 3 points and capturing a Small Merchant is worth 1 point. See how many points you can gain!



A pair of merchants escape with their cargo and their lives!

ADDITIONAL RULES

In this section you will find additional or alternative rules to the ones described in the *Black Seas* rulebook. These are to be considered official and can be used in your games of *Black Seas*. However, treat them as the same as you would the *Black Seas* rulebook's Advanced Rules, which means you will need to agree with your opponent before you use them.

AWE AND FEAR

Larger war vessels could inspire both awe and fear in crew of smaller vessels. Therefore, there was great reluctance for any ship to engage larger ships.

To reflect this, every activation that a ship wants to engage (in any way) a ship three full ratings or more above their own will first have to pass a Skill Test. In other words, an unrated ship can engage up to a 5th rate ship without making a test but needs to pass a test to engage anything higher than a 5th rate ship.



A Royal Navy 6th Rate frigate on patrol.

When the target is four rates above the active ship, apply -1 to the Skill Test. When five rates above, apply -2 modifier, and when six rates above, apply -3.

CAPTURING SHIPS

As soon as an opponent's ship Strikes the Colours and is not on fire, it can be captured. To do this, you must use a ship of equal or greater rating to the one you want to capture. Declare a boarding action on your ship's activation (all rules for grappling and boarding still apply; see page 24 of *Black Seas*), and the capture will automatically succeed.

From the next Turn onwards, both ships can be used, and both can cast off and move during their activations. First, however, to represent the redistribution of crew, you must reduce the Ship Points of the capturing ship by a number of points sufficient to bring the total Ship Points of the captured ship to half of its original value. Add these points to the captured ship.

If doing so reduces the capturing vessel's Ship Points to under its Break Value, follow all the normal rules for Striking the Colours.

If a ship captures more than one ship, rather than further lowering her Ship Points, instead reduce her Rate of Knots by 1 and her broadside by two cannons (to a minimum of zero cannons) for each additional ship captured.

FORE-AND-AFT RIGGED SAILS

These include gaff-rigged sails, the Gunter rig, lateen sails, and lug sails, as well as others used on Schooners, Cutters, Galleys and Xebecs.

Ships that had this arrangement of sails were particularly agile and could trim the wind a lot closer than the bulkier, square-rigged ships. Therefore, they can use the following rules.

If using the standard rules for Wind Attitude, vessels with fore-and-aft rigged sails have a +2 to the Skill Test roll when attempting to tack.

If using the more realistic wind effect on movement, use the diagram on the right instead of the one in the *Black Seas* rulebook. Ships using fore-and-aft rigged sails also get a +1 on the Skill Test roll when attempting to tack.

A SIMPLER TIME

The *Black Seas* rules system covers the historical period from the 1770s to the 1830s; however, during the period just before, there were only a few differences in terms of sailing and combat. The following amendments to the main rules will help extend the period in which you can set your games.

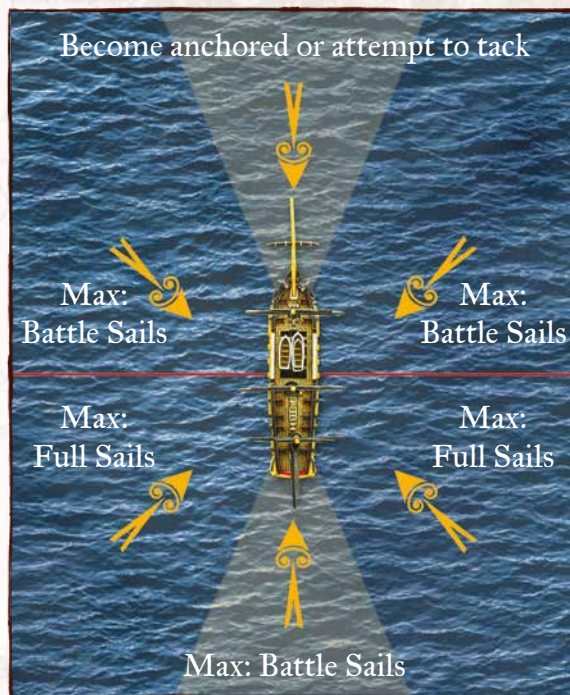
One of the main advancements during the second half of the 18th century was the introduction of carronades. Therefore, remove this from all ship profiles. All carronades should be treated as light guns instead.

Cannons were less accurate. All shooting has an additional -1 to hit.

Muskets were also less accurate, or sailors used bows and arrows instead. If using the Advanced Rule Musket Fire, add 2 instead of 3 to the damage if successful.

Finally, ships were not as sturdy as those of the latter period. Reduce the Ship Points of all ships (apart from the Galleon, which has been added to the list for the purpose of playing games in an earlier setting) by 10% rounding up. The points value of each ship remains the same.

If using galleons in the usual *Black Seas* period (1770–1830), then these are considered to be much older ships. Reduce the starting Ship Points of every Galleon to 25. Its point value also drops to 90.



GALLEYS

Galleys can use the Advanced Rule Moving Under Oars, found on page 34 of *Black Seas*. However, as their cannons were only located on the bow of the ship, they do not suffer the -2 to hit penalty to shooting whilst Moving Under Oars.

Furthermore, they do not have to spend a full Turn without shooting to switch from Moving Under Oars to sailing.

As the design of a galley was quite antiquated by the period covered under these rules, add +1 to the result when receiving a critical hit. Treat any result above 6 as a 6.

Finally, Galleys were designed to ram other vessels, therefore they do not need to test when ramming an opponent (colliding with another vessel head on). The opponent will still test to see if they can avoid the collision. The ramming Galley involved will take half (rounding up) of the damage it would have normally taken.

CALMER WATERS

Some regions favour calm weather, producing much calmer waters – such as on the Mediterranean Sea. When playing games set in such regions, you can use these additional rules: when rolling for wind direction, a result of 3 or 11 will have the same effect as a result of 2 (Becalmed!) in addition to the normal stated effect.

SHALLOW DRAFT

This is a new upgrade for Medium ships or smaller. Ignore the terrain rules for sandbanks and shoals/shorelines. Medium ships: 20 points, Small or less: 10 points.

WELL PREPARED

Both opposing fleets are primed for battle and have made vital preparations for the upcoming encounter.

All participating ships can have upgrades up to the allowed maximum. Any upgrades that cost 30 points or less can be selected for free. Furthermore, upgrades that cost more than 30 points can be bought for half their value (rounding up to the nearest 10 points).

All other rules for upgrades apply as well as the restriction that a fleet may only have three of the same upgrades in total.

This rule can be used when playing any scenario; however, it works better when the opposing forces are equally matched. It is also advisable to use this rule sporadically, as it carries with it the strong potential to unbalance the game.

ALTERNATIVE

ENTANGLEMENT RULES

At the end of each Turn (after all ships have been activated), check to see if any ungrappled ship is within 1" of another ship.

For each instance, all ships involved will roll a Skill Test with a +2. If every Skill Test is failed, all ships are now considered grappled and at anchor. Apply damage for a forced stop when necessary.

If friendly ships are entangled, on their activations they will be able to cast off immediately if any of the grappled ships roll a successful Skill Test with a +2.

If shot at, friendly grappled ships will suffer damage in the usual way, as per any other grappled ships.

DUAL OWNERSHIP RULES

Some Special Characters and Famous Ships can be used by more than one nation. As each game can have only one version of each unique character or ship, use a suitable method to decide who gets what, such as rolling a dice.

EPIC BATTLES

Each player can have as many unique Special Characters and Famous Ships as they like (as long as the above Dual Ownership Rule described above is adhered to).

Furthermore, there are no maximum limits on which ships can be deployed. This can significantly unbalance the game, so players should agree beforehand about what units are deployed.



1st and 2nd rate Royal Navy ships engage the enemy in a line of battle.

Sea Shanty: Spanish Ladies

Chorus:

*Farewell and adieu unto you Spanish ladies
Farewell and adieu to you ladies of Spain
For we've received orders for to sail for Old England
But we hope very soon we shall see you again*

[Chorus]

*We'll rant and we'll roar like true British sailors
We'll rant and we'll roar across the salt seas
Until we strike soundings in the Channel of Old England
From Ushant to Scilly is thirty-five leagues*

*We hove our ship to with the wind at sou'west, boys
We hove our ship to, our soundings to see
So we rounded and sounded; got forty-five fathoms
We squared our main yard and up channel steered we*

[Chorus]

*Now the first land we made it is called the Deadman
Next Ram Head off Plymouth, off Portland the Wight
We sailed by Beachy, by Fairlee and Dungeness
Till we came abreast of the South Foreland Light*

[Chorus]

*Then the signal was made for the grand fleet to anchor
All in the Downs that night for to lie
Then its stand by your stoppers, see clear your shank-painters,
Haul all your clew garnets, let tacks and sheets fly*

[Chorus]

*Now let every man toss off a full bumper
And let every man drink off a full glass
And we'll drink and be merry and drown melancholy
Singing here's a good health to each true-hearted lass*

NEW SHIPS

These two ship tables add several new ships to the list originally given in *Black Seas*. Otherwise, the only changes are that 1st and 4th Rates now have no maximum number available, and the maximum for Bomb Vessels has been reduced from 5 to 3.

SHIPS OF THE LINE

Ship	Size	Broadside	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
1st Rate	XL	4H-3L-3C	1H	2H	104	Yellow	3	35	450
2nd Rate (max 1)	XL	4H-3L-2C	1L	2H	96	Yellow	3	32	400
Large 3rd Rate	L	3H-2L-2C	1L	1H	74	Red	4	25	280
Small 3rd Rate	L	3H-2L-1C	-	1H	64	Red	4	22	250
Razee'd 3rd Rate (max 1)	L	2H-1L-2C	-	1H	82	Red	4	27	260
4th Rate	M	2H-2L-1C	-	1L	44	Red	4	15	190
Razee'd 4th Rate (max 1)	M	3H-1L-1C	-	1L	54	Red	4	18	200
5th Rate	M	2H-1L-1C	-	1L	36	Red	5	12	150
6th Rate	M	1H-1L-1C	-	-	28	Red	5	10	120

UNRATED SHIPS

Ship	Size	Broadside	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
Large Galley *#@	M	-	1L	2H	50	Red	5	17	90
Small Galley *#@	S	-	-	1L	35	Red	4	12	60
Large Merchant	L	2H-2L	-	-	44	Yellow	3	15	90
Small Merchant	M	1H-1L	-	-	28	Yellow	3	10	40

* Can use the Advanced Rule Moving Under Oars found on page 34 of the *Black Seas* rulebook.

Fore-and-Aft Rigged.

@ Shallow draft at no extra cost.

*"There is no way of dealing with the Frenchman
but to knock him down — to be civil to them is
to be laughed at!"*

Admiral Lord Nelson, 1798



UNRATED SHIPS

Ship	Size	Broadside	Stern	Bow	Ship Points	Turn Angle	Rate of Knots	Break Value	Points
Galleon	L	2H-2L	-	-	40	Yellow	4	15	130
Large Xebec *#@	S	2H-1L	-	-	20	Red	5	7	100
Small Xebec *#@	S	1H	-	-	10	Red	6	4	50
Gun Ketch	S	1H-1L	-	-	20	Red	5	7	70
Bomb Ketch	S	-	-	1M	20	Red	5	7	80
Large Cutter #	S	2L	-	-	12	Red	6	4	50
Small Cutter #@	S	1L	-	-	10	Red	5	4	30
Brig	S	2H	-	-	20	Red	5	7	80
Large Gunbrig	S	2C	-	-	20	Red	5	7	80
Barque	S	2H	-	-	16	Red	5	6	70
Sloop	S	1H-1L	-	-	16	Red	6	6	60
Schooner #	S	1L	-	-	12	Red	5	4	40
Bomb Vessel (max 3) *	S	-	-	1M	10	Red	4	4	50
Gunbrig Squadron (max 3) @	T	1C	-	-	12	n/a	4	4	40
Gunboat Squadron (max 6) @	T	-	-	1L	12	n/a	4	4	30
Fire Ship (max 4)	M	-	-	-	20	Yellow	3	7	80

* Can use the Advanced Rule Moving Under Oars found on page 34 of the Black Seas rulebook.

Fore-and-Aft Rigged.

@ Shallow draft at no extra cost.

TERRORS OF THE DEEP

There were many creatures roaming the depths of the oceans in the Age of Sail, some real and some mythical. Use the following rules if you want to include these Terrors of the Deep in your games. Beware, these are not at necessarily historically accurate! All players should agree before using them.

DEPLOYMENT

Unless otherwise specified, deploy the Terrors of the Deep at the centre of the gaming area.

MOVEMENT

Terrors of the Deep are activated at the start of each Turn, just after rolling for wind but before activating any ship. When activated, Terrors of the Deep move at full speed in a direct line towards the nearest ship. As they are all underwater swimmers (or mythical creatures), they are unaffected by wind. If they come into contact with a ship during their move, they will immediately end their move and attack. Place them on the closest side of the target ship.

ATTACKS

Terrors of the Deep each have one or more attacks but can only attack once per activation. If attacking a new target, they will always use their first attack. If they are attacking the same target on their next activation, they will use their second attack. Once a ship is sunk or disabled, the Terror of the Deep will move on to the next closest target.

When a ship sailing with Light Sails is attacked, it comes to an immediate stop and is considered grappled with the Terror of the Deep (see page 86). Ships sailing faster will be attacked once, but will move as normal on their activation.



Dinner's up! A hungry kraken envelops a British 1st rate ship.

"Never mind manoeuvres, always go at them!"

Lord Horatio Nelson

ATTACKING TERRORS OF THE DEEP

Terrors of the Deep can be attacked with cannons in the same way as attacking an opponent's ship. However, as they are partially submerged, there is always an extra -1 to hit them. Use all the standard modifiers and rules. A critical hit will do double damage (which is doubled again if in point blank range).

The Hit Points of Terrors of the Deep are equivalent to Ship Points. Whilst grappled, ships can fight the equivalent of a boarding action against the Terror of the Deep or attempt to disengage but may not shoot cannons.

During its activation, any sea creature with under a third of its starting Hit Points will escape, disappearing into the deep. Remove the model from the table when this happens.

Leviathan

A monstrous sea creature.

Hit Points: 70 **Speed:** 9 **Size:** Large

FIRST ATTACK

Light Snack. The Leviathan's huge mouth sweeps the decks, gobbling up some of the crew. The targeted ship receives 1D6 damage.

SECOND ATTACK

Crushing Bite. The creature bites the ship, doing 1D10 damage. If the roll is a 10, the bite got hold of one of the masts, crushing it like a toothpick. Instead of dealing 10 points of damage, immediately apply the Mast Hit result from the Critical Hit Table found on page 21 of the *Black Seas* rulebook.



Kraken

A huge cephalopod-like creature with long tentacles and a hard beak.

Hit Points: 60 **Speed:** 8 **Size:** Large

FIRST ATTACK

Envelop. Tentacles engulf the ship and reach for any exposed crew member. The ship comes to an immediate stop and is now considered grappled, no matter her original speed. Roll a boarding action; the Kraken has +1 to the required target number. The grappled ship receives -1 to disengage.



Megalodon

A huge prehistoric shark.

Hit Points: 40 **Speed:** 14 **Size:** Extra Large

FIRST ATTACK

Shark Bite. The targeted ship receives 1D6 damage.

After attacking a ship, on its next activation the Megalodon will move to attack the next closest ship.



White Whale

White Whales are huge, angry Terrors of the Deep that attack ships on sight.

Hit Points: 35 **Speed:** 10 **Size:** Medium

FIRST ATTACK

Headbutt. The White Whale smashes its body into the ship with all its might, inflicting 1D6 damage.

SECOND ATTACK

Water Spray. An intense jet of water is ejected from the White Whale's blowhole; roll on the Critical Table – High (located on page 21 of the *Black Seas* rulebook) and apply the results immediately.

After attacking a ship with its second attack, on its next activation, the White Whale will move to attack the next closest ship.



Sea Serpent

A huge slithering sea snake.

Hit Points: 55 **Speed:** 14 **Size:** Medium

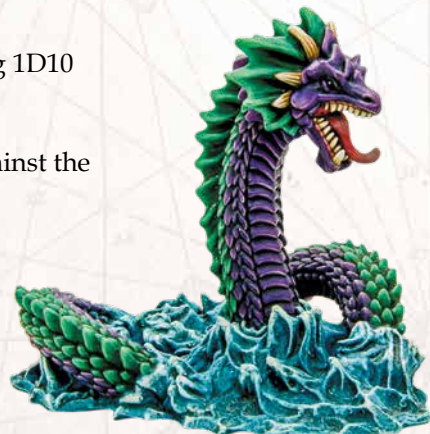
FIRST ATTACK

Snake Bite. The targeted ship receives 1D3 damage.

SECOND ATTACK

Coil. The Sea Serpent coils itself around the target ship, causing 1D10 damage to the ship. The ship is now grappled.

The crew cannot disengage but may fight a boarding action against the serpent. In this case, the Sea Serpent will not fight back. Once coiled, the Sea Serpent inflicts D10 damage every Turn, keeping the ship grappled instead of alternating attacks.



Giant Narwhal

A large whale-like creature with a huge horn protruding from its head.

Hit Points: 35 **Speed:** 10 **Size:** Medium



FIRST ATTACK

Piercing Horn. The whale pierces the ship's hull below the waterline, inflicting 3 points of damage. Until at least 3 points are repaired, the ship will lose a further D3 points at the start of every subsequent activation. Apply this only once per Turn, even if the same ship suffers multiple Narwhal attacks.

Ghost Ship

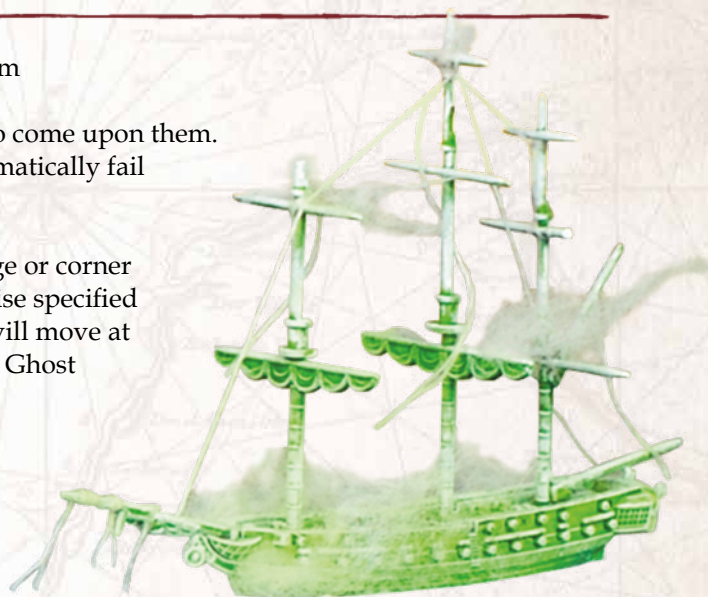
Hit Points: N/A **Speed:** 12 **Size:** Medium

These ghostly apparitions inspire fear in all who come upon them. All ships within 20" of the Ghost Ship will automatically fail any Skill Test roll they have to make.

Deploy the Ghost Ship from the centre table edge or corner from which the wind is blowing, unless otherwise specified by a scenario. When activated, the Ghost Ship will move at its speed towards the centre of the gaming area. Ghost Ships are unaffected by wind.

A Ghost Ship cannot be grappled and is unaffected by all combat. It will also pass through any ship in their path; move it just beyond any ship it would end its movement on. Every ship they move through suffers 3 damage.

When it reaches the centre, the Ghost Ship will disappear. Remove it from the gaming area and, at the start of the next round, re-deploy it in the same place where it started. It will again move towards the centre of the gaming area.



Using Terrors of the Deep in your Games

This book contains a few scenarios that make use of Terrors of the Deep and Ghost Ships. However, feel free to use them in any game you play.

Either choose one you wish to play with or use a random selection method. Terrors of the Deep will appear at the beginning of Turn 2, before any activation, in the middle of the gaming area.

If playing with more than one Terror of the Deep, space them evenly apart around the middle of the gaming area. After this, follow the rules above to use the Terrors of the Deep.

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"England expects that every man will do his duty."
Admiral Lord Nelson before Trafalgar, 1805





COMPANY ROSTER

COMPANY NAME:.....

FAME MODIFIER:.....

TOTAL FAME:.....

Warehouse

Goods		DR	Number of TUS	Value
Iron	£50	1		£
Wheat	£50	1		£
Timber	£50	1		£
Beer	£100	2		£
Tea	£100	2		£
Spirits	£150	3		£
Silk	£150	3		£
Tobacco	£200	4		£
Coffee	£200	4		£
Weapons	£300	7		£
Espionage Materials	£100	12		£
CASH				£
TOTAL:				£

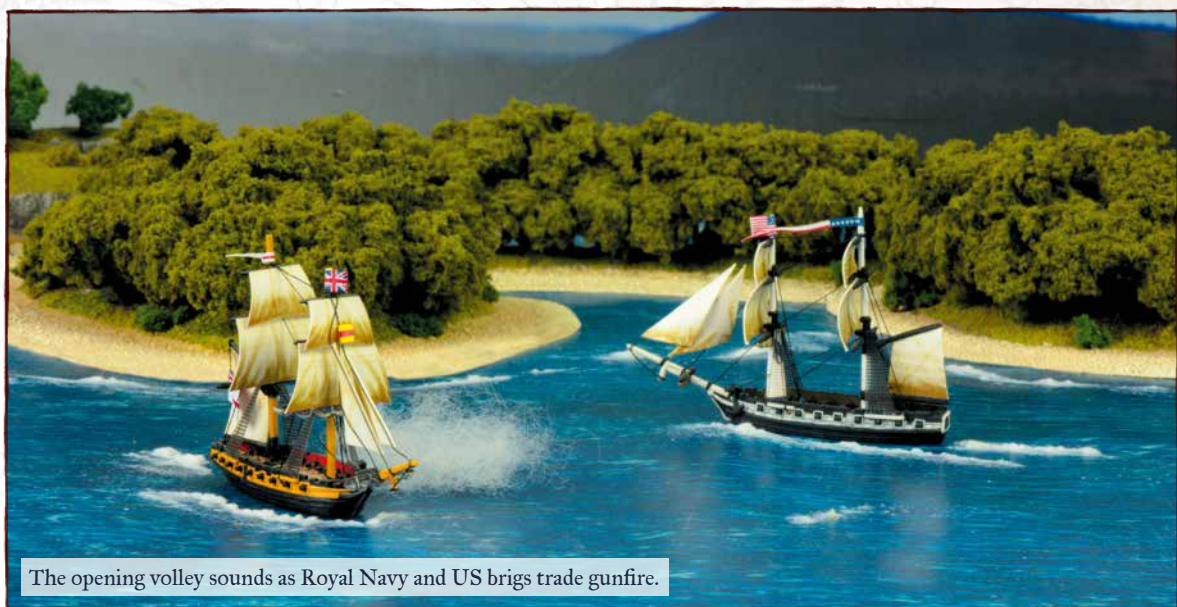
Fleet

Ship Name	Ship Type	In-Game Effects	Current Ship Points	VALUE
				£
				£
				£
				£
				£
				£
				£
				£
				£
				£
				£
				£
				£
				£





British Schooners rush to the aid of a Spanish Merchant beset by privateers.



The opening volley sounds as Royal Navy and US brigs trade gunfire.



US privateers closing in to 'commandeer' the contents of a Spanish merchant's hold.

The Age of Sail Battle Game®

BLACK SEAS®

1770-1830



HOLD FAST!

Black Seas focuses on the golden age of sail, which encompasses the period between 1770 and 1830. During this period the navies of Europe and beyond fight for dominance of the high seas. *Hold Fast!* is a supplement for the *Black Seas* age of sail game. Inside, find new ways to play, such as charting your course as an independent smuggler or following a navy career from lieutenant to admiral.

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